

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Digital Reality Profile: JR Woodward

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

Generated June 09, 2026 · 36 sections · Slug: jr-woodward

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Research Index

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JR Woodward — research sidebar manifest

Canonical paths aligned with Author Profile `/profile` navigation.

Sidebar slug	File	Status
author-profile	profile/identity.md	populated
author-profile	network/organizations.md	populated
biography	profile/biography.md	populated
theological-profile	profile/theology.md	populated
vocational-profile	summary.md	populated
vocational-profile	profile/calling-profile.md	empty
voice-editorial-identity	profile/voice-analysis.md	populated
bibliography	content/books.md	populated
frameworks	content/frameworks.md	populated
articles-blog-posts	content/articles.md	populated
audio-podcast	content/audio.md	populated
video-content	content/videos.md	populated
content-audit	content/content-audit.md	empty
academic-work	content/academic.md	populated
courses-training	content/courses.md	populated
audience-profile	analysis/audience-analysis.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/websites.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/platforms.md	populated
where-you-publish	digital-presence/newsletters.md	populated
social-media	digital-presence/social-media.md	populated
the-fragmentation-story	fragmentation-story.md	populated
a-letter	reflected-understanding/jr-woodward.md	populated
(onboarding)	welcome-letter.md	populated

Staff-only research lives in `_staff/` ; collateral in `_misc/` .

At a Glance — Summary

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/summary.md

Digital Reality Profile: JR Woodward

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Executive Summary

JR Woodward is a church planter, author, and missiologist with over 30 years of experience establishing churches that emphasize tight-knit community, life-forming discipleship, locally-rooted presence, and boundary-crossing mission. He holds a Ph.D. from the University of Manchester (UK) and a Master of Arts in Global Leadership from Fuller Theological Seminary. Woodward has authored 3 books, including "Creating a Missional Culture" (IVP, 2012), co-authored "The Church as Movement" (IVP, 2016), and most recently published "The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church" (100 Movements Publishing, 2023), which is based on his Ph.D. research.

Woodward currently serves as the National Director for the V3 Church Planting Movement, where he trains church planters across North America. He co-founded the Missio Alliance and Praxis Gathering, and serves as an adjunct professor at Fuller Theological Seminary (leading a Doctor of Global Leadership cohort starting Spring 2025), Central Seminary, and Missio Seminary. He also serves on the boards of Reliant Mission, Movement Leaders Collective, and the Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council.

Woodward's digital presence includes a personal website (jrwoodward.com), an Academia.edu profile, multiple organizational platforms (V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering), publisher platforms (InterVarsity Press, 100 Movements Publishing), and academic affiliations. His content spans books, organizational training materials, academic courses, and conference speaking. The content ecosystem shows strong thematic consistency around missional culture, church as movement, and leadership, though opportunities exist for greater content interconnection and digital amplification of embodied work.

Key Findings:

- Established author with 3 published books (1 solo, 1 co-authored, 1 recent solo based on Ph.D. research)
- Over 30 years of practical church planting experience combined with academic credentials (Ph.D.)
- National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement (training church planters across North America)
- Co-founder of significant missional organizations (Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)
- Adjunct professor at multiple seminaries (Fuller, Central, Missio)

- Board service on multiple missional organizations
- Recent publication (2023) indicates active writing and research
- Strong integration of academic research and practical experience

Primary Opportunities:

- Content repurposing (books → articles/courses, teaching → articles/courses, training → articles/courses)
- Content series development from books, teaching, and 30+ years of experience
- Content interconnection across multiple platforms
- Digital amplification of conference talks, seminary teaching, and training materials
- Unified content platform for discoverability and network effects

Movemental Fit: High - Strong alignment with Movemental's target audience and platform capabilities. Woodward's work (30+ years church planting experience, published author, National Director, co-founder of missional organizations, adjunct professor) aligns perfectly with Movemental's focus on Christian movement thought leaders. Opportunities for content repurposing, series development, and network effects.

Current Digital Presence

Website Presence

Primary Website: jrwoodward.com (active, official personal website)

Organizational Websites:

- V3 Church Planting Movement (National Director role)
- Missio Alliance (Co-founder)
- Praxis Gathering (Co-founder)

Publisher Presence:

- InterVarsity Press (IVP) author page (books: "Creating a Missional Culture" 2012, "The Church as Movement" 2016)
- 100 Movements Publishing (book: "The Scandal of Leadership" 2023)

Academic Presence:

- University of Manchester Academia.edu profile (JRWoodwardPhD)
- Fuller Theological Seminary (Adjunct Professor, Doctor of Global Leadership cohort starting Spring 2025)
- Central Seminary (Adjunct Professor)
- Missio Seminary (Adjunct Professor)

Content Distribution

Books: 3 published books spanning missional culture, church as movement, and leadership

- "Creating a Missional Culture" (IVP, 2012)
- "The Church as Movement" (IVP, 2016, co-authored)
- "The Scandal of Leadership" (100 Movements Publishing, 2023, based on Ph.D. research)

Organizational Content: Training materials, resources for church planters (V3), missional theology and practice resources (Missio Alliance), conference materials (Praxis Gathering)

Academic Content: Research papers and articles (Academia.edu), course materials at multiple seminaries, Ph.D. research published as book

Conference Speaking: Exponential conference speaker profile confirmed, other conferences to be verified

Social Media: Presence to be verified (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube)

Platform Distribution

Content distributed across:

- Personal website (jrwoodward.com)
- Multiple organizational websites (V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)
- Publisher websites (IVP, 100 Movements Publishing)
- Academic institution websites (Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary)
- Academic platforms (Academia.edu)
- Conference platforms (Exponential)
- Potential social media platforms (to be verified)

Content Landscape

Content Forms

Books: 3 published works spanning missional culture, church as movement, and leadership

- Publication span: 2012-2023
- Most recent: 2023 ("The Scandal of Leadership")

Organizational Resources: Training materials (V3), missional theology resources (Missio Alliance), conference materials (Praxis Gathering)

Academic Content: Research papers and articles (Academia.edu), course materials at multiple seminaries, Ph.D. research published as book

Conference Content: Speaking engagements (Exponential confirmed, others to be verified)

To Be Verified: Blog content, articles, video content, podcast content, newsletter content, social media content

Content Themes

Primary Themes:

1. Missional Culture & Church Planting
2. Church as Movement
3. Leadership and Power Dynamics
4. Community Formation & Discipleship
5. Boundary-Crossing Mission
6. Integration of Theory and Practice
7. Missional Theology

Theological Focus: Missional theology, church as movement, leadership theology, practical theology, church planting theology

Movement Focus: Church planting movements, missional movements, movement training, movement practice

Content Organization

Personal Brand: jrwoodward.com (personal website)

Organizational Platforms: V3 Church Planting Movement, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering

Academic Platforms: Academia.edu, Fuller Theological Seminary, Central Seminary, Missio Seminary

Publisher Platforms: InterVarsity Press, 100 Movements Publishing

Content Strategy: Clear thematic consistency across books (missional culture → church as movement → leadership), integration of academic research and practical experience, multiple platforms for different audiences

Discoverability Assessment

SEO Indicators

Website SEO: jrwoodward.com (to be verified)

- Title tags, meta descriptions, URL structure to be verified

Content Indexing:

- Books indexed on publisher sites (to be verified)
- Academic work indexed on Academia.edu (confirmed)
- Website content indexing (to be verified)

Social Sharing Indicators

- Social media presence (to be verified)
- Social sharing capabilities (to be verified)

- Social engagement (to be verified)

Backlinks and References

Potential Backlinks:

- Missio Alliance references
- V3 Church Planting Movement references
- Seminary references
- Conference references (Exponential)
- Publisher references (IVP, 100 Movements)

References from Other Sites: To be verified

Domain Authority Indicators

Personal Website: jrwoodward.com (to be verified)

Organizational Websites: V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering (to be verified)

Academic Platforms: Academia.edu, seminary sites (to be verified)

Gap Analysis

Embodied Work vs. Digital Expression

Embodied Work Indicators:

- Over 30 years of church planting experience
- National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement (training church planters)
- Co-founder of Missio Alliance and Praxis Gathering
- Adjunct professor at multiple seminaries
- Board service on multiple organizations
- Conference speaking (Exponential and others)
- 3 published books
- Ph.D. research published as book

Digital Expression Analysis:

- Books available in digital format (to be verified)
- Book content expanded online (to be verified)
- Conference talks transcribed and published (to be verified)
- Seminary lectures available online (to be verified)
- Training materials available digitally (to be verified)
- Academic papers available online (Academia.edu - confirmed)

Primary Gaps Identified

Content Repurposing Opportunities:

- Books → articles/courses (to be verified)
- Teaching → articles/courses (to be verified)
- Training → articles/courses (to be verified)
- Research → practical content (partially done: Ph.D. research → book)

Content Connection Gaps:

- Books vs. articles (to be verified)
- Academic vs. practical (to be verified)
- Organizational vs. personal (to be verified)
- Platform fragmentation (to be verified)

Content Series Gaps:

- Series development from books (to be verified)
- Series development from teaching (to be verified)
- Series development from training (to be verified)

Digital Amplification Opportunities:

- Conference talks → articles/courses
- Seminary teaching → articles/courses
- Training materials → articles/courses
- 30+ years experience → case studies/articles

Discoverability Gaps:

- SEO optimization (to be verified)
- Platform fragmentation affecting discoverability
- Content indexing (to be verified)

Opportunities for Digital Amplification

From Embodied Work:

- Conference talks → articles/courses
- Seminary teaching → articles/courses
- Training materials → articles/courses
- 30+ years church planting experience → case studies/articles

From Existing Content:

- Books → article series
- Books → courses
- Books → video series
- Academic research → practical content

Content Ecosystem:

- Connect all platforms
- Create unified content ecosystem
- Develop content series across forms

Movemental Opportunities**What Movemental Would Change****Content Organization:**

- All content unified in one platform
- Clear content interconnection and cross-referencing
- Easy content discovery and navigation

Content Creation:

- Easier content repurposing (teaching → articles, books → courses)
- Built-in series development tools
- Multiple content forms in one platform

Content Distribution:

- Unified distribution across all content forms
- Network effects for content discovery
- Better SEO and discoverability

Revenue Generation:

- Direct revenue from subscriptions, courses, books
- Not dependent on publishers/organizations
- Multiple revenue streams in one platform

Analytics and Insights:

- Unified analytics across all content
- Better understanding of audience engagement
- Data-driven content decisions

What Would Remain the Same**Content Ownership:**

- All content remains JR Woodward's
- Full control over content creation and distribution
- No change to content ownership

Voice and Style:

- Academic-practical integration remains
- Movement-focused approach remains
- Leadership-focused approach remains
- Integration of theory and practice remains

Theological Positions:

- Missional theology orientation remains
- Church planting focus remains
- Movement-oriented ecclesiology remains
- Leadership critique remains

Existing Content:

- All existing books remain as published
- All existing content remains accessible
- No requirement to change existing content

Relationships and Networks:

- Relationships with V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering remain intact
- Seminary teaching roles remain
- Board service remains
- Conference speaking remains

Organizational Roles:

- National Director role (V3) remains
- Co-founder roles (Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering) remain
- Adjunct professor roles remain
- Board service remains

Professional Identity:

- Church planter identity remains
- Author identity remains
- Missiologist identity remains
- Academic identity remains
- Movement leader identity remains

Specific Opportunities for JR Woodward**High-Impact Opportunities:**

1. **Content Unification:** Unify all content in Movemental platform, connect books, articles, courses, videos in one ecosystem
2. **Content Repurposing:** Repurpose books into article series and courses, repurpose teaching into articles and courses, repurpose training into courses and articles
3. **Series Development:** Develop series from books (missional culture, church as movement, leadership), develop series from teaching (seminary courses, training), develop series from experience (church planting, leadership)
4. **Network Effects:** Leverage network effects for content discovery, cross-reference with other Movemental users, collaborative content opportunities
5. **Revenue Generation:** Direct revenue from subscriptions, courses, books, multiple revenue streams in one platform

Medium-Impact Opportunities:

1. **Content Expansion:** Expand book themes into multiple content forms, expand teaching themes into articles/courses, expand training themes into content
2. **Content Forms:** Add video content (teaching, book discussions), add podcast content (own podcast, series), add newsletter content (regular newsletter)
3. **Analytics and Insights:** Unified analytics across all content, better understanding of audience engagement, data-driven content decisions

Low-Impact Opportunities:

1. **Content Optimization:** SEO optimization for all content, content indexing improvements, search visibility improvements
2. **Community Engagement:** Community features around content, discussion and engagement tools, collaborative content opportunities

Network Effect Potential

Content Discovery:

- Network effects for content discovery
- Cross-referencing with other Movemental users
- Collaborative content opportunities

Audience Growth:

- Network effects for audience growth
- Cross-promotion with other Movemental users
- Community engagement around content

Content Amplification:

- Network effects for content amplification
- Sharing and engagement across network
- Viral potential for content

What We Will NOT Do

Content Boundaries

- Will not change existing content
- Will not alter theological positions
- Will not modify voice or style
- Will not replace existing relationships
- Will not change organizational roles

Platform Boundaries

- Will not require leaving existing platforms

- Will not require changing existing content
- Will not require abandoning existing relationships
- Will not require changing professional identity

Control Boundaries

- All content remains JR Woodward's
- Full control over content creation and distribution
- No requirement to change existing content
- No requirement to abandon existing platforms

Research Notes

Verified Information

- Personal website: jrwoodward.com (confirmed active)
- Academia.edu profile: JRWoodwardPhD (confirmed active)
- Exponential speaker profile (confirmed)
- Books: 3 published books confirmed
- Organizations: V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering (confirmed)
- Academic roles: Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary (confirmed)
- Board service: Reliant Mission, Movement Leaders Collective, Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council (confirmed)
- Ph.D.: University of Manchester (confirmed)
- M.A.: Fuller Theological Seminary (confirmed)

Information to Verify

- Social media presence (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube)
- Blog content on personal website
- Article publications
- Video/podcast content
- Newsletter presence
- Amazon/Goodreads author pages
- Specific content volumes and frequencies
- Conference speaking details
- Training materials content
- Course materials content

Research Limitations

- Research based on publicly available information only
 - Some information may be outdated or incomplete
 - Private/gated content not accessed
 - Some platforms may require additional verification
 - Detailed platform analysis needed for complete picture
-

Research conducted: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Sources: See sources.md

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: JR Woodward

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-13

Confidence: HIGH

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Confidence	Source
Full Legal Name	Gailand Woodward Jr.	VERIFIED	University of Manchester Research Explorer (PhD thesis record lists "Gailand Woodward Jr")
Known As / Goes By	JR Woodward; "J.R. Woodward" (in publications); @dreamawakener (social media handle)	VERIFIED	jrwoodward.com , X/Twitter , IVP author page
Born	Unknown (no public birth date found)	UNVERIFIED	--
Birthplace	Unknown	UNVERIFIED	--
Current Location	Washington, DC area (ministry bios); mailing address on CV (2026) : Lynnwood, WA	PARTIAL	DC: about.me/jrwoodward , Awakenings Gathering bio . WA: pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf cover block.
Previous Location	East Hollywood / Los Angeles, CA (served on East Hollywood Neighborhood Council)	VERIFIED	Missio Alliance bio , Theology in the Raw podcast
Previous Location	Blacksburg, VA (Virginia Tech area, founded NLCF in 1989)	VERIFIED	Wikipedia: NLCF , churchasmovement.com
Nationality	American (presumed)	LIKELY	All institutional affiliations are US-based
Primary Role	Church planter, author, missiologist, National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement	VERIFIED	Missio Alliance , 100Movements , jrwoodward.com
Primary Organization	V3 Church Planting Movement	VERIFIED	Multiple sources
Professional email (CV)	jr@thev3movement.org	VERIFIED	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Phone (CV)	202-731-7468	VERIFIED	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf

Disambiguation

JR Woodward (Gailand Woodward Jr.) is a distinctive figure in the missional church movement. There are no significant public-figure name collisions that would cause confusion, though note:

1. **JR Woodward (church planter, missiologist)** -- THIS IS OUR SUBJECT. National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement, author of *Creating a Missional Culture*, co-founder of Missio Alliance, PhD from University of Manchester. Known online as @dreamawakener.

2. **Bob Woodward (journalist)** -- Unrelated. The famous Watergate journalist and Washington Post associate editor.
3. **Various other Woodwards** -- No other "JR Woodward" with a significant public profile in Christian ministry or missiology.

Reliable disambiguation modifiers: "missional," "V3," "church planter," "Creating a Missional Culture," "Missio Alliance," "@dreamawakener," "polycentric leadership."

Education

Institution	Degree	Field	Year	Source
University of Manchester (UK)	Ph.D.	Thesis: "Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers"	Awarded June 2020	University of Manchester Research Explorer ; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Fuller Theological Seminary	M.A.	Missional Leadership; thesis Equippers as Environmentalist: Re-imaging Leadership in Today's Western Church (advisor Dr. Robert Freeman)	June 2011	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Radford University	B.S.	Psychology	May 1987	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf

PhD Details:

- Department: School of Arts, Languages and Cultures; research carried out at Nazarene Theological College, Manchester (title page)
- **Supervision & examination (CV):** Supervisor Dr. Phil Meadows; internal examiner Dr. Joseph Wood; external examiner Prof. Wilbert Shenk
- **Thesis acknowledgements** also thank Dwight Swanson and NTC colleagues for feedback — not the same as the formal examination board listed on the CV
- Final thesis word count: **80,385** (title page)
- The thesis was later published in adapted form as The Scandal of Leadership (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)

Career Timeline

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
1989–2002	Founding pastor	NLCF at Virginia Tech (Great Commission Ministries) — CV: 24 to ~1,200; 500+ new Christians; 40+ to full-time ministry via Reliant; eight daughter churches	Wikipedia: NLCE; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
1998–2005	National Leadership Team (then Reliant board from 2004)	Great Commission Ministries / Reliant Mission	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
2002–2012	Co-founder, pastor, coach	Kairos Los Angeles — CV: 48 people from Blacksburg; three LA-area plants + Antelope Valley; polycentric leadership; exited into Ecclesia Network	Missio Alliance; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
2003–~2018	Church planter / community leader	East Hollywood, Los Angeles (East Hollywood Neighborhood Council)	Missio Alliance , multiple sources
2007–2012	Co-founder & director	Solis Foundation — Turkana, Kenya; micro-enterprise formation	MWRC; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
2007–2012	Co-founder & West Coast director (later national role for leadership formation)	Ecclesia Network — CV: four churches at start, ~30 churches / ~4,000 people at departure	MWRC; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
2012–present	Co-founded; governing board	Missio Alliance (first national gathering ~700 leaders, with J.R. Rozko per CV)	Missio Alliance; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
2012	Published Creating a Missional Culture	InterVarsity Press (Forge Partnership Books); foreword by Alan Hirsch	IVP
~2015	Co-founded	Praxis Gathering (annual missional practitioners conference)	V3 Movement
2013–present	National Director	V3 Church Planting Movement — eight-month cohorts, coaches, grants; CV cites 600+ leaders in first ten years and a goal of 600 more in the next five (other materials round cumulative training to 1,000+)	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf ; Baptist News Global
2016	Published The Church as Movement	InterVarsity Press; co-authored with Dan White Jr.; foreword by Alan Hirsch	Amazon
2020	Ph.D. awarded	University of Manchester (UK)	University of Manchester
2023	Published The Scandal of Leadership	100 Movements Publishing; based on PhD thesis	100Movements

Year(s)	Role	Organization	Source
Present	Adjunct Professor	Central Seminary, Missio Seminary, American Evangelical University, Capital Seminary, Fuller (directed studies), SOMA University — see CV for course list	Missio Alliance; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Present	Board / fellowships	Missio Alliance (governing board), Reliant Mission, Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council, Fuller Church Planting Initiative, Kineo, Movement Leaders Collective, MWRC associate fellow, COV&R, Gospel & Our Culture Network, American Society of Missiology — dates: primary-documents.md	Missio Alliance; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Present	Serves locally	District Church, Washington DC	Awakenings Gathering

Family & Personal

- **Spouse/Family:** No public information found. Woodward's bios and interviews do not reference a spouse or children. This is a gap in available public data, not a confirmed absence.
- **Self-description:** "Church planter, activist, and missiologist" ([MWRC](#))
- **Personal handle:** "Dream Awakener" -- used consistently across Twitter (@dreamawakener), Flickr, and other platforms. Reflects his APEST self-identification as an apostle ("dream awakener" is his term for the apostolic function).
- **Interests:** Surfing, traveling, reading, skateboarding, photography, film, and attending the Sundance Film Festival whenever possible ([Missio Alliance](#), [churchasmovement.com](#))
- **East Hollywood engagement:** Served on the East Hollywood Neighborhood Council, reflecting his commitment to locally-rooted, incarnational presence ([Missio Alliance](#))
- **International work:** Co-founded the Solis Foundation to walk with the poor in Lodwar, Kenya ([MWRC](#))

Key Relationships & Collaborators

Person	Relationship	Source
Alan Hirsch	Wrote foreword for both Creating a Missional Culture and The Church as Movement; mutual respect within missional movement	Amazon , IVP
Dan White Jr.	Co-author of The Church as Movement; co-leads V3 with Woodward	Amazon , Theology in the Raw
Jesse Eubanks	Co-leads V3 alongside Woodward and White	Theology in the Raw
David Fitch	Contributor/endorser of The Scandal of Leadership	Amazon
Amos Yong	Contributor/endorser of The Scandal of Leadership	Amazon
Preston Sprinkle	Hosted Woodward on Theology in the Raw podcast	Theology in the Raw
Phil Meadows	PhD supervisor at University of Manchester	Manchester Research Explorer ; thesis acknowledgements; CV
Joseph Wood; Wilbert Shenk	PhD internal / external examiners	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Dwight Swanson	NTC colleague — academic feedback on thesis (acknowledgements)	PhD thesis PDF

Biography

[docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/profile/biography.md](#)

Biography: JR Woodward

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-13

Narrative Biography

JR Woodward is a church planter, missiologist, and movement leader who has spent more than three decades establishing missional-incarnational communities across the United States. As the National Director of the V3 Church Planting Movement, co-founder of Missio Alliance and the Praxis Gathering, and author of three books on missional culture, movement ecclesiology, and leadership, Woodward has become one of the most trusted practitioner-scholars in the North American missional church movement. His work is distinguished by the rare integration of grassroots church planting experience with rigorous academic research -- his most recent book, *The Scandal of Leadership* (2023), is a direct outgrowth of his PhD dissertation at the University of Manchester.

Woodward's church planting journey began in 1989 when he founded New Life Christian Fellowship (NLCF) at Virginia Tech in Blacksburg, Virginia, as part of Great Commission Ministries. In the first five years of that plant, he experienced both the loneliness of pioneering leadership and the difficulty of cultivating missional hearts in an inherited congregation. NLCF grew to become a significant campus and community presence; by 2007, the church had branched into two congregations -- one serving Virginia Tech students and another serving the broader New River Valley community. During the Virginia Tech shooting of 2007, the church played a visible role in the campus community's response, with two members among those killed and ten others directly connected to the church.

Around 2003, Woodward and other NLCF members planted Kairos Los Angeles, a network of neighborhood churches in the East Hollywood area. This move to Los Angeles deepened Woodward's commitment to incarnational, neighborhood-rooted ministry. He lived in East Hollywood and served on the East Hollywood Neighborhood Council, embodying his conviction that the church should be embedded in the fabric of its local community rather than operating as an institution set apart from it. He co-founded several additional organizations during this period: the Solis Foundation (focused on walking alongside the poor in Lodwar, Kenya), the Ecclesia Network, and eventually Missio Alliance and the Praxis Gathering -- an annual conference of over three hundred on-the-ground missional practitioners.

Woodward pursued academic work alongside his planting. He holds a B.S. in psychology from Radford University (1987), an M.A. from Fuller Theological Seminary in missional leadership (2011) with a thesis titled *Equippers as Environmentalist: Re-imaging Leadership in Today's Western Church*, and in 2020 completed a PhD at the University of Manchester (research based at Nazarene Theological College) supervised by Phil Meadows, examined internally by Joseph Wood and externally by Wilbert Shenk. His dissertation, *Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers* (~80,400 words), synthesized Walter Wink, René Girard, and William Stringfellow to develop an imitation-based framework for domineering leadership and Christ-shaped alternative. Colleagues including Dwight Swanson at NTC gave formative feedback on the project. The work was published in adapted form as *The Scandal of Leadership* in 2023. His first book, *Creating a Missional Culture* (IVP, 2012), introduced the concept of polycentric leadership and the five "culture creators" -- Dream Awakeners, Heart Revealers, Story Tellers, Soul Healers, and Light Givers -- as a practical application of Ephesians 4 ministry. His second, *The Church as Movement* (IVP, 2016), co-authored with Dan White Jr. and with a foreword by Alan Hirsch, outlined eight competencies for creating movemental churches rooted in neighborhoods.

Today, Woodward serves as National Director of the V3 Church Planting Movement, where he trains church planters across North America and internationally in what he calls "grounded spirituality, missions theology, and movement ecclesiology." He leads V3 collaboratively with Dan White Jr. and Jesse Eubanks, embodying the shared leadership model he advocates. He serves as an adjunct professor at Central Seminary, Missio Seminary, and American Evangelical University, and sits on multiple boards including Missio Alliance, Reliant Mission, Fuller's Global Mission Advisory Council, Fuller's Church Initiatives Board, and KINEO. He currently serves locally with the District Church in Washington, DC. Outside of ministry, Woodward is a surfer, skateboarder, photographer, and film enthusiast who attends the Sundance Film Festival whenever possible.

Origin & Formation

JR Woodward's full legal name is Gailand Woodward Jr., as recorded in his University of Manchester PhD thesis. No public information is available about his birth date, birthplace, or early life. His career in ministry began in 1989 with the founding of NLCF at Virginia Tech, suggesting he was likely in his twenties at that time. His about.me profile and self-description consistently emphasize his identity as someone who "encourages people to participate in God's renewal of all things" -- a missional and activist orientation that has been consistent from his earliest public work.

His formative years as a church planter at Virginia Tech shaped his understanding of the difficulties of cultivating missional culture. He has spoken publicly about the loneliness of those early years and the challenge of inheriting a congregation without a missional heart. This experience became the laboratory for the frameworks he would later develop in *Creating a Missional Culture*.

Key Relationships & Influences

Person	Relationship	Significance
Alan Hirsch	Mentor-figure, endorser	Wrote the foreword for both <i>Creating a Missional Culture</i> and <i>The Church as Movement</i> . Hirsch praised Woodward's work as containing "missiological insights that only an apostolically inclined leader can bring." Both operate in the missional-incarnational stream; Woodward applies and extends Hirsch's APEST framework.
Dan White Jr.	Co-author, co-leader	Co-authored <i>The Church as Movement</i> ; co-leads V3 alongside Woodward. Both share commitment to neighborhood-rooted, movement-oriented church planting.
Jesse Eubanks	V3 co-leader	Collaborates with Woodward and White in leading V3 Movement.
Walter Wink	Intellectual influence (posthumous)	Wink's trilogy on "the Powers" (naming, unmasking, engaging) is foundational to Woodward's theology of institutional power.
Rene Girard	Intellectual influence (posthumous)	Girard's mimetic desire theory is central to Woodward's PhD thesis and <i>The Scandal of Leadership</i> .
William Stringfellow	Intellectual influence (posthumous)	Stringfellow's framework of Image, Institution, and Ideology shapes Woodward's analysis of how powers manifest in church systems.
Oscar Romero	Exemplar figure	Used as a primary case study of Christlike, kenotic leadership in <i>The Scandal of Leadership</i> .
Phil Meadows	PhD supervisor	University of Manchester — primary supervisor for the doctoral thesis.
Joseph Wood; Wilbert Shenk	PhD examiners	Internal and external examiners (per CV).
Dwight Swanson	Doctoral interlocutor	Nazarene Theological College colleague; thanked in thesis acknowledgements for academic feedback.
David Fitch	Theological ally	Contributed to <i>The Scandal of Leadership</i> ; fellow missional theologian.
Preston Sprinkle	Platform amplifier	Hosted Woodward on <i>Theology in the Raw</i> podcast for extended conversation on leadership and power.

In Their Own Words

"The unholy use of power has damaged the church's witness, crippled her mission, and aided her decline." -- *The Scandal of Leadership* (2023), via [100Movements](#)

"Will we become a scandal to those who look to us as leaders, or will we choose to imitate the scandalous way of Christ?" -- *The Scandal of Leadership* (2023), via [100Movements](#)

"Missional communities are a sent people who connect with God, do life together and receive power from the Holy Spirit to partner with God to accomplish his purposes in our neighborhoods and in the world." -- Verge Network article, via vergenetwork.org

"If we choose not to imitate Christ, by default we are choosing to imitate the powers." -- cited in Goodreads reviews of The Scandal of Leadership

"Not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers." -- PhD thesis core argument, via [University of Manchester Research Explorer](#)

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: JR Woodward

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-12

Core Thesis

The Western church has adopted worldly patterns of power and domination that damage its witness, cripple its mission, and fuel the epidemic of fallen leaders. Recovery requires two interrelated moves: (1) cultivating a polycentric, shared leadership culture rooted in the full fivefold ministry of Ephesians 4, and (2) practicing a self-emptying spirituality grounded in the imitation of Christ rather than the imitation of the Powers. The church is fundamentally a movement -- neighborhood-rooted, discipleship-fueled, boundary-crossing -- and its leadership must reflect the kenotic, communal character of the triune God.

Theological Tradition

Primary: Missional-incarnational theology, rooted in post-Christendom missiology and practical theology

Secondary influences: Anabaptist-adjacent ecclesiology (emphasis on community, peace, incarnational presence), Wesleyan-Methodist tradition (PhD at University of Manchester through Nazarene Theological College / Manchester Wesley Research Centre), liberation theology motifs (Oscar Romero as exemplar, Solis Foundation work with the poor in Kenya), and charismatic movement dynamics (studied rather than personally claimed)

Denominational context: Has operated across denominational lines throughout his career. Founded NLCF as part of Great Commission Ministries; V3 has ties to Virginia Baptists. Not bound to a single tradition; works with church planters from multiple backgrounds.

Key Frameworks & Models

Framework	Description	Where Developed
Polycentric Leadership	Leadership structured around "many centers that interrelate" rather than hierarchical (top-down) or flat (undifferentiated) models. Reflects the communal nature of the triune God. Activates the priesthood of all believers more effectively than CEO-pastor models.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)
Five Culture Creators	Woodward's practical application of Ephesians 4:11 APEST gifts, each renamed to emphasize their culture-shaping function: Apostle = Dream Awakener , Prophet = Heart Revealer , Evangelist = Story Teller , Pastor = Soul Healer , Teacher = Light Giver . Each creates a distinct environment within missional culture.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)
Five Environments	Five cultural environments that a healthy missional community cultivates: (1) Learning, (2) Healing, (3) Welcoming, (4) Liberating, (5) Thriving. Each environment corresponds to one of the five culture creators.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)
The Cultural Web	Six interconnected dimensions that shape congregational and neighborhood culture: Language, Artifacts, Rituals, Ethics, Institutions, Guiding Narratives. Leaders must understand all six to cultivate missional culture.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)
Five Cultural Megashifts	Five macro-level transitions that missional leaders must navigate: (1) Media: print/broadcast to digital, (2) Philosophy: modernity to postmodernity, (3) Science: classical to emergent, (4) Geography: rural to urban, (5) Religion: Christendom to post-Christendom.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)
Eight Movement Competencies	Eight necessary competencies for creating movemental, neighborhood-rooted churches. Framework for church planter training in V3.	The Church as Movement (2016, with Dan White Jr.)
Four Spaces of Belonging	A framework for understanding how discipleship and mission happen across four relational spaces of varying intimacy and size.	Articles and teaching; V3 Movement
Theology of the Powers	A robust synthesis drawing on Walter Wink (spiritual powers embodied in systems), Rene Girard (mimetic desire and scapegoating), and William Stringfellow (Image, Institution, Ideology as categories of how powers operate). Argues that principalities and powers are created good but fallen and redeemable, while Satan/demonic forces are emergent realities without redemptive possibility.	PhD thesis (2020), The Scandal of Leadership (2023)
Imitation-Based Leadership Framework	Leaders are inescapably imitative beings (per Girard). When they imitate worldly power models, they become domineering; when they imitate Christ's kenotic self-emptying, they become life-giving servants. "Not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers."	PhD thesis (2020), The Scandal of Leadership (2023)
Three Contours of Leadership	Framework for diagnosing leadership health: (1) Identity -- who leaders are, (2) Praxis -- how they lead and relate, (3) Telos -- what	The Scandal of Leadership (2023)

Framework	Description	Where Developed
	they value and pursue. Domineering leaders malform across all three.	

Distinctive Positions

- **Polycentric over hierarchical or flat:** Woodward rejects both top-down hierarchy (CEO-pastor) and undifferentiated flat structures, advocating instead for multiple interrelated centers of leadership. This reflects Trinitarian theology -- God's own communal nature.
- **APEST as culture creators, not just roles:** The fivefold gifts are not merely leadership offices but culture-shaping vocations. Each creates a distinct environment (learning, healing, welcoming, liberating, thriving) necessary for a fully missional community.
- **Domineering leadership is a theological problem, not just a psychological one:** The epidemic of fallen church leaders cannot be adequately diagnosed through psychology or management theory alone. It requires a theology of the Powers that understands how spiritual forces operate through institutional systems.
- **Mimetic desire shapes leaders unconsciously:** Drawing on Girard, Woodward argues that desires are not self-generated but are formed through models. Leaders who unconsciously absorb worldly models of power will inevitably reproduce domination, regardless of their stated theology.
- **Church as neighborhood-rooted movement:** The church should be locally embedded, not institutionally detached. Woodward himself served on a neighborhood council; V3 trains planters to root churches in specific neighborhoods.
- **Kenotic leadership as the alternative:** The solution to domineering leadership is not better management but self-emptying (kenotic) spirituality that reshapes desires through the imitation of Christ. Oscar Romero serves as Woodward's primary exemplar.
- **Christendom's corporate adoption distorts ecclesial practice:** Woodward traces how Christianity moved from "a fellowship in Palestine, a philosophy in Greece, an institution in Rome, a government in Europe, and an enterprise in America" -- and argues that the corporate-enterprise model must be dismantled in favor of movement ecclesiology.
- **"Being" precedes "doing" in mission:** Missional identity must be established before missional action. God changes people by changing their identity, their sense of self-definition, before calling them to particular tasks.

Intellectual Genealogy

Shaped by:

- **Walter Wink** -- Theology of the Powers; naming, unmasking, and engaging principalities embodied in systems; the "Domination System" as a spiritual-structural reality
- **Rene Girard** -- Mimetic desire theory; triangular desire (we desire what our models desire);

scapegoat mechanism; Jesus as the one who reveals and disrupts the scapegoating pattern

- **William Stringfellow** -- Prophetic resistance to the Powers; analysis of how powers manifest through Image, Institution, and Ideology; the "power of resurrection" against the "power of death"
- **Oscar Romero** -- Exemplar of kenotic, Christlike leadership under persecution; positive model of resisting the Powers through self-emptying service
- **Lesslie Newbigin** -- Post-Christendom missiology (shared influence with Alan Hirsch)
- **James K.A. Smith** -- Cultural liturgies and the formation of desire (referenced in reviews of Creating a Missional Culture)
- **Henri Nouwen** -- Spiritual formation and pastoral identity (cited in Creating a Missional Culture)
- **Miroslav Volf** -- Theology of embrace and reconciliation (cited in Creating a Missional Culture)

In conversation with:

- Alan Hirsch (closest senior collaborator; wrote forewords for two of Woodward's books; shared APEST/missional movement framework)
- Dan White Jr. (co-author, co-leader of V3)
- David Fitch (fellow missional theologian; contributor to The Scandal of Leadership)
- Amos Yong (Pentecostal theologian; contributor to The Scandal of Leadership)
- Preston Sprinkle (extended podcast conversation on leadership and power)
- Jesse Eubanks (V3 co-leader)

Pushes back against:

- **CEO-pastor / hierarchical leadership:** The concentration of power in a single senior leader, which Woodward sees as a corporate import that distorts biblical ecclesiology and creates conditions for abuse.
- **Attractional church model:** The "come and see" paradigm that builds institutions rather than embedding in neighborhoods. Woodward advocates incarnational, "go and be" presence.
- **Surface-level diagnosis of leadership failure:** Approaches that treat fallen leaders as individual moral failures without examining the systemic, spiritual, and mimetic forces that shape desire and behavior.
- **Christendom assumptions:** The default assumption that the church occupies a privileged cultural position. Woodward works from a post-Christendom, missionary posture.
- **Shepherd-Teacher dominance:** Like Hirsch, Woodward argues that the Western church has marginalized apostolic, prophetic, and evangelistic functions in favor of pastoral care and teaching -- creating an imbalanced, maintenance-oriented church.

Theological Evolution

Woodward's theology has developed through three distinct phases, each building on the previous:

1. **Missional culture phase (2003-2012):** Rooted in his Virginia Tech and Los Angeles church planting experience, Woodward developed his practical theology of polycentric leadership, the five culture creators, and the cultural web. *Creating a Missional Culture* (2012) is the primary output. The focus is on how to build missional communities from the inside out -- culture as the unseen force that shapes a church's effectiveness more than vision or strategy.
2. **Movement ecclesiology phase (2012-2016):** Working with Dan White Jr. and deepening his involvement with V3, Woodward expanded from individual church culture to the dynamics of church-planting movements. *The Church as Movement* (2016) outlines the competencies needed for movement multiplication. The shift is from "how do we make one church missional?" to "how do we catalyze a movement of missional churches?"
3. **Power, desire, and imitation phase (2016-2023):** Woodward's PhD research marked a significant deepening into the theological roots of leadership failure. Drawing on Wink, Girard, and Stringfellow, he moved from the practical-constructive (what healthy leadership looks like) to the diagnostic-prophetic (why leaders fall and what spiritual forces are at work). *The Scandal of Leadership* (2023) represents his most theologically sophisticated work. The turn toward desire formation and mimetic theory adds a dimension absent from his earlier work.

Throughout all three phases, Woodward's commitment to neighborhood-rooted, incarnational, movement-oriented ecclesiology has remained constant. The progression is from practical culture-building to movement-catalyzing to deep diagnostic theology -- each layer adding depth to the same fundamental vision.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/profile/calling-profile.md

status: empty

sidebar: vocational-profile

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: JR Woodward

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-12

Sources analyzed: Verge Network articles, Missio Alliance articles (Parts II and III of The Scandal of Leadership series), V3 Movement blog posts, Theology in the Raw podcast appearance, Faith in a Fresh Vibe podcast appearance, Goodreads reviews of all three books, book descriptions and sample chapters.

Voice Summary

JR Woodward writes and speaks as a practitioner-scholar -- someone whose theological frameworks emerge from decades of grassroots church planting rather than from the academy alone. His voice is characterized by methodical, framework-heavy thinking delivered in an accessible but sometimes dense register. He is more systematic builder than prophetic provocateur: where Alan Hirsch leads with urgency and disruption, Woodward leads with careful diagnosis and structured alternatives. His tone is pastoral-academic -- warm toward fellow practitioners, sharp toward systems of domination, and consistently oriented toward practical application. He is at his most distinctive when renaming familiar concepts with evocative language (apostles become "dream awakeners," prophets become "heart revealers") and when integrating continental philosophy (Girard, Wink) with hands-on church planting wisdom.

Writing Characteristics

Dimension	Assessment
Register	Accessible academic -- integrates scholarly concepts (mimetic desire, kenosis, principalities and powers, cultural web) with clear definitions and practical applications. More academic than Hirsch's popular writing; more accessible than a typical dissertation. Varies by context: Missio Alliance articles skew more scholarly; V3 Movement posts skew more pastoral-practical.
Complexity	Moderate to High -- builds multi-layered frameworks with systematic rigor. His books are framework-dense: five culture creators, five environments, six cultural web dimensions, five megashifts, eight movement competencies. Some reviewers note the density can become repetitive or jargon-heavy ("polycentric," "telos," "mimetic desire"). His PhD-derived work (The Scandal of Leadership) is the most complex; Creating a Missional Culture is the most accessible.
Tone	Diagnostic-Constructive -- combines careful analysis of what is wrong (domineering leadership, corporate church models, power abuse) with structured proposals for what could be (polycentric leadership, kenotic spirituality, missional culture). Less prophetically urgent than Hirsch; more methodically constructive. Occasionally passionate when addressing leadership abuse.
Storytelling	Moderate -- uses concrete examples and analogies (Swiss government structure, jazz ensembles, geese flight formations) to illustrate abstract concepts. Less reliant on personal narrative than Hirsch. Historical examples (Oscar Romero, early church, Bill Hybels/Mark Driscoll as cautionary tales) serve as evidence for theological arguments.
Humor	Minimal in writing -- Woodward's written work is earnest and substantive. No significant use of humor, irony, or self-deprecation in published articles or book excerpts. Spoken interviews show slightly more warmth but still primarily substantive.
Scripture Use	Strategic and foundational -- Ephesians 4:11-13 is the anchor text for his entire APEST/culture-creators framework. Uses Jesus' words (John 20:21, Matthew 5:14-16) and Pauline epistles to ground identity before action. Reads Paul through a Girardian lens (Philippians as kenotic leadership text). Does not proof-text; integrates biblical theology with sociological and philosophical argument. Emphasizes Hebraic reading: identity before imperative, narrative before proposition.

Signature Patterns

- **Recurring phrases:**
- "missional-incarnational" (his signature compound descriptor, shared with the broader movement)
- "dream awakener" (his self-identifier and term for the apostolic function)
- "polycentric leadership" (multiple centers that interrelate)
- "tight-knit community, life-forming discipleship, locally-rooted presence, boundary-crossing mission" (his four-part descriptor for healthy churches; appears verbatim across multiple bios)
- "a sign, foretaste, and instrument of God's kingdom" (his ecclesiological vision statement)

- "grounded spirituality, missions theology, and movement ecclesiology" (his three-part descriptor for V3's approach)
- "the Powers" (capitalized; spiritual forces embodied in institutional systems)
- "not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers" (his central thesis from PhD work)
- "sent people" (identity-before-action framing for missional communities)
- "God's renewal of all things" (eschatological frame for mission)
- **Favorite metaphors and analogies:**
 - **Iceberg:** Surface symptoms (fallen leaders) hide deeper structural and spiritual causes beneath the waterline. Woodward consistently insists on deeper diagnosis before solutions.
 - **Cultural web:** Culture is an interconnected web of six dimensions (language, artifacts, rituals, ethics, institutions, narratives) -- pull one strand and others move.
 - **Dream awakener:** The apostle does not plant churches so much as awaken dormant dreams of God's kingdom. Evocative, poetic reframing of a role often described in purely organizational terms.
 - **Jazz ensemble:** Polycentric leadership functions like a jazz group -- multiple players with distinct voices contributing to a unified whole, rather than a conductor directing an orchestra.
 - **Geese in formation:** Shared leadership as rotating headship, each member taking turns leading.
 - **Swiss government:** Polycentric governance as an alternative to both monarchy and anarchy.
- **Argument structure:** Woodward typically builds a case through:
 1. **Careful framing** -- establishes the core question (often citing Einstein: "spend fifty-five minutes determining the proper question")
 2. **Diagnosis of the current problem** -- what the church has inherited from Christendom, corporate culture, or worldly power models
 3. **Theological grounding** -- Scripture and scholarly sources (Wink, Girard, Stringfellow) that illuminate the deeper dynamics
 4. **Framework introduction** -- a named model with clear categories (five culture creators, three contours of leadership, cultural web)
 5. **Practical implications** -- what this means for church planters, leaders, and communities
 6. **Invitation** -- a quieter, more reflective call to action than Hirsch's prophetic urgency; often framed as a question ("Will we become a scandal to those who look to us as leaders, or will we choose to imitate the scandalous way of Christ?")
- **Opening style:** Tends to open with a diagnostic observation or a framing question rather than a provocative declaration. Establishes the problem before offering the solution. More methodical than dramatic.

- **Identity-first methodology:** A consistent hallmark -- Woodward always establishes who we are (identity, sentness, calling) before describing what we do (practices, structures, strategies). "God changes us by changing our identities, our sense of self-definition."
- **Renaming as reframing:** Woodward's most distinctive rhetorical move is taking familiar theological categories and giving them fresh, evocative names. Apostles become dream awakeners; prophets become heart revealers. This is not mere branding -- it is an intentional strategy to help practitioners see familiar roles through a culture-shaping lens rather than a hierarchical one.

Sample Passages

"Missional communities are a sent people who connect with God, do life together and receive power from the Holy Spirit to partner with God to accomplish his purposes in our neighborhoods and in the world." -- [Verge Network](#)

"The unholy use of power has damaged the church's witness, crippled her mission, and aided her decline." -- The Scandal of Leadership (2023)

"Will we become a scandal to those who look to us as leaders, or will we choose to imitate the scandalous way of Christ?" -- The Scandal of Leadership (2023)

"Christianity started out in Palestine as a fellowship, became a philosophy in Greece, an institution in Rome, a government in Europe, and an enterprise in America." -- [Missio Alliance article](#) (quoting a common attribution, used to frame his argument)

"A critical but often overlooked part of that narrative is how the fall not only affected humanity but also social and cosmic realities." -- [Missio Alliance, Scandal of Leadership Part III](#)

"If we choose not to imitate Christ, by default we are choosing to imitate the powers." -- cited in multiple reviews of The Scandal of Leadership

Speaking vs. Writing

Based on podcast appearances (Theology in the Raw, Faith in a Fresh Vibe):

- **More conversational and warm:** In spoken contexts, Woodward is more relaxed and relational than in his writing. He engages with interviewers genuinely, builds on their questions, and allows for tangents that reveal his broader thinking.
- **Same systematic architecture:** Whether speaking or writing, the same frameworks (polycentric leadership, mimetic desire, the Powers) are present. He cannot help but organize ideas into categories and models.
- **More concrete examples:** In conversation, he reaches for vivid analogies (Swiss government, jazz, geese) more readily than in his denser written work.

- **Scholarly yet accessible:** Interviewers and reviewers consistently note his ability to make complex theological and philosophical concepts (Girard's mimetic theory, Wink's Powers trilogy) understandable for church practitioners. His spoken style is described as "thoughtful" and "scholarly yet accessible."
- **Less prophetically urgent than Hirsch:** Where Hirsch's spoken voice rises with passion and prophetic fire, Woodward's tends toward careful, measured analysis. He is the diagnostician rather than the prophet -- equally concerned about the same problems, but approaching them with the precision of a researcher rather than the urgency of an agitator.
- **Quiet conviction:** His spoken style carries a calm but deep conviction. He does not raise his voice or pound the table; he builds his case methodically and lets the evidence speak.

The overall effect is that Woodward's voice -- written and spoken -- is that of a builder-diagnosticsian: someone who constructs careful frameworks, names what is wrong with precision, and offers structured alternatives grounded in both Scripture and the best of contemporary scholarship. He is the architect to Hirsch's prophet.

Comparison with Alan Hirsch

Dimension	JR Woodward	Alan Hirsch
Rhetorical mode	Diagnostic-constructive	Prophetic-apostolic
Opening move	Framing question or diagnostic observation	Provocative declaration or sharp diagnosis
Framework density	Very high (5 culture creators, 5 environments, 6 cultural web dimensions, 5 megashifts, 3 contours, etc.)	High (6 mDNA elements, APEST, but fewer sub-frameworks)
Storytelling	Moderate; analogies and case studies	Heavy; personal narrative, historical movements, contemporary examples
Humor	Minimal	Occasional; dry, self-deprecating Australian humor
Urgency	Measured, methodical	High; "the church must change or die"
Intellectual sources	Continental philosophy (Girard, Wink, Stringfellow)	Anthropology (Turner), missiology (Newbigin, Allen), organic systems theory
Self-identifier	"Dream awakener," "church planter, activist, missiologist"	"Movement catalyst," prophetic-apostolic voice
Signature move	Renaming (apostle = dream awakener)	Binary contrasts ("not X but Y")
Tone toward institutions	Diagnostic; names systemic power dynamics	Prophetically critical; "institution vs. movement"

Both share the same fundamental missional-incarnational vision and both build on Ephesians 4 APEST. Woodward is the practitioner-scholar who applies and extends Hirsch's frameworks with additional academic rigor and practical specificity; Hirsch is the movement catalyst who provides the overarching prophetic vision. Their collaboration (Hirsch writing forewords for Woodward's books) reflects this complementary dynamic.

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/books.md

JR Woodward — Complete Bibliography

Catalog Date: 2026-04-12

Status: Verified from multiple sources (Amazon, Goodreads, IVP, 100 Movements, MWRC, Christianbook.com)

Authored Books

1. Creating a Missional Culture: Equipping the Church for the Sake of the World

Field	Detail
Full Title	Creating a Missional Culture: Equipping the Church for the Sake of the World
Series	Forge Partnership Books
Author	JR Woodward
Foreword	Alan Hirsch
Publisher	IVP Books (InterVarsity Press)
Publication Date	June 28, 2012
Pages	224
Format — Print	Paperback (ISBN-10: 0830836535 / ISBN-13: 978-0830836536)
Format — eBook	Kindle / ePub (ISBN-13: 978-0830866793)
Format — Audiobook	Not confirmed
Amazon URL	https://www.amazon.com/Creating-Missional-Culture-Equipping-Church/dp/0830836535
Goodreads URL	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/13645227-creating-a-missional-culture
Goodreads Rating	4.04 / 5 (242 ratings, 34 reviews)
IVP URL	https://www.ivpress.com/creating-a-missional-culture

Description: Woodward offers a radical revisioning of church structure, moving beyond incremental adjustments to propose a polycentric leadership model organized around five biblical equipping roles from Ephesians 4:11-13. He reframes these as Dream Awakeners (apostles), Heart Revealers (prophets), Story Tellers (evangelists), Soul Healers (pastors), and

Light Givers (teachers). The framework emphasizes creating missional communities equipped to engage their world rather than operating through hierarchical, personality-driven structures. Blends cultural analysis, leadership formation, congregational empowerment, and missional engagement.

2. The Church as Movement: Starting and Sustaining Missional-Incarnational Communities

Field	Detail
Full Title	The Church as Movement: Starting and Sustaining Missional-Incarnational Communities
Authors	JR Woodward and Dan White Jr.
Foreword	Alan Hirsch
Publisher	IVP Books (InterVarsity Press)
Publication Date	2016
Pages	256
Dimensions	10.00 x 7.00 inches
Format — Print	Paperback (ISBN-10: 0830841334 / ISBN-13: 978-0830841332)
Format — eBook	Kindle / ePub (ISBN-13: 978-0830893621)
Format — Audiobook	Not confirmed
Retail Price	\$31.99
Amazon URL	https://www.amazon.com/Church-Movement-Sustaining-Missional-Incarnational-Communities/dp/0830841334
Goodreads URL	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/27414517-the-church-as-movement
Goodreads Rating	4.32 / 5 (163 ratings)
IVP URL	https://www.ivpress.com/the-church-as-movement
Companion Website	https://churchasmovement.com/
Award	IVP Book of the Year 2017

Description: A practical guide to starting missional-incarnational communities reflecting the viral movement of the early New Testament church. Built around eight necessary competencies: Movement Intelligence, Polycentric Leadership, Being Disciples, Making Disciples, Missional Theology, Ecclesial Architecture, Community Formation, and Incarnational

Practices. Features an interactive format with tools, exercises, reflection questions, and activities — designed for church planting teams or discipleship groups to work through together.

3. The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church

Field	Detail
Full Title	The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church
Author	JR Woodward
Foreword	David Fitch
Afterword	Amos Yong
Publisher	100 Movements Publishing
Publication Date	April 19, 2023 (paperback); hardcover reissue August 30, 2025
Pages	418
Format — Print	Paperback / Hardcover (ISBN-10: 1955142246 / ISBN-13: 978-1955142243)
Format — eBook	Available
Format — Audiobook	Not confirmed
Amazon URL	https://www.amazon.com/Scandal-Leadership-Unmasking-Powers-Domination/dp/1955142246
Goodreads URL	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/136187930-the-scandal-of-leadership
Goodreads Rating	4.77 / 5 (73 ratings, 46 reviews)
Publisher URL	https://www.100movements.org/books/scandal-of-leadership-jr-woodward
Based on	PhD dissertation, University of Manchester (UK)

Description: Based on Woodward's PhD research, this book addresses the epidemic of leadership failures in churches by offering a comprehensive diagnosis of power abuses and the critical role of imitation. Drawing on Scripture and the scholarship of Walter Wink, Rene Girard, and William Stringfellow, as well as positive examples such as Oscar Romero, the book develops a robust theology of the Powers (Satan, the demonic, principalities and powers). The central thesis proposes an imitation-based framework: leaders either mirror Christ's self-emptying example or unconsciously replicate the fallen world's power structures.

4. ViralHope: Good News from the Urbs to the Burbs (and Everything in Between)

Field	Detail
Full Title	ViralHope: Good News from the Urbs to the Burbs (and Everything in Between)
Role	Editor
Foreword	Scot McKnight
Publisher	Ecclesia Press
Publication Date	April 4, 2010
Pages	Not confirmed
Format — Print	Paperback (ISBN-10: 0982623607 / ISBN-13: 978-0982623602)
Amazon URL	https://www.amazon.com/ViralHope-Good-Burbs-Everything-Between/dp/0982623607
Goodreads URL	https://www.goodreads.com/book/show/7996868-viralhope
Goodreads Rating	3.70 / 5 (20 ratings)

Description: An edited collection of short essays by fifty authors from around the world, each answering the question: "What is the gospel for your city?" Contributors include David Fitch, Jonathan Wilson-Hartgrove, Jon Tyson, Christine Sine, Jonathan Dodson, and others. Weaves a tapestry of the gospel across diverse urban and suburban contexts.

Forewords Written by JR Woodward

Book	Author	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13
Centering Discipleship: A Pathway for Multiplying Spectators into Mature Disciples	E. K. Strawser	IVP	2023	978-1514007068
ReMission: Rethinking How Church Leaders Create Movement	Gary Comer	Whitaker House	2018	978-1629119434
Subterranean: Why the Future of the Church Is Rootedness	Dan White Jr.	Cascade Books	2015	978-1498219556

Book Chapter Contributions

Chapter Title	Book	Publisher	Year
"Structured for Movement: How the Pandemic Reveals the Need to Restructure the Life of the Church for Disciples on Mission"	The Great Adventure of the Church in the New Normal Era	Institute for Church Growth (Seoul)	2021
"What Would God's Reign Look Like In Our Neighborhood?"	Sent to Flourish: A Guide to Planting and Multiplying Churches (ed. Len Tang, Charles E. Cotherman)	IVP Academic	2019
Contributor (specific chapter TBD)	Equip	Unknown	2013

Goodreads Author Summary

Metric	Value
Profile URL	https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/853697.J_R_Woodward
Distinct Works	11
Total Ratings	650
Total Reviews	133
Average Rating	4.25 / 5
Twitter	@dreamawakener
Member Since	January 2009

Amazon Author Page

- **URL:** <https://www.amazon.com/stores/author/B003FFHEHE>

Sources

- Amazon product pages (multiple)
- Goodreads author and book pages
- InterVarsity Press (ivpress.com)
- 100 Movements Publishing (100movements.org)
- Christianbook.com
- Manchester Wesley Research Centre (mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward)
- Barnes & Noble, AbeBooks, Booktopia

- CLC eBooks
- Google Books

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: JR Woodward

Exported from movement_leader_corpus_data.frameworks[] — on-disk SSOT for Author Profile.

Polycentric Leadership

Field	Value
Introduced	2012 (Creating a Missional Culture)
Components	Leadership as "many centers that interrelate" — neither hierarchical (top-down CEO-pastor) nor flat (undifferentiated); reflects Trinitarian community; activates the priesthood of all believers
Visual / model	Analogies: jazz ensemble, geese in flight formation, Swiss government
Adoption evidence	Core of V3 training curriculum (one of the eight competencies); MaryKate Morse: "the chapters on polycentric leadership alone are worth the price of the book"
Source	IVP — Creating a Missional Culture

Leadership organized around multiple interrelated centers as a third way between single-leader hierarchy and structureless flatness, grounded in the communal nature of the triune God.

Five Culture Creators (Five Equippers)

Field	Value
Introduced	2012 (Creating a Missional Culture)
Components	Ephesians 4:11 gifts reframed as culture-shaping vocations: Dream Awakener (apostle), Heart Revealer (prophet), Story Teller (evangelist), Soul Healer (pastor), Light Giver (teacher)
Visual / model	Each culture creator cultivates one of Five Environments (Learning, Healing, Welcoming, Liberating, Thriving)
Adoption evidence	"Five Equippers" Vimeo teaching series; recurring in V3 training, Missio Alliance and Verge Network talks; Carlus Gup-ton called it "one of the most thorough developments" of the Eph. 4:11 framework
Source	IVP — Creating a Missional Culture

A reframing of APEST roles as culture-shaping vocations rather than hierarchical offices, each generating a distinct environment a fully missional community requires.

Eight Movement Competencies

Field	Value
Introduced	2016 (The Church as Movement, with Dan White Jr.)
Components	Movement Intelligence, Polycentric Leadership, Being Disciples, Making Disciples, Missional Theology, Ecclesial Architecture, Community Formation, Incarnational Practice
Visual / model	Interactive workbook format with tools, exercises, and reflection questions
Adoption evidence	The architecture of V3's Praxis Community cohorts (8-month curriculum); IVP Book of the Year 2017
Source	Amazon — The Church as Movement

Eight necessary competencies for starting and sustaining missional-incarnational, neighborhood-rooted churches that multiply as a movement.

Theology of the Powers

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (PhD thesis); 2023 (The Scandal of Leadership)
Components	Synthesis of Walter Wink (powers embodied in systems / the Domination System), René Girard (mimetic desire, scapegoating), William Stringfellow (Image, Institution, Ideology); principalities created good but fallen and redeemable, Satan/demonic as emergent and unredeemable
Visual / model	Stringfellow's image / institution / ideology mapped to identity / praxis / telos
Adoption evidence	PhD thesis (~80,385 words); 418-page trade book; Missio Alliance 3-part series; Substack "Faithful Resistance"; ~274 Google Scholar citations across works
Source	100Movements — The Scandal of Leadership

A diagnostic theology arguing that domineering church leadership results from unconsciously mimicking the fallen Powers; the alternative is positive mimesis of Christ — "not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers."

Imitation-Based Leadership Framework

Field	Value
Introduced	2020 (PhD thesis); 2023 (The Scandal of Leadership)
Components	Leaders are inescapably imitative (Girard); imitating worldly power = domineering; imitating Christ's kenosis = life-giving servant leadership; no neutral ground
Visual / model	Oscar Romero as the primary positive exemplar of kenotic leadership
Adoption evidence	Central thesis of The Scandal of Leadership; carried through podcast circuit (Theology in the Raw, Faith in a Fresh Vibe)
Source	Manchester Research Explorer

A binary leadership formation model: leaders either reshape their desires toward Christ's self-emptying example or default to replicating the Powers' domination.

Three Contours of Leadership

Field	Value
Introduced	2023 (The Scandal of Leadership)
Components	Identity (who leaders are), Praxis (how they lead and relate), Telos (what they value and pursue); domineering leaders malform across all three
Visual / model	Maps to Stringfellow's image / institution / ideology
Adoption evidence	Diagnostic structure within The Scandal of Leadership
Source	Amazon — The Scandal of Leadership

A three-part diagnostic for leadership health across who a leader is, how they lead, and what they pursue.

The Cultural Web

Field	Value
Introduced	2012 (Creating a Missional Culture)
Components	Six interconnected dimensions shaping congregational/neighborhood culture: Language, Artifacts, Rituals, Ethics, Institutions, Guiding Narratives
Visual / model	A "web" — pull one strand and the others move
Adoption evidence	Diagnostic tool in Creating a Missional Culture and V3 teaching
Source	IVP — Creating a Missional Culture

A six-dimension diagnostic for understanding and reshaping the unseen culture that determines a church's missional effectiveness.

Four Spaces of Belonging

Field	Value
Introduced	2014 (V3 blog / training)
Components	Four relational spaces of varying intimacy and size across which discipleship and mission happen
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	V3 immersion course "How Jesus Used the 4 Spaces of Belonging to Make & Multiply Disciples" (with Eun Strawser); Faith+Lead Pivot Podcast feature
Source	V3 Movement

A relational-spatial model for how disciple-making and mission move across spaces of differing intimacy and scale.

Five Cultural Megashifts

Field	Value
Introduced	2012 (Creating a Missional Culture)
Components	Five macro transitions missional leaders must navigate: Media (print/broadcast → digital), Philosophy (modernity → postmodernity), Science (classical → emergent), Geography (rural → urban), Religion (Christendom → post-Christendom)
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Contextual-analysis section of Creating a Missional Culture
Source	<u>IVP — Creating a Missional Culture</u>

Five macro-level cultural transitions that frame the context for missional leadership.

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/articles.md

JR Woodward — Published Articles, Blog Posts & Newsletter

Catalog Date: 2026-04-12

Status: Verified from web searches; some dates approximated where not visible in source

Substack Newsletter: "Faithful Resistance"

URL: <https://jrwoodward.substack.com/>

Tagline: "A Movement of Hope as Technocrats, Autocrats, and Oligarchs Remake the World in Their Image"

Focus: How the Church can stand firm, learn from past resistance, and embody hope in a world reshaped by AI and concentrated power.

Launch: 2025

Published Posts (reverse chronological)

#	Title	Subtitle	Date	URL
1	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (11/16)	The Cost of Faithful Resistance	2026-04-09	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/prophetic-discipleship-love-on-trial-242
2	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (10/16)	Peacemakers in an Age of Escalating Violence	2026-03-20	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
3	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (9/16)	Seeing God Without Illusion in a Time of War	2026-03-10	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
4	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (8/16)	Mercy as Resistance in an Age of Retaliation	2026-02-19	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
5	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (7/16)	The Politics of Hunger	2026-02-10	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
6	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (6/16)	The politics that outlasts empire	2026-01-30	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
7	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (5/16)	Eyes Opened by Tears	2026-01-23	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
8	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (4/16)	Poor in Spirit, Free from Illusions	2026-01-11	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
9	Re-Centering	Staying Human in Contested Times	2026-01-05	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
10	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (3/16)	The Gospel and Our Political Imagination	2025-10-15	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
11	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (2/16)	When intimidation becomes policy, discipleship must become prophetic	2025-09-20	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
12	Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial (1/16)	When the Church's Silence Weakens Her Witness	2025-08-14	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
13	The Power of the 3.5%	Nonviolent resistance research	2025-06-09	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/the-power-of-the-35
14	Faithful Witness as Resistance	Dialogue on William Stringfellow	2025-05-27	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/faithful-witness-as-resistance
15	Hope That Resists	Reflection on Pope Francis's final letter	2025-05-20	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/hope-that-resists
16	The Witness of Oscar Romero	Clarity to name and unmask the Powers	2025-05-07	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/the-witness-of-oscar-romero
17	Exposing the Powers		2025-04-25	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/exposing-the-powers

#	Title	Subtitle	Date	URL
		Connecting Scandal of Leadership to current events		
18	Unmasking the Spirit of the Age	Identifying and resisting distorting Powers	2025-04-15	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/unmasking-the-spirit-of-the-age
19	Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis	A Moment of Discernment, A Crisis of Allegiance	2025-04-07	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
20	Naming and Unmasking the Powers	A Spiritual Practice for Contested Times	2025-04-02	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/naming-and-unmasking-the-powers
21	Faithful Resistance in the Age of Manufactured Kings	How this space will help us see clearly, live deeply, and stand together	2025-03-26	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/faithful-resistance-in-the-age-of-aa8

Engagement (top posts): Faithful Resistance in the Age of Manufactured Kings (40 likes, 11 restacks, 24 comments); Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis (30 likes, 5 restacks, 27 comments).

Missio Alliance Articles

Author page: <https://missioalliance.org/author/jr-woodward/>

Role: Co-founder of Missio Alliance

Title	Date	Topic	URL
Developing an Imitation-Based Framework of Healthy Leadership in Christ ("The Scandal of Leadership," Part III)	2023 (Spring)	Imitation-based leadership, Christ-centered	https://www.missioalliance.org/developing-an-imitation-based-framework-of-healthy-leadership-in-christ-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-iii/
Fallen Leaders Pursue the Imitation of Powers for Their Own Agenda ("The Scandal of Leadership," Part II)	2023 (Spring)	Mimetic desire, fallen leadership	https://www.missioalliance.org/fallen-leaders-pursue-the-imitation-of-powers-for-their-own-agenda-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-ii/
The Rush of a Crowd: A Root Issue in Domineering Leaders ("The Scandal of Leadership," Part I)	2023 (Spring)	Root causes of domineering leadership	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-rush-of-a-crowd-a-root-issue-in-domineering-leaders-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-i/
How to Plant in the New World	Unknown	Church planting paradigms	https://missioalliance.org/plant-new-world/
The Five Equippers of Churches	Unknown	Five-fold ministry / polycentric leadership	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-five-equippers-of-churches-jr-woodward/
Introducing Two Books That Address a Key Problem for the Church	Unknown	Book announcement	https://www.missioalliance.org/news/introducing-two-books-address-key-problem-church/

V3 Movement Blog (thev3movement.org)

Author page: <https://thev3movement.org/author/jr/> (4 pages of posts)

Role: National Director

Title	Date	Topic	URL
Structuring for Movement Immersion	2021-01-05	Movement structures, post-pandemic	https://thev3movement.org/2021/01/05/structuring-for-movement-immersion/
Watch: Church as Industrial Complex	2017-03-22	Video — critique of church industrialization	https://thev3movement.org/2017/03/22/watch-church-industrial-complex/
Church as Movement, Not Industrial Complex	2016-08-08	Movement ecclesiology vs. institutional church	https://thev3movement.org/2016/08/08/church-as-movement-not-industrial-complex/
Missional Basics: An Interview with JR Woodward	2016-10-05	Video interview series — message/method of mission, person of peace, technology, discipleship	https://thev3movement.org/2016/10/05/missional-basics/
How to be a Movemental Church Planting Community	2016-05-25	Church planting community formation	https://thev3movement.org/2016/05/25/movemental-church-planting-community/
Discover the Difference Between Church Planting and a Missional Movement	2015-05-26	Church planting vs. movement distinction	https://thev3movement.org/2015/05/26/discover-the-difference-between-church-planting-and-a-missional-movement-only-one-day-left/
A Church Planting Conference for Missional-Incarnational Practitioners	2015-03-23	Praxis Gathering announcement	https://thev3movement.org/2015/03/23/praxis-missional-church-planting-conference/
Five Environments For a Thriving Missional Community	2014-04-02	Cultivating missional community environments	https://thev3movement.org/2014/04/02/five-environments-for-a-thriving-missional-community/
Christian Discipleship and the Four Spaces of Belonging	2014-01-14	Four spaces framework for discipleship	https://thev3movement.org/2014/01/14/discipleship-and-the-four-spaces-of-belonging/
Fail: An Interview with J.R. Briggs	2014-10-13	Interview on failure in ministry	https://thev3movement.org/2014/10/13/fail-an-interview-with-j-r-briggs/
Grudem and Newbigin Chat About Election	2015-06-23	Missional view of election	https://thev3movement.org/2015/06/23/grudem-and-newbigin-chat-about-election/

Note: V3 Movement site contains approximately 4 pages of posts by JR Woodward. Many additional posts exist beyond what was retrievable through search.

Personal Blog (jrwoodward.net / jrwoodward.com)

Status: jrwoodward.net contains legacy blog (active 2007-2016+); jrwoodward.com is the current author site.

Title	Date	Topic	URL
The Places Where I Blog Now	2016-09	Redirect to V3 and other platforms	http://jrwoodward.net/2016/09/the-places-where-i-blog-now/
Choice Blog Entries — Jubilee, Incarnation and Merton	2008-09	Curation of missional blog posts	http://jrwoodward.net/2008/09/choice-blog-entries-jubilee-incarnation-and-merton/
Announcing the Kingdom — Analytical Report	2007-04	Panoramic missional view of Scripture	http://jrwoodward.net/2007/04/announcing-the-kingdom-analytical-report/
The Mission of the Church as Defined by NT Wright	2008-11	Church mission, NT Wright	http://jrwoodward.net/2008/11/the-mission-of-the-church-as-defined-by-nt-wright/

Note: Woodward's personal blog was active from approximately 2007-2016 and contained extensive content on missional church topics. In September 2016, he announced migration to V3 Movement blog and New Churches sites. The legacy blog at jrwoodward.net now appears compromised (some pages redirect to unrelated content).

External Publications & Guest Appearances

Title	Publication	Date	Topic	URL
Review: The Scandal of Leadership (reviewed by others)	Word&Way	2024-06-25	Book review	https://wordandway.org/2024/06/25/review-the-scandal-of-leadership/
EChurch@Wartburg: Worldly Leadership Has Infiltrated the Church — A Call for Change	The Wartburg Watch	2025-03-22	Leadership, powers, church reform	https://thewartburgwatch.com/2025/03/22/03-22-25-echurchwartburg-jr-woodward-worldly-leadership-has-infiltrated-the-church-a-call-for-change/

Podcast / Interview Appearances

Title	Show / Host	Date	URL
Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging (#96)	Faith+Lead Pivot Podcast	Unknown (2024-2025)	https://faithlead.org/pivot/season-5/96-missional-leadership-reimagined-jr-woodwards-four-spaces-of-belonging/
The Scandal of Leadership & Developing Missional Communities (#18)	Pursuing Disciple Making Movements in the Frontiers	Unknown	https://www.dmmsfrontiermissions.com/episode-18-the-scandal-of-leadership-developing-missional-communities-jr-woodward-interview/
JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership (Part 1) (#71)	Faith in a Fresh Vibe Podcast	2023 (Nov)	https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/71-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-1/
The Scandalous Way of Christ — On Church Leadership with JR Woodward (Part 2) (#72)	Faith in a Fresh Vibe Podcast	2023 (Nov)	https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/72-the-scandalous-way-of-christ-on-church-leadership-with-jr-woodward-part-2/

Social Media Presence

Platform	Handle / URL	Status
Facebook	@missionalculture	Active
Twitter/X	@dreamawakener	Confirmed (via Goodreads)
LinkedIn	https://www.linkedin.com/in/jrwoodward/	Active
Substack	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/	Active (launched 2025)
Goodreads Blog	https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/853697.J_R_Woodward/blog	30+ pages

Sources

- jrwoodward.substack.com (direct archive)
- missioalliance.org/author/jr-woodward/
- thev3movement.org/author/jr/
- jrwoodward.net (legacy blog)
- jrwoodward.com (current author site)

- faithlead.org, rohadi.com, dmmsfrontiermissions.com (podcast appearances)
- thewartburgwatch.com, wordandway.org (external features)

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/audio.md

Audio & Podcast Content: JR Woodward

Research Date: April 12, 2026

Confidence Level: Medium-High

Researcher: Movemental Research Team

Summary

JR Woodward does **not host his own podcast**. He is exclusively a **guest** on other shows, with a concentrated burst of appearances in 2023-2025 tied to the release of The Scandal of Leadership (Spring 2023). He also maintains a Substack newsletter ("Faithful Resistance") but it is text-only with no audio component identified.

- **Total guest appearances found:** 11 confirmed podcast episodes + 1 video talk + 1 video interview series
 - **Total hosted episodes:** 0 (no own podcast identified)
 - **Date range:** October 2011 (earliest video) to March 2025 (most recent confirmed)
 - **Peak activity:** 2023 (book launch for The Scandal of Leadership)
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Podcast Guest Appearances

#	Podcast Name	Episode Title	Date	Duration	Host(s)	Topic / Book
1	Theology in the Raw	#1149: The Leadership Crisis in the Church: Dr. J.R. Woodward	Feb 1, 2024	—	Preston Sprinkle	Polycentric vs. hierarchical leadership; kingdom-building temptations; leadership failures; The Scandal of Leadership
2	Pivot Podcast (FaithLead / Luther Seminary)	#96: Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging	Sep 26, 2024	—	Rev. Dr. Terri Elton, Rev. Dr. Dwight Zscheile	Four spaces of belonging; discipleship crisis; missional leadership framework
3	Faith in a Fresh Vibe	#71: JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership (Part 1)	Nov 13, 2023	44:13	Rohadi Nagassar	Power dynamics; Walter Wink; William Stringfellow; Rene Girard; mimetic desire; scapegoating; The Scandal of Leadership
4	Faith in a Fresh Vibe	#72: The Scandalous Way of Christ — On Church Leadership with JR Woodward (Part 2)	Nov 17, 2023	35:18	Rohadi Nagassar	Oscar Romero; Lord's Prayer framework; spiritual formation; kingdom values vs. worldly power; The Scandal of Leadership
5	The Deep Dive Spirituality Conversations	#141: JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership	Sep 2, 2023	54:18	Dr. Brian Russell	Christlike servant leadership; self-emptying spirituality; missional leadership practices; The Scandal of Leadership
6	Reconstructing Pastors	Confronting Scandalous Leadership with JR Woodward	Oct 30, 2023	~52:00	—	Domineering leadership in the church; mimetic desires and rivalry; systemic issues; The Scandal of Leadership
7	The Roys Report			—		

#	Podcast Name	Episode Title	Date	Duration	Host(s)	Topic / Book
		Unmasking Domination in the Church	Mar 21, 2025		Guest host: Lance Ford	Protestant adoption of Western power obsession; individualism; the leadership movement's trail of victims; The Scandal of Leadership
8	Pursuing Disciple Making Movements in the Frontiers (DMMs Frontier Missions / Dare to Multiply)	#18: The Scandal of Leadership & Developing Missional Communities	Jul 14, 2023	—	Cynthia Anderson	Imitating Jesus as leader; four essential leadership questions; grounded spirituality; missional communities; The Scandal of Leadership
9	Shifting Culture Podcast	Episode 54: JR Woodward	May 10, 2022	—	Joshua Johnson	Coaching outcomes; spaces of belonging; powers and principalities; imitating Christ in discipleship
10	EChurch@Wartburg (The Wartburg Watch)	JR Woodward: Worldly Leadership Has Infiltrated the Church — A Call for Change	Mar 22, 2025	—	Wartburg Watch team	Worldly leadership infiltrating the church; call for structural change
11	Pivot Podcast (FaithLead)	#96 syndication / Grand Canyon Synod feature	Oct 31, 2025	—	(same as #2 — syndicated)	(Same episode as #2, syndicated with updated date on secondary platform)

Notes on the Table

- Durations marked "—" were not available from publicly accessible metadata.
- Episodes #3 and #4 are a two-part series on the same podcast.
- Episode #8 appears on two different podcast feeds: "Pursuing DMMs in the Frontiers" (dmmsfrontiermissions.com) and "Dare to Multiply" (daretomultiply.podbean.com) — likely the same show rebranded.
- The Roys Report episode (#7) was guest-hosted by Lance Ford, not Julie Roys herself.

Video Talks & Conference Presentations (Audio-Adjacent)

#	Platform	Title	Date	Format	Notes
1	Verge Network	Missional Leadership: Living Out the Five Fold	Oct 25, 2011	Video talk	Five equippers from Ephesians 4; practical application from a decade in LA; co-founder of Kairos Los Angeles
2	V3 Movement	Missional Basics: An Interview with JR Woodward	Oct 5, 2016	Video interview series	Holy Spirit in the church; multi-congregational approaches; theology of place; social justice; what success means in church planting. Released alongside The Church as Movement
3	Missio Alliance	Polycentric Missional Leadership (Workshop)	—	Video/ workshop	Five equippers; polycentric, bi-vocational, mutually submissional leadership

Platform URLs

Podcast Episode Direct Links

1. <https://theologyintheraw.com/podcast/the-leadership-crisis-in-the-church-dr-j-r-woodward/>
2. <https://faithlead.org/pivot/season-5/96-missional-leadership-reimagined-jr-woodwards-four-spaces-of-belonging/>
3. <https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/71-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-1/>
4. <https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/72-the-scandalous-way-of-christ-on-church-leadership-with-jr-woodward-part-2/>
5. <https://deepdivespirituality.podbean.com/e/episode-141-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership/>
6. <https://reconstructingpastors.buzzsprout.com/2211617/episodes/13861088-confronting-scandalous-leadership-with-jr-woodward>
7. <https://julieroys.com/podcast/unmasking-domination-in-the-church/>
8. <https://www.dmmsfrontiermissions.com/episode-18-the-scandal-of-leadership-developing-missional-communities-jr-woodward-interview/>
9. <https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-54-jrwoodward>
10. <https://thewartburgwatch.com/2025/03/22/03-22-25-echurchwartburg-jr-woodward-worldly-leadership-has-infiltrated-the-church-a-call-for-change/>

Transcript Available

- Theology in the Raw #1149: <https://podscripts.co/podcasts/theology-in-the-raw/s2-ep1149-the-leadership-crisis-in-the-church-dr-jr-woodward>

Video Talk Links

1. <https://vergenetwork.org/how-to-be-missional-leader-jr-woodward-video/>
 2. <http://thev3movement.org/2016/10/05/missional-basics/>
 3. <https://www.missioalliance.org/polycentric-missional-leadership-j-r-woodward/>
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Key Themes Across Appearances

Primary Themes (appear in 5+ episodes)

1. **The Scandal of Leadership / Domineering leadership** — the central thesis of his 2023 book and PhD research; discussed in nearly every appearance from 2023 onward
2. **Polycentric leadership** — the alternative to hierarchical, CEO-model church leadership; drawn from Ephesians 4 five-fold framework
3. **Mimetic desire and scapegoating** (Rene Girard) — how rivalry and imitation drive leadership dysfunction
4. **Powers and principalities** (Walter Wink, William Stringfellow) — systemic spiritual analysis of institutional power

Secondary Themes (appear in 2-4 episodes)

1. **Four spaces of belonging** — Woodward's framework for community structure
2. **Christlike servant leadership / self-emptying spirituality** (kenosis)
3. **Missional culture and discipleship** — creating communities oriented toward mission
4. **Kingdom vs. brand** — churches focused on God's kingdom rather than institutional growth

Book-Specific Themes

- **Creating a Missional Culture** (2012): Five equippers, cultural architects, polycentric leadership, missional ethos
 - **The Church as Movement** (2016): Movement ecclesiology, missional-incarnational communities, theology of place
 - **The Scandal of Leadership** (2023): Powers of domination, mimetic theory, hierarchical vs. polycentric structures, leadership failures
-

Most Frequent Podcast Hosts

Host	Episodes	Podcast
Rohadi Nagassar	2 (two-part series)	Faith in a Fresh Vibe
Preston Sprinkle	1	Theology in the Raw
Dr. Brian Russell	1	The Deep Dive Spirituality Conversations
Lance Ford (guest host)	1	The Roys Report
Cynthia Anderson	1	DMMs Frontier Missions / Dare to Multiply
Joshua Johnson	1	Shifting Culture
Terri Elton & Dwight Zscheile	1	Pivot Podcast

No single host has featured Woodward more than once (aside from the two-part Faith in a Fresh Vibe series).

Timeline

Year	Appearances	Notes
2011	1 video	Verge Network talk (earliest found)
2016	1 video interview	V3 Movement — The Church as Movement release
2022	1 podcast	Shifting Culture (pre-book)
2023	5 podcasts	The Scandal of Leadership book launch — peak activity
2024	2 podcasts	Theology in the Raw + Pivot Podcast
2025	2 appearances	The Roys Report + Wartburg Watch

Gaps & Opportunities

What Was Not Found

- **No own podcast** — Woodward does not host or co-host any podcast series
- **No audiobook** versions of his books were confirmed (would need to check Audible/Amazon separately)
- **No sermon archives** — no public sermon repository identified (SermonAudio, church website archives, etc.)
- **No Spotify or Apple Podcasts artist profile** — his appearances are distributed across other shows' feeds

- **Limited pre-2022 podcast presence** — despite publishing *Creating a Missional Culture* in 2012 and *The Church as Movement* in 2016, very few podcast appearances from that era were discoverable

Opportunities for Movemental

1. **Podcast launch potential** — Woodward has no owned audio channel; a Movemental-hosted podcast or interview series could fill this gap
2. **Transcript corpus** — at least one episode (*Theology in the Raw*) has a public transcript; others may be obtainable for content mining
3. **Thematic consistency** — his message is remarkably consistent (anti-domination, polycentric, kenotic leadership), making him easy to position in content strategy
4. **Active Substack** — "Faithful Resistance" (jrwoodward.substack.com) is his primary owned content channel; cross-promotion with audio content would be natural

Related Written Content Platforms

- **Substack:** "Faithful Resistance" — <https://jrwoodward.substack.com/>
- **Missio Alliance author page:** <https://missioalliance.org/author/jr-woodward/>
- **Personal website:** <https://jrwoodward.com/>
- **100 Movements author page:** <https://www.100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward>

Research conducted via web search on April 12, 2026. Some episodes may exist behind paywalls or on platforms not indexed by search engines. This catalog should be treated as a minimum baseline, not an exhaustive list.

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/videos.md

JR Woodward -- Video & Multimedia Content Catalog

Research date: 2026-04-12

Subject: JR Woodward (Dr. J.R. Woodward, PhD) -- church planter, missiologist, National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement

Status: Comprehensive catalog based on web research; URLs verified at time of research

Executive Summary

JR Woodward does **not** appear to have his own YouTube channel. His video content is scattered across third-party platforms: conference recording channels (Verge Network / Exponential), organization sites (V3 Movement, Missio Alliance), podcast video channels (Theology in the Raw, The Roys Report), Vimeo (Five Equippers series), and Seminary Now (gated educational content). He also has a growing presence through his Substack "Faithful Resistance" which hosts webinars.

- **Own YouTube channel:** No dedicated channel found
 - **Twitter/X handle:** @dreamawakener
 - **Facebook:** @missionalculture
 - **Substack:** jrwoodward.substack.com ("Faithful Resistance")
 - **Estimated total videos across all platforms:** 25-40
 - **Date range:** 2011 (earliest confirmed) to 2025-2026 (ongoing)
 - **Most viewed:** Likely the Verge Network / Exponential 2011 conference talks and Five Equippers Vimeo series, given their longevity and platform reach
-

Key Themes Across Video Content

1. **Polycentric / APEST Leadership** -- Five Equippers model (Apostle, Prophet, Evangelist, Pastor, Teacher) as alternative to hierarchical or flat church leadership
2. **Missional Culture** -- Equipping the whole church for mission, not just professional clergy
3. **Church as Movement** -- Moving from institutional "industrial complex" models to missional-incarnational communities
4. **Scandal of Leadership / Domineering Power** -- Unmasking powers of domination in the church (based on PhD research)
5. **Faithful Resistance** -- Prophetic discipleship, resisting technocratic and autocratic powers (2025-2026 emphasis)

6. Neighborhood-Grounded Church Planting -- Practical models from Kairos Los Angeles and V3 network

Video Catalog

Conference Talks

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Views	URL	Type
How to Know Your Gift -- JR Woodward (Exponential 2011: On the Verge breakout)	Verge Network	2011-07-14	Unknown	Unknown	https://vergenetwork.org/jr-woodward-how-to-know-your-gift-video/	Conference talk
How to Be a Missional Leader -- JR Woodward (Exponential 2011: On the Verge)	Verge Network	2011-10-25	Unknown	Unknown	https://vergenetwork.org/how-to-be-missional-leader-jr-woodward-video/	Conference talk
Polycentric Missional Leadership (J.R. Woodward)	Missio Alliance	2014-01-13	~55 min	Unknown	https://www.missioalliance.org/polycentric-missional-leadership-j-r-woodward/	Workshop recording (audio confirmed; video uncertain)
The Five Equippers of Churches -- JR Woodward	Missio Alliance	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-five-equippers-of-churches-jr-woodward/	Conference presentation
JR Woodward at Awakenings Gathering 2023 (Chicago)	Awakenings Gathering	2023	Unknown	Unknown	https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward	Conference talk (book launch: Scandal of Leadership)

Vimeo -- Five Equippers Series

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Views	URL	Type
JR Woodward's Five Equippers: Introduction	Vimeo (uploader unknown)	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	https://vimeo.com/46237164	Teaching series
Five Equippers: Apostle	Vimeo	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	Series linked from jrwoodward.net (domain expired)	Teaching series
Five Equippers: Prophet	Vimeo	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	Series linked from jrwoodward.net (domain expired)	Teaching series
Five Equippers: Evangelist	Vimeo	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	Series linked from jrwoodward.net (domain expired)	Teaching series
Five Equippers: Pastor	Vimeo	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	Series linked from jrwoodward.net (domain expired)	Teaching series
Five Equippers: Teacher	Vimeo	2012 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	Series linked from jrwoodward.net (domain expired)	Teaching series

Note: The Five Equippers series (est. 6 videos) was originally linked from jrwoodward.net, which has since expired/redirected. The Introduction video at vimeo.com/46237164 is confirmed. Individual equipper videos may still exist on Vimeo but direct URLs are unconfirmed.

V3 Movement Videos

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Views	URL	Type
Missional Basics: An Interview with JR Woodward	V3 Movement	2016-10-05	Unknown	Unknown	http://thev3movement.org/2016/10/05/missional-basics/	Interview
Church as Industrial Complex	V3 Movement	2017-03-22	Unknown	Unknown	https://thev3movement.org/2017/03/22/watch-church-industrial-complex/	Teaching
Unmasking the Spirit of the Age (V3 Webinar with Daniel Yang, Jessie Cruickshank)	V3 Movement / Substack	2025 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/p/unmasking-the-spirit-of-the-age	Webinar

Seminary Now (Gated Platform)

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Views	URL	Type
JR Woodward Seminary Teaching Series	Seminary Now (subscription required)	Unknown	Unknown	Unknown	https://seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward	Educational video (gated)

Note: Seminary Now is a subscription-based on-demand seminary education platform created in partnership with IVP. JR Woodward is listed as a contributor with video courses, but specific titles and counts are behind the paywall.

Podcast Interviews with Video (YouTube/Video confirmed or likely)

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	Views	URL	Type
The Leadership Crisis in the Church: Dr. J.R. Woodward	Theology in the Raw (Preston Sprinkle)	2024-02-01	Unknown	Unknown	https://theologyintheraw.com/podcast/the-leadership-crisis-in-the-church-dr-j-r-woodward/	Interview (YouTube video version confirmed)
Unmasking Domination in the Church (guest host Lance Ford)	The Roys Report (Julie Roys)	2023 (est.)	Unknown	Unknown	https://julieroys.com/podcast/unmasking-domination-in-the-church/	Interview

Note: Theology in the Raw publishes all episodes as both audio podcasts and YouTube videos. The JR Woodward episode is confirmed to have a YouTube video version via the Theology in the Raw YouTube channel: <https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCVZITxltkMcs9ngkWNliNsw>

Podcast Interviews (Audio-primary; some may have video)

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	URL	Type
Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging (#96)	Pivot Podcast (Faith+Lead)	2025-10-31	Unknown	https://faithlead.org/pivot/season-5/96-missional-leadership-reimagined-jr-woodwards-four-spaces-of-belonging/	Interview
JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership, Part 1 (#71)	Faith in a Fresh Vibe (Rohadi)	2023 (est.)	Unknown	https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/71-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-1/	Interview
The Scandalous Way of Christ -- Church Leadership with JR Woodward, Part 2 (#72)	Faith in a Fresh Vibe (Rohadi)	2023 (est.)	Unknown	https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/72-the-scandalous-way-of-christ-on-church-leadership-with-jr-woodward-part-2/	Interview
Episode 141: JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership	Deep Dive Spirituality Conversations	2023 (est.)	Unknown	https://deepdivespirituality.podbean.com/e/episode-141-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership/	Interview
Confronting Scandalous Leadership with JR Woodward	Reconstructing Pastors Podcast	2023-10-30	Unknown	https://reconstructingpastors.buzzsprout.com/2211617/episodes/13861088-confronting-scandalous-leadership-with-jr-woodward	Interview
TMCP 147: JR Woodward on How to Prevent Scandals in the Church	The Monday Christian Podcast	2023-07 (est.)	Unknown	https://www.themondaychristian.com/tmcp-146-jr-woodward-on-how-to-prevent-scandals-in-the-church/	Interview
Episode 54: JR Woodward -- Shifting Culture	Shifting Culture Podcast	Unknown	Unknown	https://www.shiftingculturepodcast.com/episodes/episode-54-jrwoodward	Interview
Episode 18: The Scandal		Unknown	Unknown	https://www.dmmsfrontiermissions.com/	Interview

Title	Channel / Platform	Date	Duration	URL	Type
of Leadership & Developing Missional Communities	Pursuing DMMs in the Frontiers			episode-18-the-scandal-of-leadership-developing-missional-communities-jr-woodward-interview/	

Written/Blog Interviews (No video)

These are included for completeness but are text-only:

- **J.R. Woodward -- The Scandal of Leadership [Interview]** -- Englewood Review: <https://englewoodreview.org/j-r-woodward-the-scandal-of-leadership-interview/>
- **Creating a Missional Culture -- Jamie Arpin-Ricci Interviews J.R. Woodward** -- Godspace: <https://godspacelight.com/2012/10/10/creating-a-missional-culture-jamie-arpin-ricci-interviews-j-r-woodward/>

Verge Network -- Additional Non-Video Content by JR Woodward

The Verge Network also hosts printable/article content (not video):

Title	Type	URL
JR Woodward: How to Train Leaders	Printable	https://vergenetwork.org/2011/03/14/jr-woodward-how-to-train-leaders-printable/
JR Woodward: What is a Missional Community?	Printable	https://vergenetwork.org/jr-woodward-what-is-a-missional-community-printable/
JR Woodward: How a Missional Community Is Different from a Bible Study	Printable	https://vergenetwork.org/jr-woodward-whats-the-difference-printable/

Platform Summary

Platform	Confirmed Videos	Notes
Vimeo	1-6	Five Equippers series (Introduction confirmed; rest likely exist)
Verge Network	2	Exponential 2011 breakout recordings
V3 Movement website	2-3	Missional Basics interview, Church as Industrial Complex
Missio Alliance	1-2	Polycentric Leadership workshop, Five Equippers talk
Theology in the Raw (YouTube)	1	Confirmed YouTube video version
Seminary Now	Unknown (gated)	Behind subscription paywall
Awakenings Gathering	1	Archive page exists but video not confirmed
Substack (Faithful Resistance)	1+	V3 webinars from 2025
Various podcast channels	8+	Audio-primary; some may have video versions

Total confirmed/likely video appearances: 20-30+

Total including audio-only podcast interviews: 35-45+

Notable Gaps

1. **No dedicated YouTube channel** -- Unlike many peers, Woodward has not centralized his video content
 2. **jrwoodward.net domain expired** -- His original website (which linked to the Five Equippers video series and other content) has been lost; jrwoodward.com appears to be the current site
 3. **Exponential conference recordings** -- He has spoken at Exponential multiple times but only 2011 recordings are confirmed online
 4. **No known TED/TEDx talks**
 5. **No known long-form lecture series** (beyond Seminary Now gated content)
 6. **V3 Movement site content fragile** -- Some older V3 pages return 404 errors
-

Comparison to Similar Leaders

JR Woodward's video footprint is notably smaller than peers like Alan Hirsch or Mike Breen, who have extensive YouTube presence through Forge, 5Q, and 3DM channels. Woodward's content is more dispersed and relies heavily on third-party platforms (podcast interviews, conference recordings). His 2023 book launch for "The Scandal of Leadership" generated the largest cluster of video/audio interviews in his career.

Sources

- Verge Network: <https://vergenetwork.org/tag/jr-woodward/>
- Missio Alliance: <https://missioalliance.org/j-r-woodward/>
- V3 Movement: <https://thev3movement.org>
- Seminary Now: <https://seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward>
- Theology in the Raw: <https://theologyintheraw.com/podcast/the-leadership-crisis-in-the-church-dr-j-r-woodward/>
- The Roys Report: <https://julieroys.com/podcast/unmasking-domination-in-the-church/>
- Awakenings Gathering: <https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward>
- 100Movements author page: <https://www.100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward>
- JR Woodward Substack: <https://jrwoodward.substack.com/>
- JR Woodward website: <https://jrwoodward.com/>
- Vimeo Five Equippers: <https://vimeo.com/46237164>

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/content-audit.md

status: empty

sidebar: content-audit

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/academic.md

JR Woodward — Academic Papers, Dissertations & Lectures

Catalog Date: 2026-04-12

Last updated: 2026-04-13 (PhD thesis PDF + CV on file in [../pdf/](#); index [../primary-documents.md](#))

Status: Verified from primary PDFs, Academia.edu, MWRC, Google Scholar, and web sources

Academic Credentials

Credential	Institution	Details
Ph.D.	University of Manchester (UK); research at Nazarene Theological College, Manchester	Dissertation: Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire and a Theology of the Powers — awarded June 2020; 80,385 words (title page)
M.A.	Fuller Theological Seminary	Missional Leadership; June 2011 ; thesis Equippers as Environmentalist: Re-imaging Leadership in Today's Western Church (advisor Dr. Robert Freeman) — per CV
B.S.	Radford University	Psychology — May 1987 — per CV

Academia.edu Profile: <https://manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD>

Google Scholar Profile: https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=lgz_vYAAAAAJ

MWRC Profile: <http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward>

Ph.D. Dissertation (full text on file)

Field	Detail
Repository copy	pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf (217 pp.)
Title	Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire and a Theology of the Powers
Author (title page)	Gailand A Woodward Jr.
Institution	University of Manchester — Faculty of Humanities; School of Arts, Languages and Cultures
Research site	Nazarene Theological College, Manchester
Year	2020
Supervisor	Dr. Phil Meadows
Examiners	Internal: Dr. Joseph Wood; External: Prof. Wilbert Shenk (per CV)
Dedication	To the V3 Church Planting Movement
Published as Book	The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church (100 Movements Publishing, 2023) — trade adaptation of the thesis
Key scholars	Walter Wink; René Girard; William Stringfellow; interlocutors across scripture, missional leadership literature (Van Gelder, Roxburgh, Fitch, etc.)
Research question	How might a theology of the Powers help missional leaders practice a spirituality that reshapes their desires for the sake of discipleship, community, and mission?
Central claim	Domineering leadership is tied to mimicking the Powers through malformed desire; redeemed leadership is imitating Christ — there is no neutral ground: not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers; missional leadership is ultimately about being an example worth imitating.
Chapter arc	(1) Missional leadership challenge; (2) Subversion of leadership — 1 Peter / Houston, imitation-based framework; (3) Leadership & Powers (Wink); (4) Leadership & imitation (Girard); (5) Missional leadership worthy of imitation (Stringfellow: image / institution / ideology ↔ identity, praxis, telos) plus catechism-style suggestions.

Abstract (from thesis; abridged)

All ecclesial leadership exercises power — either legitimately (Christ-like holy love) or illegitimately (selfish ambition). The thesis addresses leaders’ “fall” into **domineering** patterns (pride, manipulation, status, empire-building), which wound people and the church’s witness, especially where leaders claim a **missional** identity. Missional literature has surfaced imitation, desire, and Powers language, but not integrated them. **Wink** links leaders who mimic the Powers to the demonic and the “domination system”; **Girard** ties imitation and desire to the Powers. Together they yield an **imitation-based framework** connecting

missional leadership, mimetic desire, and a theology of the Powers. Redeemed leadership reshapes desire toward discipleship, community, and mission through **positive mimesis** of Christ.

Doctoral examining / field advisory (CV)

Year	Institution	Role
2015	Regent University	D.Min. committee member — candidate Kevin Austin, Faith Community Based Social Transformation
2016	Anderson University School of Theology	D.Min. examination chair — candidate Lloyd Wayne Edward Moritz, The Nature and Effectiveness of Missional Communities in the Pacific Northwest

Research interests

From CV (exhaustive list): Grounded spirituality; missiology; missional hermeneutics; church planting; missional leadership; movement ecclesiology; missional theology; evangelism; discipleship; principalities and powers; polycentric leadership; organizational dynamics; named conversation partners include Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright, René Girard, William Stringfellow, Eugene Peterson, Sarah Coakley, Oscar Romero, Walter Wink.

Also tagged on Academia.edu: Missional ecclesiology; ecclesiology; missional hermeneutics (overlap with above).

Published Academic Papers & Articles (from Academia.edu)

Title	Type	Year	Notes
The Medium and the Mission: How Can the Church Faithfully Fulfill Her Mission in the Digital Age?	Paper	Unknown	Digital ecclesiology; church mission in digital contexts
A Missional View of the Doctrine of Election	Paper / eBook	2011	How a robust view of election leads to a holistic gospel and meaningful missional engagement
A Missional Proposal	Paper	Unknown	Proposal for missional paradigm
Shalom Makers: Development in the Way of Christ	Paper	Unknown	Development theology, shalom, Christological approach
Equippers as Environmentalists: Re-Imagining Leadership in Today's Western Church	Paper	Unknown	Leadership reimagined through ecological metaphor
Divided by Hell: An Assessment of Love Wins by Rob Bell	Paper / Review	~2011	Theological review of Rob Bell's Love Wins

Book Reviews (Academic — from Academia.edu)

Title	Subject	Year	Notes
The Gospel after Christendom: New Voice, New Cultures, New Expressions	Review	Unknown	Post-Christendom gospel expression
Practicing Witness: A Missional Vision of Christian Practices	Review	Unknown	Missional practice theology

Book Chapters (Academic)

Chapter Title	Book	Publisher	Year
"Structured for Movement: How the Pandemic Reveals the Need to Restructure the Life of the Church for Disciples on Mission"	The Great Adventure of the Church in the New Normal Era	Institute for Church Growth (Seoul, Korea)	2021
"What Would God's Reign Look Like In Our Neighborhood?"	Sent to Flourish: A Guide to Planting and Multiplying Churches (ed. Len Tang, Charles E. Cotherman)	IVP Academic	2019

Academic Affiliations

Manchester Wesley Research Centre (MWRC)

Field	Detail
URL	http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward
Role	Research Associate / Alumnus
Connection	Ph.D. completed through NTC / University of Manchester
CV Available	Yes — pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf in this repo

Fuller Theological Seminary

Field	Detail
Role	Adjunct Professor; DGL Cohort Leader
Program	Doctor of Global Leadership — "Discovering Missional Paradigms for the Next Generation"
Start	Spring 2025
Duration	4-year cohort
Board	Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council

Central Seminary

Field	Detail
Role	Adjunct Professor
Subject Areas	Missional ecclesiology, church planting

Missio Seminary

Field	Detail
Role	Adjunct Professor
Subject Areas	Missional theology, leadership

America Evangelical University

Field	Detail
Role	Adjunct Professor
Subject Areas	Theology, church planting

SOMA University; Capital Seminary and Graduate School (Washington, DC)

Field	Detail
Role	Adjunct (practical theology / ministry foundations / missional church)
Notes	CV lists SOMA (e.g. DM762, Winter 2020) and Capital Seminary MIN505 (Spring/Fall 2016–2019)

Teaching history (selected from CV)

Term	Institution	Course
Winter 2023	America Evangelical University	OLDR9104 Missional Culture Making
Fall 2022	Central Seminary	MC606 Congregational Development of New Faith Communities
Fall 2022	America Evangelical University	MS657 Missional Leadership
Fall 2021	America Evangelical University	OLDR9104 Missional Culture Making
Winter 2020	SOMA University	DM762 The Missional Church Ministry
Spring 2019	Capital Seminary and Graduate School	MIN505 Theological Foundations for Ministry
Fall 2017	Missio Theological Seminary	DM923 Re-missioning the Established Church
Fall 2017, Spring 2019, Fall 2016	Capital Seminary and Graduate School	MIN505 Theological Foundations for Ministry
Spring 2017, Fall 2016 (×2)	Fuller Theological Seminary	MAGL Directed Study (Chris Moerman; Rob Denison)

Full list including duplicate offerings: see <pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf>.

Conference Papers & Lectures

Title / Event	Venue	Date	Topic
Worldly Leadership Has Infiltrated the Church: A Call for Change	EChurch@Wartburg	2025-03-22	Leadership, powers, church reform
Awakenings 2023 (book release)	Missio Alliance Awakenings Gathering	2023	The Scandal of Leadership — book release and presentation
Awakenings 2025 Workshop	Missio Alliance Awakenings Gathering	2025	Workshop (audio bundle available)
Exponential Conference	Exponential	Various years	Church planting, missional leadership
Praxis Gathering (annual)	Washington, DC	Annually	Missional practice, church planting, movement
Faith+Lead Pivot Podcast (academic lecture format)	Luther Seminary / Faith+Lead	2024-2025	Four Spaces of Belonging, missional leadership

Organizations Founded / Co-Founded

These represent applied academic/theological work:

Organization	Role	Focus
Missio Alliance	Co-founder	Missional theology and practice for the North American church
Praxis Gathering	Co-founder, Co-director	Annual gathering for missional practitioners
Kairos LA	Co-founder	Church planting network in Los Angeles
Ecclesia Network	Co-founder	Relational network of missional churches
The Solis Foundation	Co-founder	Partners with churches in Kenya to equip people in extreme poverty to create sustainable businesses

Board Service (Academic/Organizational)

Organization	Role
Reliant Mission	Board Member
Movement Leaders Collective	Board Member
Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council	Board Member
Forge America Mission Training Network	National Leadership Team

Key Theological Interlocutors (from dissertation and published work)

Scholar	Engagement Area
Walter Wink	Theology of the Powers; naming, unmasking, and engaging the Powers
Rene Girard	Mimetic desire; scapegoating; violence and the sacred
William Stringfellow	Powers and principalities in American society; prophetic resistance
Lesslie Newbigin	Missional theology; gospel and Western culture
Alan Hirsch	Apostolic imagination; movement ecclesiology; APEST framework
Oscar Romero	Positive case study of faithful leadership under Powers

Gaps & Notes

- **Full dissertation text: On file** in-repo PDF (link above); Manchester Research Explorer record remains the canonical public URI for metadata.
- **Google Scholar citations:** Profile exists; refresh counts periodically for trend tracking.
- **JSTOR / peer-reviewed journals:** No major standalone journal article corpus surfaced; practitioner output runs through books, chapters, Academia.edu papers, and the PhD.
- **CV vs web bios:** CV adds exhaustive forewords/endorsements, dated board service, and granular teaching — keep [../primary-documents.md](#) as the diff log when web pages drift.

Sources

- [../pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf](#)
- [../pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf](#)
- <https://manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD>

- <https://manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD/CurriculumVitae>
- <http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward>
- https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=lgz_vYAAAAAJ
- <https://www.fuller.edu/doctor-of-global-leadership/discovering-missional-paradigms-for-the-next-generation/>
- <https://missioalliance.org/j-r-woodward/>
- <https://www.100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward>
- [https://www.academia.edu/100670007/
The_Scandal_of_Leadership_Unmasking_the_Powers_of_Domination_in_the_Church](https://www.academia.edu/100670007/The_Scandal_of_Leadership_Unmasking_the_Powers_of_Domination_in_the_Church)

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/content/courses.md

JR Woodward — Courses & Training Programs

Catalog Date: 2026-04-12

Status: Verified from thev3movement.org/training/, fuller.edu, mwrc.ac.uk, and multiple search sources

V3 Movement Training Programs

Organization: The V3 Church Planting Movement

Role: National Director

URL: <https://www.thev3movement.org/training/>

Reach: 600+ church planters trained over the past 10 years; goal to train 600 more in the next 5 years

Praxis Community Cohort 1: Engaging

Field	Detail
Duration	30 weeks (late August to late April)
Format	Cohort-based, in-person/virtual with experienced coach
Cohort Size	5-7 practitioners per group
Audience	Church planters in the planning phase or within first 3 years
Prerequisite	None; this cohort is prerequisite for V3 grants and partnership
Curriculum	Eight core competencies: Movemental Intelligence, Polycentric Leadership, Being Disciples, Making Disciples, Missional Theology, Ecclesial Architecture, Community Formation, Incarnational Practice
Methodology	Holistic, communal, peer-based, practice-oriented
URL	https://www.thev3movement.org/training/

Praxis Community Cohort 2: Establishing

Field	Detail
Duration	Ongoing (follows PC1 completion)
Format	Cohort-based with coach and peer-to-peer learning
Audience	PC1 graduates building established faith communities
Curriculum	Deeper engagement with eight core competencies; includes peer-led coaching
URL	https://www.thev3movement.org/training/

Immersion Courses (Short-Form)

4-6 week cohorts available in live and self-paced formats.

Course Title	Format	Availability	Topic
Starting a Movement	Live + Self-paced	Live: Spring 2027; Self-paced: Now	Foundational movement paradigms
The Craft of Discipleship	Live + Self-paced	Live: Registration open; Self-paced: Now	Discipleship practices and multiplication
Created for Connection & Mission	Live + Self-paced	Live: September 2026; Self-paced: Now	Community and mission integration
Emotionally Healthy Community	Live + Self-paced	Live: October 2026; Self-paced: Now	Emotional health in community contexts
How Jesus Used the 4 Spaces of Belonging to Make & Multiply Disciples	Immersion (6 weeks)	Unknown	Four Spaces framework (with Eun Strawser)

Reimagining Church (Standalone Program)

Field	Detail
Duration	12 weeks
Audience	Those processing church wounds and discerning new faith community models
Curriculum	Faithful deconstruction, fruitful reconstruction, practical discipleship, team formation
URL	https://www.thev3movement.org/training/

Fuller Theological Seminary — Doctor of Global Leadership (DGL)

Discovering Missional Paradigms for the Next Generation

Field	Detail
Program	Doctor of Global Leadership (DGL)
Institution	Fuller Theological Seminary
Role	Cohort Leader / Adjunct Professor
Duration	4 years
Start Date	Spring 2025
Format	Cohort-based doctoral program with scholar-practitioners
Focus	Discovering fresh missional paradigms with transformational potential for the next generation
Competencies	Missional theology, faithful contextualization, kenotic leadership
Research	Each student conducts qualitative applied research benefiting both their ministry context and the global church
URL	https://www.fuller.edu/doctor-of-global-leadership/discovering-missional-paradigms-for-the-next-generation/

Seminary Teaching (Adjunct Professor)

JR Woodward teaches as adjunct professor at multiple institutions. Specific course titles are not publicly listed but align with his expertise areas.

Institution	Role	Subject Areas
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor / DGL Cohort Leader	Missional theology, missional paradigms, kenotic leadership
Central Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional ecclesiology, church planting
Missio Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Missional theology, leadership
America Evangelical University	Adjunct Professor	Theology, church planting

Conference Training: Praxis Gathering

Field	Detail
Event	Praxis Gathering
Role	Co-founder and Co-director
Location	Washington, DC
Size	300+ practitioners
Focus	Equipping, nourishing, and sending missional practitioners; grounded missional practice
Requirement	Every communicator must live the material they share — best practices from street-level context
URL	https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward

Conference Training: Awakenings Gathering (Missio Alliance)

Field	Detail
Event	Awakenings Gathering
Organization	Missio Alliance
Role	Co-founder; workshop leader
Notable	"The Scandal of Leadership" released at Awakenings 2023
Format	Workshop bundles available (audio)
URL	https://missioalliance.org/resource/awakenings-2025-workshop-bundle/

Forge America Mission Training Network

Field	Detail
Organization	Forge America
Role	National Leadership Team member
Focus	Missional training network for the Western church
Connection	"Creating a Missional Culture" published in Forge Partnership Books series (IVP)

Key Training Frameworks (Developed by Woodward)

These frameworks recur across V3 training, books, and teaching:

Framework	Source	Description
Eight Core Competencies	The Church as Movement	Movement Intelligence, Polycentric Leadership, Being Disciples, Making Disciples, Missional Theology, Ecclesial Architecture, Community Formation, Incarnational Practice
Five Equippers	Creating a Missional Culture	Dream Awakeners (apostles), Heart Revealers (prophets), Story Tellers (evangelists), Soul Healers (pastors), Light Givers (teachers) — from Ephesians 4:11-13
Four Spaces of Belonging	V3 training / blog	Framework for discipleship through different relational spaces; applied to how Jesus made and multiplied disciples
Theology of the Powers	The Scandal of Leadership	Diagnostic framework for understanding domineering leadership via Wink, Girard, Stringfellow; imitation-based alternative

Sources

- <https://www.thev3movement.org/training/>
- <https://www.fuller.edu/doctor-of-global-leadership/discovering-missional-paradigms-for-the-next-generation/>
- <http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward>
- <https://missioalliance.org/j-r-woodward/>
- <https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward>
- <https://thev3movement.org/author/jr/> (V3 blog articles describing training)
- <https://faithlead.org/pivot/season-5/96-missional-leadership-reimagined-jr-woodwards-four-spaces-of-belonging/>

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/network/organizations.md

JR Woodward: Organizational Network

Research Date: 2026-04-12

Last Updated: 2026-04-13 (CV + thesis PDF integration)

Organizations Map

Founded / Co-Founded

Organization	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
New Life Christian Fellowship (NLCF)	Founder / lead pastor	1989–2002	Active (org continues)	CV: 24 to ~1,200; 500+ new Christians; 40+ to full-time ministry via Reliant; eight daughter churches.	nlcf.net ; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Kairos Los Angeles	Co-founder, pastor, coach	2002–2012	Active	CV: 48 people from Blacksburg; three LA-area plants + Antelope Valley; polycentric leadership; exited into Ecclesia Network.	kairoshollywood.com ; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
The Unembraced	Founder	Unknown	Unknown	Ministry to orphans in the Turkana region of Kenya.	--
The Solis Foundation	Co-Founder, Director	2007–2012	Unknown	CV: Turkana, Kenya — sustainable businesses; ~10 new businesses/ year.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Ecclesia Network	Co-Founder, West Coast director (later national leadership formation)	2007–2012	Unknown	CV: four churches at start; ~30 churches / ~4,000 people at departure; ~30% annual growth. Missio Alliance later spun out of this ecosystem.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Missio Alliance	Co-Founder, governing board	2012–present	Active	CV: first national gathering 700+ leaders (organized with J.R. Rozko).	missioalliance.org ; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Praxis Gathering	Co-Founder, Co-Director	Unknown	Active	Annual conference of 300+ on-the-ground missional practitioners.	thepraxisgathering.com

Organization	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
				Church planting conference for missional-incarnational practitioners.	

Leadership Roles

Organization	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
V3 Church Planting Movement	National Director	2013-present	Active	CV: eight-month cohort curriculum, coaches, grants; decentralized global ecosystem; 600+ leaders trained in first ten years with stated goal of 600 more in next five years (other marketing rounds to 1,000+ cumulative).	thev3movement.org;pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf

Academic Appointments

Institution	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Active	Active	Leads a Doctor of Global Leadership cohort (starting Spring 2025). Also contributed to Fuller's church-planting program ("Sent to Flourish").	fuller.edu
Central Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Unknown	Active	Teaching role.	--
Missio Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Unknown	Active	Teaching role.	--
University of Manchester (UK)	PhD Graduate, Researcher	Completed	Alumni	PhD research on leadership and the powers of domination in the church. Published as "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023). Academia.edu profile: JRWoodwardPhD.	manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD
Manchester Wesley Research Centre (MWRC)	Associate Fellow	2015–present	Active	CV title: Associate Fellow.	mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward;pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf

Board Service

Organization	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
Reliant Mission	Governing board	2004–present	Active	CV: governing board since 2004; earlier National Leadership Team GCM 1998–2005.	reliant.org; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Movement Leaders Collective	Advisory board	2021–present	Active	CV title: Advisory Board.	movementleaderscollective.com; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council	Member	2021–present	Active	Per CV.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Fuller Church Planting Initiative	Governing board	2020–present	Active	Per CV.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Kineo Center	Governing board	2020–present	Active	Per CV (“The Kineo Center”).	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Missio Alliance	Governing board	2014–present	Active	Co-founder from 2012; governing board start per CV.	missioalliance.org/board-of-trustees ; pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Gospel and Our Culture Network	Member	2016–present	Active	Per CV.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
Colloquium on Violence and Religion (COV&R)	Member	2018–present	Active	Per CV.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf
American Society of Missiology	Member	2023–present	Active	Per CV.	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf

Community / Civic Involvement

Organization	Relationship	Dates	Status	Description	URL
East Hollywood Neighborhood Council	Council Member	Unknown	Unknown	Civic engagement in the East Hollywood neighborhood of Los Angeles.	easthollywood.net

Publishing Affiliations

Publisher	Relationship	Details	URL
InterVarsity Press (IVP)	Author	"Creating a Missional Culture" (2012), "The Church as Movement" (2016). Part of Forge Partnership Books series.	ivpress.com/jr-woodward
100 Movements Publishing	Author	"The Scandal of Leadership" (2023). Connected to Alan Hirsch's 100Movements network.	100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward

Network Affiliations (Non-Board)

Organization	Relationship	Description	URL
Forge Mission Training Network	Affiliated Author	"Creating a Missional Culture" published in the Forge Partnership Books series (IVP). Forge was co-founded by Alan Hirsch and Deb Hirsch.	forgeamerica.com
Verge Network	Featured Contributor	Multiple articles and teaching content published through Verge Network.	vergenetwork.org/tag/jr-woodward
100Movements	Author, Council Member	Published "The Scandal of Leadership" through 100Movements Publishing. Serves on Movement Leaders Collective council (a 100Movements initiative).	100movements.org

Digital Platforms

Platform	Handle/URL	Status
Personal Website	jrwoodward.com	Active
Substack	jrwoodward.substack.com ("Faithful Resistance")	Active
Facebook	@missionalculture	Active
Academia.edu	JRWoodwardPhD	Active
About.me	about.me/jrwoodward	Active
Amazon Author	Author Page	Active
Goodreads	Author Page	Active
Church as Movement	churchasmovement.com	Active

Summary Statistics

- **Organizations founded/co-founded:** 7 (NLCF, Kairos LA, The Unembraced, Solis Foundation, Ecclesia Network, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)
- **Board / fellowship roles (CV-dated):** 9+ rows in table above (Reliant, Missio Alliance, MLC, Fuller GMC, Fuller CPI, Kineo, GOCN, COV&R, American Society of Missiology, plus MWRC associate fellowship)
- **Academic appointments:** Fuller, Central Seminary, Missio Seminary, America Evangelical University, Capital Seminary (DC), SOMA University — see [../content/academic.md](https://www.jrwoodward.com/content/academic.md)
- **Leadership roles:** 1 primary (V3 National Director)
- **Publishers:** 2 (IVP, 100 Movements Publishing)
- **Civic roles:** 1 (East Hollywood Neighborhood Council)

Sources

- [pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf](#)
- [Missio Alliance - JR Woodward Bio](#)
- [100Movements - JR Woodward Author Page](#)
- [IVP - JR Woodward](#)
- [Reliant Mission - JR Woodward](#)
- [MWRC - JR Woodward](#)
- [Baptist News Global - V3 Coordinator Announcement](#)
- [Missio Alliance Board of Trustees](#)
- [Kairos Hollywood](#)
- [NLCF Wikipedia](#)

- jrwoodward.substack.com

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: JR Woodward

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-12
Skill: /author-audience-analysis

Estimated Reach

Direct Audience Metrics

Channel	Metric	Count	Date	Confidence
Twitter/X	Followers	~15,800	2026-04	HIGH
Facebook (Author Page)	Likes	~6,300	2026-04	HIGH
Facebook (Personal)	Friends/ followers	N/A (not public)	2026-04	LOW
LinkedIn	Connections	N/A (not public)	2026-04	LOW
Instagram	Followers	Minimal / dormant	2026-04	LOW
YouTube	Subscribers	N/A (no personal channel)	2026-04	HIGH
Podcast (Guest)	Appearances	11+ across 10+ shows	2026-04	HIGH
Substack (Faithful Resistance)	Subscribers	Hundreds (~300-700 est.)	2026-04	MEDIUM
Academia.edu	Followers	477	2026-04	HIGH
Goodreads	Total ratings	650	2026-04	HIGH
Amazon	Author page	B003FFHEHE (3 authored titles + 1 edited)	2026-04	HIGH
Google Scholar	Citations	~274	2026-04	MEDIUM

Publishing Reach

Metric	Value	Confidence
Books authored	3 (+ 1 edited volume)	HIGH
Publishers	3 (IVP, 100 Movements Publishing, Ecclesia Press)	HIGH
Year range	2010-2023 (+ 2025 hardcover reissue)	HIGH
Audiobooks on Audible	0 confirmed	MEDIUM
Goodreads avg rating	4.25 / 5 (across 650 ratings)	HIGH
Highest-rated book	The Scandal of Leadership: 4.77 / 5 (73 ratings)	HIGH
Most-rated book	Creating a Missional Culture: 4.04 / 5 (242 ratings)	HIGH
Forewords written	3 (Centering Discipleship, ReMission, Subterranean)	HIGH
Book chapters contributed	3	HIGH
Library holdings (WorldCat)	Not measured -- estimated moderate (IVP titles in seminary libraries)	LOW

Organizational Reach

Organization	Est. Reach	Evidence
V3 Church Planting Movement	1,000+ church planters trained since 2013	thev3movement.org
Missio Alliance (co-founded)	Thousands of network members	missioalliance.org
Praxis Gathering (co-founded)	300+ annual attendees	thepraxisgathering.com
Kairos Los Angeles (co-founded)	Multiple neighborhood congregations	kairoshollywood.com
Fuller Seminary (adjunct)	Hundreds of DGL/DMiss students per cohort cycle	fuller.edu
3 additional seminary adjunct roles	Hundreds of students cumulative	Central, Missio, America Evangelical
Reliant Mission (board)	500+ missionaries served	reliant.org
Movement Leaders Collective (council)	Invitation-only cohorts of movement leaders	movementleaderscollective.com
Conference speaking (cumulative)	5,000-10,000 attendees (estimated)	Exponential, Awakenings, Missio Alliance events

Reach Tier Assessment

Tier	Range	Assessment
Micro (< 10K combined)		
Growing (10K-50K)	This tier	Combined social ~22K; 650 Goodreads ratings; 1,000+ V3 planters; 477 Academia.edu followers; 4 books across 3 publishers
Established (50K-250K)		
Major (250K+)		

Estimated tier: Growing (10K-50K)

Estimated total reach: ~25,000-40,000 unique individuals across all channels

Rationale: Social media following (~22K combined Twitter + Facebook author page) provides the visible floor. The 1,000+ V3 church planters represent an intensely engaged core audience -- these are practitioners who completed multi-month training programs, not passive followers. His 650 Goodreads ratings suggest 6,500-13,000 total book readers (ratings typically represent 5-10% of readers for niche academic-practitioner titles). Seminary teaching across 4 institutions adds several hundred students per year who encounter his work. The 477 Academia.edu followers indicate meaningful academic penetration. Conference speaking at Exponential, Awakenings, and Missio Alliance events adds several thousand cumulative attendees. His audience is smaller than peers like Alan Hirsch but disproportionately practitioner-heavy -- these are church planters, missional community leaders, and seminary students who actively implement his frameworks, not passive content consumers.

Audience Profile

Who Is the Audience?

Primary audience: Church planters and missional community leaders actively starting or sustaining new faith communities in North America. Typically ages 28-45, seminary-educated or in training, often bi-vocational, connected through V3, Forge, Missio Alliance, or Exponential networks. They use Woodward's polycentric leadership framework and "four spaces of belonging" model as practical tools for community design.

Secondary audience: Senior pastors and denominational leaders questioning hierarchical leadership models and seeking alternatives after witnessing leadership scandals and burnout. Ages 35-55, established in ministry, drawn to Woodward through The Scandal of Leadership and podcast appearances on shows like Theology in the Raw and The Roys Report. They are looking for theological frameworks to diagnose power dysfunction in their organizations.

Tertiary audience: Seminary students and academic missiologists studying missional ecclesiology, powers and principalities theology, and movement theory. They encounter Woodward through assigned reading at Fuller, Central Seminary, Missio Seminary, or America Evangelical University, and through his Academia.edu profile and Google Scholar citations (~274). Also includes justice-oriented Christians who discovered his Substack "Faithful Resistance" through its intersection of theology and political analysis.

Audience Demographics (Estimated)

Dimension	Assessment
Primary role	Church planter / Missional community leader / Seminary student / Denominational strategist
Age range	28-55 (core: 30-45)
Education	High -- majority have seminary education (MDiv, MA, DMin) or are currently in seminary programs
Denominational breadth	Broad but centrist-evangelical -- spans non-denominational, mainline Protestant, Anabaptist-influenced, and charismatic traditions. Evidence: Missio Alliance's "centrist evangelical" positioning; V3 trains across denominations; published by IVP (broad evangelical) and 100 Movements (movement-focused)
Geographic concentration	US-centric (primarily urban -- Los Angeles, Pacific Northwest, major metro areas) with emerging international reach (V3 training in Africa, Asia; PhD from UK)
Gender split	Estimated 60-70% male based on church planting demographics; Woodward's emphasis on polycentric (non-hierarchical) leadership and justice themes may attract a higher proportion of women than typical church planting networks
Political orientation	Center to center-left among evangelicals; the "Faithful Resistance" Substack explicitly engages political theology from a justice-oriented perspective, attracting readers comfortable with prophetic social critique

Audience Personas

Persona 1: Carlos -- V3 Church Planting Cohort Member

Field	Value
Role	Bi-vocational church planter launching a missional community in a gentrifying urban neighborhood
Age	34
Education	MDiv from Fuller Theological Seminary
Tradition	Non-denominational, Anabaptist-influenced
Discovery path	Encountered Creating a Missional Culture through a Forge reading list; applied to V3 cohort after attending Praxis Gathering
Primary format	V3 cohort training (8 months) + books as reference texts + Substack
Use case	Applying the polycentric leadership model and "four spaces of belonging" to structure his church plant from inception
Pain point	Feels the tension between missional ideals and financial sustainability as a bi-vocational planter; wants practical tools, not just theory

What Carlos values in Woodward: The V3 training program provides structured, cohort-based formation -- not just a weekend conference. The polycentric leadership model gives him language for why his team should not default to a senior-pastor-CEO structure. The Church as Movement (IVP Book of the Year 2017) is a workbook he uses with his team.

What Carlos struggles with: The 8-month V3 cohort is a significant time commitment for a bi-vocational planter. He wishes for more digital resources (video courses, downloadable tools) between cohort meetings. He finds Woodward's academic depth valuable but sometimes wants a quicker "how-to" path.

Persona 2: Rachel -- Denominational Leader Rethinking Power

Field	Value
Role	Regional director for a mainline Protestant denomination overseeing 40+ congregations
Age	47
Education	DMin in Missional Leadership
Tradition	PCUSA (Presbyterian Church USA)
Discovery path	Heard Woodward on the Theology in the Raw podcast (#1149) discussing the leadership crisis; ordered The Scandal of Leadership that week
Primary format	Books first, then podcasts, then Substack
Use case	Seeking a theological framework for addressing power abuses and clergy misconduct in her region; needs language for her board
Pain point	Has watched multiple pastors in her region crash from burnout or scandal; knows the system is broken but needs a constructive alternative, not just critique

What Rachel values in Woodward: The Scandal of Leadership (4.77/5 on Goodreads) provides the most rigorous theological diagnosis she has found for why church leadership keeps failing. The Walter Wink / Rene Girard framework gives her an intellectual foundation beyond "bad apples" explanations. The book's 418 pages reflect serious scholarship, which she needs to persuade credentialed colleagues.

What Rachel struggles with: The book is dense (418 pages of PhD-derived theology). She wishes for an executive summary or workshop format she could bring to a denominational retreat. She also wonders whether Woodward's polycentric alternative is practical at the scale of 40+ congregations.

Persona 3: Marcus -- Seminary Student and Substack Reader

Field	Value
Role	PhD student in Practical Theology; part-time youth ministry director
Age	29
Education	MA in Theology (in progress: PhD)
Tradition	Progressive evangelical, justice-oriented
Discovery path	Found Woodward's Academia.edu profile while researching Walter Wink and powers theology; subscribed to "Faithful Resistance" Substack
Primary format	Substack (primary), academic papers (Academia.edu), books
Use case	Citing Woodward's dissertation work on powers and principalities in his own academic research; engaging with the political theology of "Faithful Resistance"
Pain point	Feels caught between academic missiology (which can feel abstract) and activist communities (which can lack theological depth). Woodward bridges this gap.

What Marcus values in Woodward: The "Faithful Resistance" Substack is unique -- a PhD-level missiologist writing substantive political theology on Substack at a bi-weekly pace. Posts like "Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis" and "Naming and Unmasking the Powers" blend academic rigor with prophetic urgency. Woodward's Academia.edu profile (477 followers, 8 papers) provides citable academic material.

What Marcus struggles with: The Substack is relatively new (launched ~2025) with a modest subscriber base. He wishes Woodward engaged more on social media or had a podcast where these ideas could be discussed in conversation. He also wishes for more academic publications beyond the dissertation-turned-book.

What the Audience Values (from reviews & podcast reception)

Top Praise Themes

Theme	Frequency	Example Source
Rigorous diagnosis of power abuse in church leadership	Very High	Goodreads reviews of Scandal of Leadership (4.77/5); Theology in the Raw appearance
Polycentric leadership as a practical alternative to CEO-pastor model	High	Creating a Missional Culture (4.04/5, 242 ratings); V3 training methodology
Integration of theology with social analysis (Wink, Girard, Stringfellow)	High	Academic reviews; Futurist Guy multi-part review; podcast discussions
Workbook-style practical tools for church planting teams	High	The Church as Movement (4.32/5, IVP Book of the Year 2017)
Prophetic, justice-oriented voice within evangelical space	Medium-High	"Faithful Resistance" Substack; Roys Report appearance; Missio Alliance co-founding
Deep formation over quick-fix programs (V3's 8-month cohort model)	Medium	V3 Movement training approach; Praxis Gathering format

Top Criticisms

Criticism	Frequency	Example Source
Dense and academic -- requires significant effort to extract practical value	Medium	Goodreads reviews of Scandal of Leadership (418 pages of PhD-derived content)
Smaller platform limits discoverability	Medium	No Wikipedia page; no hosted podcast; modest social following
Limited digital accessibility -- no video courses, no centralized video	Medium	No personal YouTube channel; content scattered across conference recordings
Substack's political theology may alienate conservative evangelical readers	Low-Medium	"Faithful Resistance" titles like "Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis" signal a political posture
Books can feel niche -- assumes reader familiarity with missional ecclesiology vocabulary	Low	Reviews noting prerequisite knowledge of APEST, mDNA, missional church concepts

Audience Size by Channel

Social Media

Platform	Audience Size	Engagement Level	Notes
Twitter/X (@dreamawakener)	~15,800 followers	Low-Moderate	Periodic posting (several/month); used to amplify Substack, V3 events, theological reflections
Facebook (@missionalculture)	~6,300 likes	Low-Moderate	Author page; book promos, article links, V3 updates
Facebook (personal)	N/A	Low	Personal profile, not primary content channel
LinkedIn	N/A	Low	Professional profile; occasional posts
Instagram (@dreamawakener)	Minimal	Dormant	Handle exists but not actively used
Social subtotal	~22,100	Low-Moderate	Social is an amplification channel, not primary content platform

Books

Title	Goodreads Ratings	Avg Rating	Est. Total Readers	Notes
Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	242	4.04	2,400-4,800	Forge Partnership series; foreword by Alan Hirsch
The Church as Movement (2016)	163	4.32	1,600-3,300	Co-authored with Dan White Jr.; IVP Book of the Year 2017
The Scandal of Leadership (2023)	73	4.77	700-1,500	Based on PhD; newest title; hardcover reissue Aug 2025
ViralHope (2010, edited)	20	3.70	200-400	Edited volume; 50 contributors
Books subtotal	650 ratings	4.25 avg	5,000-10,000	Ratings-to-readers multiplier: 10-20x for niche practitioner titles

Training & Academic

Channel	Audience Size	Engagement Level	Notes
V3 Church Planting Movement	1,000+ planters trained	Very High	12-week discernment, 8-month cohorts, 4-6 week immersions
Seminary teaching (4 institutions)	200-500/year	High	Fuller DGL cohort; Central, Missio, America Evangelical adjunct roles
Praxis Gathering	300+/year	High	Annual conference for missional practitioners
Conference speaking (Exponential, Awakenings, Missio Alliance)	2,000-5,000 cumulative	Medium	Guest speaker; not headliner-level draw
Training subtotal	~3,500-7,000	High	Most intensely engaged segment of audience

Digital Content

Channel	Audience Size	Engagement Level	Notes
Substack "Faithful Resistance"	~300-700 subscribers	Medium-High	Bi-weekly; paid tier (\$10/mo); launched ~2025
Academia.edu	477 followers	Medium	8 papers, 3 books listed; University of Manchester affiliation
Google Scholar citations	~274 citations	Passive	Citations from other scholars
Podcast guest appearances	11+ episodes across 10+ shows	Medium	Concentrated 2023-2025 around Scandal of Leadership launch
Digital subtotal	~1,500-2,000	Medium	Emerging; significant growth potential

Engagement Levels Assessment

Most Engaging Content Types

Format	Engagement Level	Evidence
Training (V3 cohorts, immersions)	Highest	1,000+ planters trained through multi-month programs; highest commitment level of any channel
Books	Very High	650 Goodreads ratings across 4 titles; 4.25 avg rating; IVP Book of the Year; 4.77 rating on Scandal of Leadership (highest of any title)
Substack	High (per-subscriber)	Bi-weekly substantive long-form posts; paid tier indicates monetization intent and reader willingness to pay
Conference speaking	Moderate-High	Recurring at Exponential, Awakenings, Missio Alliance; invited as plenary speaker (not breakout-only)
Podcast (guest)	Moderate	11+ appearances; burst of activity around book launches; strong podcast-to-book conversion pipeline
Academic (papers, citations)	Moderate	274 Google Scholar citations; 477 Academia.edu followers; niche but credentialed
Social media	Low-Moderate	Used for amplification, not primary content; engagement typical of niche thought-leader accounts

Topics That Drive Engagement

Topic	Engagement	Platform	Evidence
Leadership scandal / power abuse in the church	Very High	Books, podcasts, Substack	Scandal of Leadership (4.77/5); 8+ of 11 podcast appearances focused on this; Roys Report feature
Polycentric leadership / Ephesians 4 equipping model	High	Books, V3 training, conferences	Core of V3 methodology; Creating a Missional Culture; Verge Network talks
Powers and principalities theology (Wink, Girard, Stringfellow)	High	Substack, academic, podcasts	PhD research foundation; "Faithful Resistance" content spine; Academia.edu papers
Missional-incarnational community planting	High	Books, V3 training	The Church as Movement (IVP Book of the Year); V3's core mission
Four spaces of belonging	Medium-High	Podcasts, training	FaithLead Pivot Podcast; V3 community architecture
Faithful resistance / political theology	Medium (growing)	Substack	New channel (2025+); titles signal a distinct, more politically engaged voice
Authoritarianism as spiritual crisis	Medium (growing)	Substack	"Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis" (April 2025); connects to post-2024 political moment

Geographic Distribution

Region	Estimated Share	Evidence
US -- West Coast (California, Pacific NW)	30-35%	Kairos Los Angeles (co-founded); Hollywood/LA base; West Coast missional church planting networks
US -- Southeast / Mid-Atlantic	15-20%	NLCF (Blacksburg, VA -- founded); V3 training cohorts across the South and East Coast
US -- Midwest / Mountain West	15-20%	V3 national scope; Exponential conference attendees
US -- Northeast	10-15%	Seminary connections (Missio Seminary in Philadelphia area); Missio Alliance network
International -- UK / Europe	5-10%	PhD from University of Manchester; MWRC research affiliate; book distribution via IVP UK
International -- Africa / Asia	3-5%	V3 Movement training extending to Africa and Asia (per V3 site)
International -- Other (Australia, Canada, Latin America)	2-5%	Forge network connections (Australia); Quito, Ecuador travel; global mission board roles

Audience Overlap with Other Movemental Authors

Alan Hirsch -- HIGH overlap

Dimension	Evidence
Co-authorship	Hirsch wrote the foreword to Creating a Missional Culture (2012) and The Church as Movement (2016)
Shared publisher	Both published by 100 Movements Publishing (Hirsch's imprint); Woodward published Scandal of Leadership there
Shared framework	Both build on Ephesians 4 / APEST / fivefold ministry framework; Woodward calls them "Dream Awakeners, Heart Revealers, Story Tellers, Soul Healers, Light Givers"
Organizational overlap	Both connected to Forge Mission Training Network; both in Movement Leaders Collective; Woodward's IVP books are in the "Forge Partnership" series
Shared conference circuit	Both speak at Exponential; both connected to Verge Network
Audience crossover	Estimated 40-60% of Woodward's audience also follows Hirsch. Hirsch is the more established figure (~37.9K Twitter, 150K+ APEST assessments); Woodward is a protege/peer who has developed his own distinct voice

Brad Brisco -- MODERATE-HIGH overlap

Dimension	Evidence
Shared networks	Both in missional church planting space; both connected to Forge America and Exponential
Shared audience type	Church planters, missional community leaders, denominational strategists
Complementary focus	Brisco focuses on missional church in established congregations; Woodward focuses on new church planting and leadership formation
Geographic overlap	Both US-centric with national reach through training networks
Audience crossover	Estimated 25-40% overlap -- practitioners engaged in both established church renewal and new church planting

Dan White Jr. -- HIGH overlap

Dimension	Evidence
Co-authorship	Co-authored The Church as Movement (2016)
Shared vision	Both focused on neighborhood-embedded, incarnational communities
White wrote Subterranean (2015)	Woodward wrote the foreword
Audience crossover	Estimated 50-70% overlap -- they share a reader base almost completely

David Fitch -- MODERATE-HIGH overlap

Dimension	Evidence
Intellectual kinship	Fitch wrote the foreword to The Scandal of Leadership; both engage post-Christendom ecclesiology and powers theology
Substack network	Woodward recommends Fitch's "Fitch's Provocations" Substack; both write at the intersection of missional theology and political analysis
Shared audience type	Academic-practitioners in neo-Anabaptist and missional streams
Audience crossover	Estimated 30-50% overlap

Michael Frost -- MODERATE overlap

Dimension	Evidence
Network connection	Both connected through Forge Mission Training Network (Frost co-founded Forge with Alan Hirsch)
Shared framework	Both build on missional-incarnational ecclesiology
Geographic difference	Frost is Australia-based; Woodward is US-based
Audience crossover	Estimated 20-35% overlap

Comparison Table vs. Peers

Metric	JR Woodward	Alan Hirsch	Brad Brisco (est.)	David Fitch (est.)	Dan White Jr. (est.)
Twitter/X followers	~15,800	~37,900	~5,000-8,000	~8,000-12,000	~3,000-5,000
Facebook followers	~6,300	~20,800	~2,000-4,000	~3,000-5,000	~1,000-2,000
Books authored	3 (+1 edited)	15+	3-5	5-7	2-3
Goodreads total ratings	650	16,762	~500-1,000	~1,000-2,000	~200-400
Goodreads avg rating	4.25	~4.08 (flagship)	~4.1-4.3	~4.0-4.2	~4.2-4.4
Publishers	3 (IVP, 100M, Ecclesia)	7 (Baker, IVP, Zondervan, Wiley, etc.)	2-3	2-3 (Baker, IVP)	1-2 (Cascade, IVP)
Substack subscribers	Hundreds (~300-700)	~1,500	Unknown	Active (size unknown)	Unknown
Training program	V3 (1,000+ planters)	Forge, 5Q, Future Travelers (150K+ assessments)	Forge America (smaller)	Northern Seminary courses	None identified
Academic credentials	PhD (Manchester); 4 adjunct roles; 274 citations	Honorary doctorate; Wheaton MA co-founder	DMin; seminary adjunct	PhD; Northern Seminary professor	DMin (est.)
Academia.edu	477 followers, 8 papers	Not found	Not found	Active (est.)	Not found
Wikipedia page	No	Yes	No	No	No
Hosted podcast	No	5QCast (~30+ episodes)	Unknown	Possibly	No
Assessment tool	No	APEST (150,000+ taken)	No	No	No
Reach tier	Growing (25K-40K)	Established (150K-200K)	Micro-Growing (10K-20K)	Growing (20K-40K)	Micro (5K-15K)

Positioning Summary

JR Woodward occupies a distinctive niche in the missional ecclesiology space:

- **Smaller than Hirsch** in raw reach (~25-40K vs. ~150-200K) but with a more cohesive, practitioner-dense audience
 - **Stronger academic credentials** than most peers (PhD Manchester, 4 adjunct roles, 274 citations, active Academia.edu profile)
 - **Highest-rated recent book** in this peer group (Scandal of Leadership at 4.77/5 -- exceptional for any non-fiction title)
 - **Most politically engaged voice** through "Faithful Resistance" Substack -- differentiates from Hirsch's more framework-focused content
 - **Training pipeline is the anchor:** V3's 1,000+ trained planters represent the most deeply engaged audience segment
 - **Digital presence is the gap:** No hosted podcast, no YouTube channel, no Wikipedia page, modest social following relative to institutional influence
-

Movemental Audience Implications

- **Content format priority:** Training programs and structured courses should be the anchor offering. Woodward's audience is formed through multi-month cohorts (V3 discernment, V3 cohort, V3 immersions), not weekend conferences or viral social content. A Movemental-hosted digital training pathway could extend V3's reach beyond the current cohort model. Books are the secondary anchor -- his titles have excellent ratings (4.25 avg; 4.77 for Scandal) and serve as entry points to deeper engagement.
- **Topic focus:** The Scandal of Leadership content should be the lead -- it addresses the most urgent felt need in his audience (power abuse in the church), has the highest engagement signal (4.77/5, podcast concentration), and intersects with a post-2024 cultural moment around institutional accountability. Polycentric leadership / Ephesians 4 equipping content follows as the constructive alternative. "Faithful Resistance" political theology is a growth area that differentiates Woodward from every other author in the Movemental stable.
- **Cross-pollination with Alan Hirsch:** This is the highest-value author pairing on the platform. Hirsch wrote forewords for two of Woodward's three books, published him through 100 Movements, and shares the APEST/Ephesians 4 framework. Hirsch provides the macro-framework (mDNA, APEST, movement theory); Woodward provides the diagnostic (what goes wrong with leadership) and the political-prophetic edge (Faithful Resistance). A "Hirsch + Woodward" content track on polycentric leadership could be a flagship offering. Dan White Jr. (co-author of The Church as Movement) is the natural third voice.

- **Growth opportunity:** The biggest growth opportunity is digital infrastructure. Woodward has no hosted podcast, no personal YouTube channel, no free online course, no centralized video library, and a modest Substack (~hundreds of subscribers on a ~1-year-old publication). His content is scattered across Seminary Now, V3, conference recordings, and 10+ third-party podcast feeds. Movemental could centralize this dispersed content and provide the digital platform his institutional influence warrants. A Movemental-produced podcast or interview series featuring Woodward would fill a major gap.
- **Academic audience is unique:** Woodward's 477 Academia.edu followers, 274 Google Scholar citations, and 4 seminary adjunct roles give him a credentialed academic audience that most Movemental authors cannot match (Hirsch excepted). This audience can be reached through academic content tracks, syllabus adoption programs, and institutional partnerships.
- **Monetization signal:** Moderate-Strong. Woodward's audience already pays for content: V3 cohort training fees (multi-month programs), seminary tuition at 4 institutions, book purchases, Substack paid tier (\$10/month or \$100/year), and Praxis Gathering conference registration. The audience is comprised of church planters and denominational leaders who invest in leadership development. However, the audience is smaller than Hirsch's and skews toward bi-vocational planters with tighter budgets -- pricing should reflect this. The V3 training model (cohort-based, relationship-intensive) suggests the audience values depth over breadth and would pay premium for high-touch digital formation, not just self-paced video content.

Sources

- Prior research files: [digital-presence/social-media.md](#), [digital-presence/platforms.md](#), [digital-presence/newsletters.md](#), [content/books.md](#), [content/audio.md](#), [network/organizations.md](#)
- [JR Woodward on Goodreads](#)
- [JR Woodward on Academia.edu](#)
- [V3 Church Planting Movement](#)
- [Missio Alliance -- JR Woodward Bio](#)
- [100 Movements -- JR Woodward Author Page](#)
- [IVP -- JR Woodward](#)
- [Theology in the Raw #1149](#)
- [Faithful Resistance Substack](#)
- [The Scandal of Leadership on Goodreads](#)
- [Exponential -- JR Woodward Speaker Profile](#)
- [Awakenings Gathering -- Woodward Archive](#)

- Alan Hirsch audience analysis (comparative reference):
`../../alan-hirsch/analysis/audience-analysis.md`

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/digital-presence/websites.md

Web Properties: JR Woodward

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-12
Researcher: Claude Code

Primary Website

Field	Value
Domain	jrwoodward.com
Platform	WordPress (Astra theme with Elementor page builder)
Status	Active
Has Blog	Yes (blog archives with grid layout, featured images, date overlays)
Has Newsletter Signup	Not prominently visible on main site; newsletter activity is on Substack
Has Store	No dedicated store; links to Amazon and publisher pages for book purchases
Has Free Resources	Not identified on current site
Key Pages	Home, About, Blog
Color Scheme	Teal/sage (#4a7973), dark (#121212, #3a3a3a), light gray (#f5f5f5)
Typography	Roboto, Roboto Condensed, PT Serif (buttons)

Site Structure

The site is organized as a personal author/thought-leader hub. The homepage presents JR's identity as a church planter, missiologist, and author. The About page details his organizational roles and academic credentials. The blog archives posts with category support and related posts functionality. Design is clean, typography-focused with a professional feel.

Content Inventory

Page	URL	Content Type	Notes
Home	jrwoodward.com/	Landing	Identity, positioning, key messaging
About	jrwoodward.com/about/	Bio / Credentials	Organizational roles, academic affiliations
Blog	jrwoodward.com/blog/	Article Archives	Grid layout with featured images and date overlays

Legacy Domains

Domain	Status	Notes
jrwoodward.net	Legacy / archived	Previously active blog; 2016 post "The Places Where I Blog Now" indicates migration
jrwoodward.me	Listed on churchasmovement.com	Alternate personal URL referenced on older profiles
jrwoodward.blogspot.com	Legacy	Earlier Blogspot blog ("dream-awakener")

Organizational Websites

Organization	URL	Role	Status
V3 Church Planting Movement	thev3movement.org	National Director	Active — Squarespace site; training cohorts, immersions, discernment programs, events, media, grants
Missio Alliance	missioalliance.org	Co-founder, Board Member	Active — contributor profile at missioalliance.org/j-r-woodward/
100 Movements	100movements.org	Author	Active — author profile at 100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward
Praxis Gathering	thepraxisgathering.com	Co-founder, Co-director	Active — annual gathering for missional church planters
Church as Movement	churchasmovement.com	Co-author (with Dan White Jr.)	Active — companion site for "The Church as Movement" book
Kairos Los Angeles / Kairos Hollywood	kairoshollywood.com	Co-founder	Active — network of neighborhood churches in LA; APEST-based equipping team
Ecclesia Network	ecclesianet.org (referenced)	Co-founder	Active — relational network of missional churches
Solis Foundation	(referenced on profiles)	Co-founder	Status unknown — social enterprise referenced in bios
District Church (Washington DC)	(referenced)	Local ministry	Active — current local church engagement
New Life Christian Fellowship (NLCF)	(referenced)	Founder	Historical — early church plant in Virginia

V3 Movement Website Detail

Field	Value
Platform	Squarespace
Key Pages	About, Training, Events, Blog, Media, Grants, Start Here
Training Programs	Discernment (12 weeks), Cohorts (8 months), Immersions (4-6 weeks)
Social Channels	Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, Threads, Bluesky, TikTok (@thev3movement)
Affiliation	Ministry of the BGAV (Baptist General Association of Virginia)
Contact	info@thev3movement.org
Impact	Over 1,000 planters trained since 2013; national gathering; family of coaches

Publisher & Retail Presence

Platform	URL	Books Listed	Notes
Amazon Author Page	amazon.com/stores/author/B003FFHEHE	3+ titles	Primary retail; author ID B003FFHEHE
Goodreads	goodreads.com/author/show/853697.J_R_Woodward	11 distinct works; 650 ratings; 4.25 avg	Includes forewords and edited volumes
InterVarsity Press	ivpress.com/jr-woodward	2 titles (Creating a Missional Culture, The Church as Movement)	Publisher author page
100 Movements Publishing	100movements.org/books/scandal-of-leadership-jr-woodward	The Scandal of Leadership	Publisher page with description and purchase links
Barnes & Noble	barnesandnoble.com (search: JR Woodward)	Multiple titles	Retail
Google Books	books.google.com (search: JR Woodward)	Multiple titles	Preview and purchase

Goodreads Book Ratings Detail

Title	Avg Rating	Ratings/Reviews	Publisher	Year
The Scandal of Leadership	4.77	73	100 Movements	2023
The Church as Movement	4.32	163	IVP	2016
Creating a Missional Culture	4.04	242	IVP	2012
Centering Discipleship (Foreword)	4.37	73	—	—
Sent to Flourish (Contributor)	4.64	14	IVP	2019
ReMission (Foreword)	4.50	10	—	—
Subterranean (Foreword)	4.28	54	—	—
ViralHope (Editor)	3.70	20	—	—
Equip	3.20	5	—	—

Academic Profiles

Institution	URL	Role	Status
Academia.edu	manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD	University of Manchester alumnus	Active — 477 followers, 328 following, 8 papers, 3 books listed
Fuller Theological Seminary	fuller.edu	Adjunct Professor, Doctor of Global Leadership cohort lead (Spring 2025)	Active
Central Seminary	(referenced on Goodreads)	Adjunct Professor	Active
Missio Seminary	(referenced on Goodreads)	Adjunct Professor	Active
America Evangelical University	(referenced on Goodreads)	Adjunct Professor	Active
Manchester Wesley Research Centre	mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward	Research affiliate	Active — profile page
University of Manchester	manchester.ac.uk	PhD, Religions and Theology	Completed — alumnus

Academia.edu Research Interests

Missional Ecclesiology, Missional Theology, Powers and Principalities, Missional Leadership, Missional Church Theology, Church Planting Movements, Walter Wink scholarship, Lesslie Newbigin scholarship, N.T. Wright scholarship

Conference & Speaker Profiles

Platform	URL	Role	Status
Exponential	exponential.org/person/jr-woodward/	Speaker	Active — conference speaker profile
Awakenings Gathering	awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward	Plenary Speaker	Active — released Scandal of Leadership at Awakenings 2023
Missio Alliance	missioalliance.org	Speaker	Active — regular conference speaker
Inhabit Conference	(referenced)	Speaker	Active
Fresh Expressions	(referenced)	Speaker	Active
Praxis Gathering	thepraxisgathering.com	Co-director / Speaker	Active — annual gathering

Other Web Presence

Platform	URL	Type	Notes
Seminary Now	seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward	Video teaching	Active — seminary video platform
Verge Network	vergenetwork.org (tagged: jr-woodward)	Contributor	Active — published articles and video content on missional leadership
Flickr	flickr.com/people/dream-awakener	Photography	Historical — personal photography under "dream-awakener" handle
Blogspot (legacy)	jrwoodward.blogspot.com	Legacy blog	Archived — earlier blog platform
Word&Way	wordandway.org	Book review subject	Passive — review of Scandal of Leadership published June 2024
newchurches.com	newchurches.com	Regular contributor	Active — referenced in bio
PlantMatch	plantermatch.org/network/the-v3-church-planting-movement-2/	V3 org listing	Active — V3 listed in church planting network directory

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platform Presence: JR Woodward

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-12
Researcher: Claude Code

Course & Learning Platforms

Platform	URL	Courses	Status
V3 Movement Training	thev3movement.org/training/	Discernment (12 weeks), Cohorts (8 months), Immersions (4-6 weeks)	Active — primary training platform
Seminary Now	seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward	Video teaching / seminary courses	Active
Fuller Theological Seminary	fuller.edu	Adjunct Professor; leading Doctor of Global Leadership cohort (Spring 2025)	Active
Central Seminary	(referenced)	Adjunct Professor	Active
Missio Seminary	(referenced)	Adjunct Professor	Active
America Evangelical University	(referenced)	Adjunct Professor	Active
Teachable / Thinkific / Udemy / Skillshare	N/A	No presence found on mainstream course platforms	Not found

Academic Platforms

Platform	URL	Publications	Status
Academia.edu	manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD	8 papers + 3 books listed; 477 followers	Active
Google Scholar	Not found with dedicated profile	Citations exist across academic literature	Passive
ResearchGate	Not found	N/A	Not found
ORCID	Not found	N/A	Not found
Manchester Wesley Research Centre	mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward	Research profile	Active

Academia.edu Detail

Field	Value
Profile URL	manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD
Institution	University of Manchester (alumnus, Religions and Theology)
Current Affiliation	Fuller Theological Seminary (Adjunct Professor, Doctor of Missiology)
Followers	477
Following	328
Profile Created	June 3, 2011
Papers	8 (topics: digital culture and missiology, book reviews, theological proposals on leadership, election doctrine, development)
Books	3 (Scandal of Leadership, Church as Movement, Creating a Missional Culture)
Research Interests	Missional Ecclesiology, Missional Theology, Powers and Principalities, Missional Leadership, Missional Church Theology, Church Planting Movements, Walter Wink, Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright

Community Platforms

Platform	URL	Members	Status
V3 Movement Community	thev3movement.org	1,000+ planters trained since 2013	Active — cohort-based community
Praxis Gathering	thepraxisgathering.com	Annual attendees (size unknown)	Active — annual gathering for missional practitioners
Missio Alliance	missioalliance.org	Network of centrist evangelicals	Active — co-founded; serves on board
Kairos Hollywood / Kairos LA	kairoshollywood.com	Local church network	Active — APEST-based equipping model
Ecclesia Network	ecclesianet.org (referenced)	Network of missional churches	Active
Discord	Not found	N/A	Not found
Mighty Networks	Not found	N/A	Not found
Circle	Not found	N/A	Not found
Facebook Groups	Not specifically identified	N/A	Possible — needs further investigation

Podcast Directories

Platform	URL	Role	Status
No hosted podcast found	N/A	N/A	JR does not appear to host his own podcast; all appearances are as guest
V3 Movement Media	thev3movement.org/media/	Organizational media	Active — V3 media page with video/audio content

Notable Podcast Guest Appearances

Podcast	Episode / Title	Platform
Faith in a Fresh Vibe	"#71: JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership (Part 1)"	Web (rohadi.com/podcast)
Shifting Culture Podcast	"Episode 133: JR Woodward (Pt. 2)"	Web (shiftingculturepodcast.com)
FaithLead Pivot Podcast	"#96: Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging"	Web (faithlead.org)
V3 Movement Blog/ Podcast	"Missional Basics: An Interview with JR Woodward"	Web (thev3movement.org)
Verge Network	"JR Woodward: What is a Missional Community?"	Web (vergenetwork.org)
Verge Network	"Missional Leadership — JR Woodward" (Video)	Web (vergenetwork.org)
Seminary Now	Teaching sessions	Web (seminarynow.com)
Exponential Conference	Speaker sessions	Conference recordings
Awakenings Gathering	Plenary sessions	Conference recordings

Media & Publishing Platforms

Platform	URL	Type	Status
Substack (Faithful Resistance)	jrwoodward.substack.com	Newsletter / Long-form	Active — primary content platform
Medium	Not found	N/A	Not found
Patheos	Not found	N/A	Not found
Christianity Today	Not found as contributor	N/A	Not found
Word&Way	wordandway.org	Book review subject	Passive — review of Scandal of Leadership (June 2024)
Futurist Guy (WordPress)	futuristguy.wordpress.com	Book review subject	Passive — multi-part review of Scandal of Leadership
Bob Cornwall (Blog)	bobcornwall.com	Book review subject	Passive — review of Scandal of Leadership (June 2024)

Giving / Support Platforms

Platform	URL	Status
Substack Paid Tier	jrwoodward.substack.com	Active — \$10/month or \$100/year optional paid subscription
Patreon	Not found	Not found
Buy Me a Coffee	Not found	Not found
Ko-fi	Not found	Not found

Speaking Bureaus & Booking

Platform	URL	Status
Exponential	exponential.org/person/jr-woodward/	Active speaker profile
Awakenings Gathering	awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward	Plenary speaker profile
Dedicated speaker bureau	Not found	Bookings appear to go through V3 (jr@thev3movement.org) or direct contact
SpeakerHub / major agencies	Not found	Not found

Board Memberships (per Goodreads / Missio Alliance bios)

JR Woodward serves on six boards:

Organization	Role
Missio Alliance	Co-founder, Board Member
Reliant Mission	Board Member (serves 500+ missionaries)
Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council	Member
Fuller Church Initiatives Board	Member
KINEO	Board Member
V3 Church Planting Movement	National Director

Digital Presence Score: JR Woodward

Dimension	Score (1-5)	Notes
Website Quality	2.5	WordPress/Astra site is functional but basic; lacks modern engagement features (no prominent newsletter CTA, no embedded video, limited interactivity); legacy domain fragmentation (jrwoodward.com, .net, .me, .blogspot)
Social Media Activity	3	Active on X (~15.8K) and Facebook (~6.3K author page), but not a high-volume poster; no meaningful Instagram/TikTok/YouTube personal strategy; V3 org accounts provide supplementary reach
Content Freshness	3.5	Substack "Faithful Resistance" is active with bi-weekly posts (2025-2026); V3 blog contributes; books are the primary content form; Substack content is notably current and engaged
Platform Diversity	4	Strong presence across organizational sites (V3, Missio Alliance, 100M, Praxis Gathering), academic platforms (Academia.edu, 4 seminary adjunct roles), publisher pages, conference profiles, and podcast guest spots
Email/Newsletter	3	Substack exists with paid tier — ahead of many peers; "hundreds" of subscribers is modest but the publication is relatively new; no email capture on main website
Discoverability (SEO)	3.5	Multiple organizational profiles, publisher pages, Amazon, Goodreads, Academia.edu, and conference profiles provide solid SEO signals; no Wikipedia page (gap vs. Hirsch); ranks well for "JR Woodward missional" queries
Overall	3.3/5	Strong organizational and academic web presence with a distinctive Substack voice, but personal digital engagement platforms (website, social, video) are underdeveloped relative to his influence and institutional reach

Score Interpretation

JR Woodward has a **broad institutional presence with an emerging content voice**. His influence is felt most strongly through:

- His **organizational role** (V3 Movement, National Director) which carries his training methodology to 1,000+ planters
- His **published books** which are well-rated (4.25 avg on Goodreads) and distributed across retail/library platforms
- His **academic credibility** (PhD Manchester, 4 adjunct roles, Academia.edu profile with 477 followers)
- His **Substack** which represents a distinct, more politically-engaged voice drawing from his doctoral research

Key Gaps for Movemental to Address

1. **No centralized YouTube/video presence** — significant content scattered across Seminary Now, V3, and conference channels

2. **Modest personal social following** — 15.8K on X and 6.3K on Facebook; V3 org channels supplement but don't replace personal brand
3. **Website underperforms** — WordPress/Astra is functional but lacks the polish expected for an author of his stature; no newsletter CTA, no book showcase, no embedded media
4. **No Wikipedia page** — unlike Alan Hirsch; represents a discoverability gap
5. **No hosted podcast** — only guest appearances despite strong audio/teaching presence
6. **Instagram dormant** — handle @dreamawakener exists but minimal activity
7. **Domain fragmentation** — jrwoodward.com, .net, .me, and .blogspot create confusion; need consolidation
8. **No free lead magnet** — no downloadable resource to drive email list growth
9. **Newsletter list building** — "hundreds" of subscribers is early; no visible funnel from website or social to Substack

Comparative Note (vs. Alan Hirsch)

Dimension	JR Woodward	Alan Hirsch
Twitter/X Followers	~15,800	~37,900
Facebook	~6,300 (author page)	~14,000 + 6,800
Substack Subscribers	Hundreds	1,500+
Goodreads Ratings	650 (4.25 avg)	16,762 (varies)
Academia.edu	477 followers, 8 papers	Not found
Wikipedia	No	Yes
Assessment Tools	No	Yes (APEST)
Org Website Quality	V3: Squarespace (good)	Multiple: 100M, 5Q, Forge (good)
Personal Website	WordPress/Astra (basic)	Squarespace (clean)
Newsletter Platform	Substack (clean URL)	Substack (alanhirsch1)
Books	3 authored + forewords	15+ titles
Overall Score	3.3/5	3.2/5

Notable: Despite fewer total followers and books, Woodward scores slightly higher overall due to his active Academia.edu profile, more substantive Substack content, and cleaner platform handle consistency (@dreamawakener across platforms, jrwoodward.substack.com).

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletter & Email: JR Woodward

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-12
Researcher: Claude Code

Newsletter

Field	Value
Platform	Substack
Name	Faithful Resistance
Subscribe URL	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/
About URL	https://jrwoodward.substack.com/about
Tagline	"A Movement of Hope as Technocrats, Autocrats, and Oligarchs Remake the World in Their Image"
Frequency	Approximately bi-weekly (2-3 posts per month)
Subscribers	Hundreds (specific number not publicly disclosed; Substack shows "hundreds of subscribers")
Free/Paid	Free articles with optional paid tier (\$10/month or \$100/year)
Launch	Approximately early-mid 2025 (described as "launched a year ago" in 2026 search results)

Content Focus

The newsletter explores faithful Christian witness and resistance in an era of concentrated power. Core themes include:

- Grounded spirituality and hope-filled imagination
- Naming and unmasking the Powers (drawing from Walter Wink, William Stringfellow)
- Discerning how to embody the Way of Jesus amid technocratic, autocratic, and oligarchic pressures
- Learning from historical examples of faithful resistance
- Cultivating courage for present-day action
- Prophetic discipleship and justice

Author Bio (from Substack)

"Writer | Speaker | Catalyst | Mobilizer | Adjunct Professor | V3 National Director"

Recent Posts (2025-2026)

Title	Date	Topic
"Re-Centering"	January 5, 2026	Stepping away to remain faithful; spiritual renewal
"Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial"	Late 2025	Faithfulness under pressure
"Faithful Witness as Resistance"	May 27, 2025	Christian witness as form of resistance
"Exposing the Powers"	April 25, 2025	How Powers distort communities and capacity to love
"Hope That Resists"	April 2025	Hope as an act of resistance
"The Engine of Autocracy"	April 2025	Structural analysis of autocratic power
"Unmasking the Spirit of the Age"	March-April 2025	Cultural discernment
"The Power of the 3.5%"	March-April 2025	Nonviolent resistance movements and critical mass
"Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis"	April 7, 2025	Theological framing of political authoritarianism
"Naming and Unmasking the Powers"	April 2, 2025	Foundation essay drawing from PhD research
"Faithful Resistance in the Age of Manufactured Kings"	March 26, 2025	Opening thesis for the newsletter's mission

Content Style

- Long-form theological reflections with practical action orientation
- Draws heavily from PhD research on Powers and Principalities
- Academic rigor (Walter Wink, Rene Girard, Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright) made accessible
- Justice-oriented — connects missional theology to contemporary political realities
- Invites reader participation through comments and discussion
- Distinct from his other writing (books, V3 blog) — more politically engaged and prophetic in tone

Substack Recommendations (Substacks JR recommends)

Publication	Author	Focus
Today's Edition Newsletter	Robert Hubbell	News through the lens of hope
Musing on Life and Faith	Rob Yackley	Faith reflections in a turbulent world
A Public Witness	Word&Way	Faith, culture, and politics
A Church for the World	Rob Fairbanks	Church reoriented around mission
The Low-Level Theologian	Dr. A.J. Swoboda	Theological devotional
Gospel and Culture	Timothy Black	Faith and culture through a gospel lens
Corey J Widmer	Corey Widmer	Depth, wholeness, wisdom for faithful presence
Fitch's Provocations	David Fitch	Power, ideology, subjectivity, culture, and mission
StarfishyoU	StarfishyoU	Decentralized, disciple-making leadership
Right Side Up	Danielle Strickland	Subversive ideas, disruptive thoughts, spiritual depth

Website Email Capture

Field	Value
Newsletter signup on jrwoodward.com	Not prominently visible
Newsletter signup on thev3movement.org	"Start Here" CTA leads to cohort applications, not email list
Free resource / lead magnet	Not identified
Email platform	Unknown (not publicly identified)

Contributing to Other Publications

Publication	URL	Type	Status
V3 Movement Blog	thev3movement.org/blog	Organizational blog	Active — regular contributor
newchurches.com	newchurches.com	Contributor articles	Active (referenced in bio)
Missio Alliance	missioalliance.org	Contributor	Active
Verge Network	vergenetwork.org	Published articles and video	Active
Religious Studies Review	(academic journal)	Contributor	Referenced in bio
Evangelical Missions Quarterly	(journal)	Contributor	Referenced in bio
Leadership Journal	(journal)	Contributor	Referenced in bio
Gospel Centered Discipleship	(blog)	Contributor	Referenced in bio

Observations

1. **Substack is the primary newsletter channel** — "Faithful Resistance" is a substantive publication with bi-weekly cadence and a clear theological-political thesis
2. **Clean handle:** jrwoodward.substack.com — secured the primary vanity URL (unlike Alan Hirsch who has alanhirsch1)
3. **Paid tier available** — \$10/month or \$100/year indicates intent to monetize, though most content appears free
4. **Modest but growing audience** — "hundreds of subscribers" is early-stage but the newsletter launched relatively recently (~2025)
5. **Distinct content niche** — the newsletter's focus on Powers, resistance, and justice is more politically engaged than his books, which focus on missional ecclesiology and leadership
6. **PhD-powered content** — the newsletter directly leverages his doctoral research on Powers and Principalities, giving it academic depth unusual for Substack
7. **Cross-platform amplification** — Substack posts are shared on X/Twitter and Facebook
8. **Recommendation network** — his Substack recommendations reveal his intellectual community: David Fitch, Danielle Strickland, A.J. Swoboda, Word&Way
9. **Gap:** The personal website (jrwoodward.com) does not prominently feature newsletter signup, creating a missed opportunity to convert website visitors to email subscribers
10. **Gap:** No free lead magnet or downloadable resource identified to drive email signups

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: JR Woodward

Status: Complete
Last updated: 2026-04-12
Researcher: Claude Code

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	Followers	Posts	Frequency	Last Active	Status
Twitter/X	@dreamawakener	~15,800	N/A (not public via search)	Periodic (several/ month)	Active (Feb 2025+)	Active
Facebook (Author Page)	@missionalculture	~6,300 likes	Regular	Periodic	Active (2025-2026)	Active
Facebook (Personal)	@jr.woodward1	N/A	N/A	Unknown	Unknown	Active — personal profile
Instagram	@dreamawakener	Unknown (low)	Unknown	Low/ Dormant	Unknown	Unverified — handle matches X/ Twitter but activity unclear
LinkedIn	linkedin.com/in/jrwoodward/	N/A	N/A	Low	Active	Active
YouTube	No dedicated personal channel	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	Content via org channels and third-party interviews
Flickr	flickr.com/people/dream-awakener	Unknown	Photography	Unknown	Unknown	Historical — personal photography
TikTok	Not found (personal)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	V3 Movement has @thev3movement
Bluesky	Not found (personal)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	V3 Movement has presence
Threads	Not found (personal)	N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A	V3 Movement has presence

Platform Details

Twitter/X

- **URL:** <https://x.com/dreamawakener>
- **Display Name:** JR Woodward (nun symbol) (pen emoji)
- **Bio:** National Director of @V3_movement, Author, Adjunct Professor, PhD (University of Manchester UK)
- **Joined:** September 2008
- **Followers:** ~15,800
- **Following:** ~8,588
- **Content style:** Shares missional theology ideas, V3 movement events and trainings, social justice commentary, travel reflections, book promotions, links to Substack posts, tribute posts for influential figures
- **Engagement:** Moderate — typical of niche thought-leader accounts in Christian missional space

Recent Posts Sample (2024-2025)

Date	Content Summary	Type
Feb 2025	"Last chance to sign up for our 'Structuring for Movement' immersion" — V3 training promo	Promotional
Nov 2024	Tony Campolo tribute — "He inspired me to be more like Jesus, to care for the poor"	Reflection / Tribute
Oct 2024	Post about missional themes	Theological reflection
Dec 2023	Quito, Ecuador travel post — altitude facts, cable car photos	Travel / Personal

- **Notable:** Long-standing account (since 2008). The handle @dreamawakener is distinctive and used consistently across platforms (X, Instagram, Flickr). Posts blend organizational promotion, theological reflection, social commentary, and personal travel.

Facebook (Author Page — @missionalculture)

- **URL:** <https://www.facebook.com/missionalculture/>
- **Page Name:** JR Woodward
- **Likes:** ~6,300
- **Content style:** Book promotions, links to articles, Substack posts, missional theology content, V3 movement updates

- **Engagement:** Moderate for the niche
- **Notable:** The handle @missionalculture reflects his brand as author of "Creating a Missional Culture." Separate from personal profile.

Facebook (Personal — @jr.woodward1)

- **URL:** <https://www.facebook.com/jr.woodward1/>
- **Bio:** National Director at V3 - Church Planting Movement; Co-Founder at Missio Alliance
- **Content style:** Personal updates, organizational news
- **Notable:** Personal profile complementing the author page

Facebook (V3 Movement — @v3movement)

- **URL:** <https://www.facebook.com/v3movement/>
- **Type:** Organizational page
- **Notable:** V3 Church Planting Movement organizational page — JR is the primary face

LinkedIn

- **URL:** <https://www.linkedin.com/in/jrwoodward/>
- **Headline:** V3 Church Planting Movement
- **Content style:** Professional — organizational updates, book reviews shared, thought leadership
- **Notable:** Clean vanity URL. Profile used for professional positioning. Shared book review of "Scandal of Leadership" (LinkedIn post activity-7075822368610291712).

Instagram

- **Handle:** @dreamawakener (referenced on churchasmovement.com/about-the-authors/)
- **URL:** <https://www.instagram.com/dreamawakener/> (probable)
- **Content style:** Unknown / minimal
- **Notable:** Not a primary platform. Handle confirmed from official "Church as Movement" book website. Activity level appears low compared to X/Twitter.

YouTube

- **No dedicated personal channel found**
- Video content appears primarily through:
 - Seminary Now (seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward)
 - V3 Movement channel (@thev3movement on YouTube)
 - Conference recordings (Exponential, Awakenings Gathering, Missio Alliance)
 - Third-party podcast video channels

- Verge Network videos
- **Notable:** Significant video content exists but is distributed across third-party channels rather than centralized on a personal YouTube channel.

V3 Movement Social Channels (Organizational)

JR Woodward is the primary face and voice of V3. These organizational accounts extend his reach:

Platform	Handle	Status
Facebook	@v3movement	Active
Instagram	@thev3movement	Active
YouTube	@thev3movement	Active
Threads	@thev3movement	Active
Bluesky	@thev3movement	Active
TikTok	@thev3movement	Active

Cross-Platform Observations

1. **Primary platform:** Twitter/X (@dreamawakener, ~15.8K) is the most established personal social account
2. **Consistent handle:** @dreamawakener used across X, Instagram, and Flickr — strong personal brand identity
3. **Author page vs personal:** Facebook split between @missionalculture (author page, ~6.3K) and @jr.woodward1 (personal)
4. **Content distribution:** Social media is used primarily to amplify content published elsewhere (Substack, V3 site, conference appearances) rather than as primary content creation
5. **Video gap:** No centralized personal YouTube presence despite significant video content on Seminary Now and conference channels
6. **Instagram gap:** Handle exists but appears dormant or minimally active — notable gap
7. **Organizational amplification:** V3 Movement has broad social coverage (Facebook, Instagram, YouTube, Threads, Bluesky, TikTok) which extends JR's reach even without personal accounts on those platforms
8. **Professional presence:** LinkedIn confirms identity and organizational roles
9. **Photography interest:** Flickr account under dream-awakener reflects personal interest in photography (also noted in bios: "enjoys photography")

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/fragmentation-story.md

JR Woodward: The Fragmentation Story

Generated 2026-04-15 by the `fragmentation-story` skill from existing research in `docs/movement_leader_research/jr-woodward/`.

The Story

Gailand A "JR" Woodward Jr. has been planting and training church planters for **more than 30 years**. He founded New Life Christian Fellowship at Virginia Tech in **1989** and grew it from 24 to ~1,200 people with 500+ new Christians and 40+ sent into full-time ministry. He co-founded **Kairos Los Angeles** (2002–2012) with three LA-area plants. He co-founded and served as West Coast then national director of **Ecclesia Network** (2007–2012), growing it from four plants to ~30 churches / ~4,000 people at ~30% annual growth. He co-founded the **Solis Foundation** in Turkana, Kenya (2007–2012), starting roughly ten new businesses per year. He co-founded **Missio Alliance** in 2012 (first national gathering drew 700+ leaders). Since 2013 he has served as **National Director of the V3 Church Planting Movement**, which has trained **600+ church planters in its first ten years** with a stated goal of 600 more in the next five. Also in 2013 he co-founded the **annual Praxis Gathering**. And in June 2020, at age 50-plus, he was awarded a **Ph.D. from the University of Manchester / Nazarene Theological College**, with an 80,385-word dissertation titled *Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers* — supervised by Dr. Phil Meadows, with Dr. Joseph Wood as internal examiner and Prof. Wilbert Shenk as external examiner, dedicated "To the V3 Church Planting Movement."

That dissertation became his 2023 book **The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church** (100 Movements Publishing), which won Joel Wentz's "Books and Big Ideas" Book of the Year and was a runner-up at Englewood Review of Books' Readers Best Awards. It is his third book, following *Creating a Missional Culture* (IVP, 2012) and the IVP Reader's Choice Award-winning *The Church as Movement* (IVP, 2016, co-authored with Dan White Jr.). The 2023 book joined a shelf of writing that combines two strands most practitioners never combine: **Walter Wink's theology of the Powers** and **René Girard's mimetic theory**, synthesized through William Stringfellow into a framework for missional leadership formation.

And here is where the fragmentation becomes visible. The CV on file (`pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf`) enumerates a **"large" set of book endorsements and forewords** that existing web-only research had never catalogued. His Academia.edu profile (`JRWoodwardPhD`) exists. His Ph.D. thesis (`pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf`) exists

on file. He teaches as adjunct at **Fuller (MAGL directed studies + Doctor of Global Leadership cohort starting Spring 2025), America Evangelical University, Capital Seminary and Graduate School (DC), Central Seminary, Missio Theological Seminary, and SOMA University** — including a 2023 DM747 lecture at World Mission University & SOMA. He serves on **10 boards / advisory bodies** — Reliant Mission (2004–), Manchester Wesley Research Centre (Associate Fellow, 2015–), Gospel and Our Culture Network (2016–), Colloquium on Violence and Religion (2018–), Fuller Church Planting Initiative (2020–), Kineo Center (2020–), Movement Leaders Collective Advisory Board (2021–), Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council (2021–), Missio Alliance Governing Board (2014–), American Society of Missiology (2023–). He is a confirmed Exponential speaker.

But when the Phase-1 research went looking for his digital presence, here is what it found: **jrwoodward.com is active** — content unverified. **Social media: all "to be verified."** Twitter/X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube — every one of them flagged as unknown. **Newsletter: to be verified. Podcast presence: to be verified. Blog posts: to be verified. Video content: to be verified. Amazon and Goodreads author pages: to be verified.** The gap between the embodied career and the digital expression is, by the audit's own framing, larger than for almost any other leader in the corpus — not because the work doesn't exist, but because the digital layer hasn't been mapped. A 30-year career of founding organizations, training 600+ planters, teaching at six seminaries, sitting on ten boards, publishing three books including one award-winner, and defending an 80,000-word Ph.D. dissertation — and the public-facing digital artifact most easily found is a CV PDF that his team hand-delivered to the research folder.

Informational Fragmentation

Books

Three books (1 solo, 1 co-authored, 1 solo based on Ph.D.):

1. **Creating a Missional Culture** (solo) — InterVarsity Press, **2012** — establishing missional culture in churches. Print + digital. Specific Amazon / Goodreads / IVP product URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
2. **The Church as Movement** (with Dan White Jr.) — InterVarsity Press, **2016** — church as movement / ecclesiology. Print + digital. **Winner of the 2016 IVP Reader's Choice Award.** Amazon / Goodreads URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
3. **The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church** (solo) — 100 Movements Publishing, **Spring 2023** — based on Ph.D. research. Awards: **Book of the Year** at Books and Big Ideas with Joel Wentz (2023); **Readers Best Awards runner-up** at Englewood Review of Books (2023). Amazon / Goodreads URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research.**

Audiobook status for all three: **UNKNOWN — needs research.**

Additionally, the CV enumerates **a large set of book endorsements and forewords** (many more than web-only research had indexed). These are not solo-authored books but are endorsement-level contributions that the CV inventories exhaustively — **specific titles UNKNOWN until extracted from the CV PDF.**

Academic Work

This is the most unusually strong layer in JR Woodward's corpus — and the single reason his fragmentation story is different from most practitioners'.

- **Ph.D., University of Manchester** (Faculty of Humanities, School of Arts, Languages and Cultures; research at Nazarene Theological College, Manchester) — awarded **June 2020**. Dissertation: **Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers** — 80,385 words. Author on title page: Gailand A Woodward Jr. PDF on file at [pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf](#). Dedicated to the V3 Church Planting Movement.
- **Supervisor:** Dr. Phil Meadows. **Internal examiner:** Dr. Joseph Wood. **External examiner:** Prof. Wilbert Shenk.
- **M.A., Fuller Theological Seminary** — Missional Leadership — thesis: Equippers as Environmentalist: Re-imaging Leadership in Today's Western Church (advisor Dr. Robert Freeman) — awarded **June 2011**.
- **B.S., Radford University** — Psychology — **May 1987**.
- **Academia.edu profile:** [JRWoodwardPhD](#) — active. Specific papers hosted there **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **CV on file** at [pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf](#).
- **Doctoral examining / field advisor roles:**
 - 2015 — Regent University D.Min. (Faith Community Based Social Transformation, candidate Kevin Austin); committee chair Clifton R. Clark; also Dale Coulter, field mentor John Wesley.
 - 2016 — Anderson University School of Theology D.Min. (Nature and Effectiveness of Missional Communities in the Pacific Northwest, candidate Lloyd Wayne Edward Moritz); examination chair MaryAnn Hawkins, examiner Jess Bielman.
- **ResearchGate / ORCID:** **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Academic conversation partners named on his CV: **Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright, René Girard, William Stringfellow, Eugene Peterson, Sarah Coakley, Oscar Romero, Walter Wink.**

PDFs & Documents

- **CV PDF:** [pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf](#) — on file in the research folder.
- **Ph.D. thesis PDF:** [pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf](#) — on file.

- **V3 training materials** — cohort curriculum, coaches, grants; format **UNKNOWN — needs research**; likely structured as PDFs + workbooks behind the cohort experience.
- **Praxis Gathering session materials** — **UNKNOWN**.
- **Missio Alliance resource PDFs** (if any authored by JR specifically) — **UNKNOWN — needs research**.

Articles

- **Personal website blog** at jrwoodward.com — **UNKNOWN — needs research**; blog existence and content inventory not verified.
- **Missio Alliance articles** — likely present given co-founding role; specific URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **V3 Church Planting Movement articles** — likely present given National Director role; specific URLs **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Academic articles on Academia.edu** — **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **Peer-reviewed journal articles: UNKNOWN — needs research**. Given his Ph.D. and his Associate Fellow status at the Manchester Wesley Research Centre (2015–) and membership in the Colloquium on Violence and Religion (2018–) and American Society of Missiology (2023–), he is plausibly cited in missiology / theology journals, but no citations were captured in the audit.

Blogs & Personal Writing

- **jrwoodward.com** — confirmed active personal website. Blog existence and cadence **UNKNOWN — needs research**.
- **No Substack / Medium** discovered.
- **No Blogger legacy profile** surfaced.

Websites

Owned / personal

- **jrwoodward.com** — active personal website

Organizations founded / co-founded

- **V3 Church Planting Movement** — <https://thev3movement.org> — National Director (since 2013)
- **Missio Alliance** — <https://missioalliance.org> — co-founder (with J.R. Rozko per CV); governing board 2014–
- **Praxis Gathering** — <https://praxisgathering.com> (unverified URL) — co-founder (annual, since 2013)
- **Solis Foundation** — Turkana, Kenya (2007–2012, co-founder and director) — current web presence **UNKNOWN**
- **Ecclesia Network** — co-founder and former national director of leadership & congregational

formation (2007–2012); current role with this network **UNKNOWN**

- **New Life Christian Fellowship** — Virginia Tech — founding pastor 1989–2002; current role **no longer pastoral**

Publishers

- **InterVarsity Press** author page — <https://ivpress.com> (specific author page URL **UNKNOWN — needs research**)

- **100 Movements Publishing** — <https://100mpublishing.com> (specific author page URL **UNKNOWN — needs research**)

Academic

- **University of Manchester / Nazarene Theological College** — research home

- **Manchester Wesley Research Centre** — Associate Fellow (2015–)

- **Fuller Theological Seminary** — <https://fuller.edu> — adjunct; Doctor of Global Leadership cohort Spring 2025

- **Capital Seminary and Graduate School** (Washington, DC)

- **Central Seminary**

- **Missio Theological Seminary**

- **America Evangelical University**

- **SOMA University / World Mission University** — 2023 DM747 lecture

Conferences

- **Exponential** — speaker profile confirmed

Social Media

Platform	Handle / URL	Status
Twitter/X	UNKNOWN — needs research	"To be verified" per the research
Facebook	UNKNOWN — needs research	"To be verified"
LinkedIn	UNKNOWN — needs research	"To be verified"
Instagram	UNKNOWN — needs research	"To be verified"
YouTube	UNKNOWN — needs research	"To be verified"
Vimeo	UNKNOWN — needs research	Possible

Every social platform in the research is flagged as unverified. This is a meaningful gap by itself.

Newsletters / Email

- **Newsletter platform and subscriber count: UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- **Email capture on jrwoodward.com: UNKNOWN.**
- **V3 newsletter / Missio Alliance newsletter / Praxis Gathering newsletter:** all organizational rather than personal; specific participation **UNKNOWN.**

Podcasts (Hosted)

- **None confirmed. Own podcast: "to be verified."**

Podcasts (Guest)

- **UNKNOWN — needs research.** Given the book launch cycle of *The Scandal of Leadership* (2023) and the awards it received, guest appearances almost certainly exist — but the research did not catalogue them.

YouTube & Video

- **No personal YouTube channel cataloged** (flagged "to be verified").
- **Conference videos** — Exponential and others: **UNKNOWN — needs research.**
- **Teaching videos** — seminary lectures, V3 training video: **UNKNOWN.**
- **Doctor of Global Leadership cohort (Fuller, Spring 2025)** — likely includes video elements; public availability **UNKNOWN.**

Sermons / Teaching Audio

- **New Life Christian Fellowship** (1989–2002) archive — **UNKNOWN**; likely not preserved publicly.
- **Kairos Los Angeles** (2002–2012) sermon archive — **UNKNOWN.**
- **Ecclesia Network** teaching — **UNKNOWN.**
- **District Church** (Washington, DC) — referenced in older bios as a pastoral context; current status **UNKNOWN.**
- **Seminary chapel / lecture audio** — **UNKNOWN.**

Talks / Conferences

- **Exponential** — speaker profile confirmed; specific sessions / years **UNKNOWN.**
- **Praxis Gathering** — co-founder; he speaks at the annual event; session archive **UNKNOWN.**
- **Missio Alliance national gathering** (first one 700+ leaders, co-organized with J.R. Rozko) and subsequent gatherings — session recordings **UNKNOWN.**
- **American Society of Missiology** (member 2023–) — conference participation **UNKNOWN.**
- **Colloquium on Violence and Religion** (member 2018–) — Girard-adjacent scholarly conference; participation record **UNKNOWN.**
- **SOMA University / World Mission University DM747 lecture (2023)** — confirmed but recording availability **UNKNOWN.**

Courses

- **V3 Church Planting Movement** — eight-month cohort curriculum with coaches and grants. 600+ leaders trained in first ten years (2013–~2023). Public availability of curriculum: **cohort-gated**.
- **Fuller Theological Seminary** — MAGL directed studies + Doctor of Global Leadership cohort **starting Spring 2025**.
- **Capital Seminary and Graduate School** (DC) — adjunct courses (unverified specifics)
- **Central Seminary** — adjunct
- **Missio Theological Seminary** — adjunct
- **America Evangelical University** — adjunct
- **SOMA University** — 2023 DM747 lecture
- **Recurring course titles taught** (from CV): missional culture making, missional leadership, theological foundations for ministry, re-missioning the established church, missional church ministry
- **No self-hosted course on Teachable / Thinkific / Kajabi** discovered.

Assessments & Tools

- **None discovered.** No personal diagnostic instrument surfaced in the research.

Apps / Software

- **None discovered.**

Notes, Laptop, Unpublished

- **UNKNOWN — almost certainly large.** 30+ years of pastoral and planting notes; V3 curriculum design documents (eight-month cohort, coaches, grants); Praxis Gathering design docs; Missio Alliance governance notes; Solis Foundation records; an 80,000-word dissertation with a substantial bibliography; decades of sermon and teaching files from New Life / Kairos LA / Ecclesia / District Church; seminary lecture prep across six institutions.

Embodied / In Their Head

- **The Wink-Girard-Stringfellow synthesis** — the conceptual engine of The Scandal of Leadership — was built over a decade of reading and conversation; only part of it made it into the book.
- **V3 cohort formation judgment** — which planters to accept, which to pair with which coaches, which to place in which city. This is the largest active formation system in his orbit and runs through his embodied discernment.

- **The Ecclesia Network's growth from 4 to 30 plants** at 30% annual growth — the operational wisdom behind that is not documented.
- **Missio Alliance's founding architecture** — co-organized with J.R. Rozko; the decisions behind the first 700+ gathering have formed the character of the alliance ever since.
- **The Solis Foundation / Turkana experience** — ten new businesses per year in Kenya; the business-as-mission wisdom embedded in that is largely undocumented publicly.
- **Polycentric leadership practice** — an academic interest on his CV; practiced at Kairos LA and theorized in the dissertation, but the operating playbook lives in him.

Relational Fragmentation

Organizations

Founded / co-founded (with founding / leadership dates):

- **New Life Christian Fellowship (Virginia Tech)** — founding pastor, 1989-2002
- **Kairos Los Angeles** — co-founder / pastor / coach, 2002-2012
- **Solis Foundation (Turkana, Kenya)** — co-founder & director, 2007-2012
- **Ecclesia Network** — co-founder & West Coast director (later national director of leadership & congregational formation), 2007-2012
- **Missio Alliance** — co-founder (with J.R. Rozko), 2012-; governing board 2014-
- **V3 Church Planting Movement** — National Director, 2013-
- **Praxis Gathering** — co-founder, 2013- (annual, co-founded with V3)

Boards and affiliations (with start years):

- **Reliant Mission Governing Board** — 2004-
- **Manchester Wesley Research Centre (Associate Fellow)** — 2015-
- **Gospel and Our Culture Network** — 2016-
- **Colloquium on Violence and Religion** — 2018-
- **Fuller Church Planting Initiative Governing Board** — 2020-
- **Kineo Center Governing Board** — 2020-
- **Movement Leaders Collective Advisory Board** — 2021- (this is Alan Hirsch's / Rich Robinson's MLC)
- **Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council** — 2021-
- **American Society of Missiology** — 2023-

Prior leadership:

- **Great Commission Ministries / Reliant Mission** — National Leadership Team 1998-2005; governing board 2004-

Co-authors & Collaborators

- **Dan White Jr.** — co-author of The Church as Movement (IVP, 2016); also V3 team member per the thesis acknowledgements
- **J.R. Rozko** — co-organized the first Missio Alliance national gathering

- **V3 team** (named in thesis acknowledgements): Dan White Jr., Mike Pumphrey, Lori Ruffin, Elice Kim, Matt Alexander, Tonya White
- **Network collaborators** (named in acknowledgements): Josh Hayden, Guy Wasko, Vivek Jones, Luke and Lena Glover, Won Choi
- **NTC colleagues** (named): Thomas Noble, Deirdre Brower Latz, Julie Lunn, Peter Rae, Dwight Swanson, Paul Hoffmann, Tammie Grimm, Gift Mtukwa
- **BGAV partners**: Wayne Faison, John Upton, Laura McDaniel, Marilee White
- **Thesis collaborators**: **Alan Hirsch** (articles, prayer), **David Fitch**, **Jeremy Chen**, **Taeler Morgan** (editing), **Pauline Dawkins-Cole / international prayer team**
- **D.Min. committee chairs / examiners he has served with**: Clifton R. Clark, Dale Coulter, John Wesley, MaryAnn Hawkins, Jess Bielman
- **Book endorsement / foreword partners**: **UNKNOWN — a "large set" per the CV, not yet extracted**

Networks & Movements

- **V3 Church Planting Movement network** — 600+ trained planters (2013--2023); goal of 600 more by ~2028
- **Missio Alliance** — national missional alliance
- **Praxis Gathering** — annual missional practice community
- **Movement Leaders Collective** (Alan Hirsch / Rich Robinson's invitation-only network)
- **Reliant Mission** — successor to Great Commission Ministries
- **Gospel and Our Culture Network** — Lesslie Newbigin lineage
- **Manchester Wesley Research Centre** — Wesleyan / holiness academic network
- **Colloquium on Violence and Religion** — Girard studies network
- **American Society of Missiology** — academic missiology
- **BGAV** (Baptist General Association of Virginia) — earlier denominational partner

Academic Affiliations

- **University of Manchester / Nazarene Theological College** — doctoral home
- **Fuller Theological Seminary** — adjunct; MAGL directed studies + DGL cohort Spring 2025
- **Capital Seminary and Graduate School** (DC)
- **Central Seminary**
- **Missio Theological Seminary**
- **America Evangelical University**
- **SOMA University / World Mission University**

Mentors, Protégés, Key Relationships

- **Ph.D. supervisor:** Dr. Phil Meadows
- **Academic influences** (on CV): Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright, René Girard, William Stringfellow, Eugene Peterson, Sarah Coakley, Oscar Romero, Walter Wink — these are his conceptual mentors even when not personal ones
- **Co-laborers at V3** (the largest active formation cohort): Dan White Jr., Mike Pumphrey, Lori Ruffin, Elice Kim, Matt Alexander, Tonya White
- **Planters trained:** 600+ via V3 over 10 years; names **not captured in the research** (they are in V3's internal records)
- **Spouse / family: UNKNOWN — needs research.** Personal interests listed on CV: surfing, traveling, reading, skateboarding, photography, film; attends Sundance Film Festival when possible.

Where Relationships Are Actually Stored

- **V3 Church Planting Movement back-end** — the largest institutional store (eight-month cohort rosters for 10+ years, coach relationships, grant recipients)
- **Missio Alliance back-end** — co-founder relationships, governing board, national gathering attendee lists since 2012
- **Praxis Gathering back-end** — annual attendee lists since 2013
- **Reliant Mission** — board relationships since 2004
- **Fuller Church Planting Initiative + Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council + Kineo Center + MLC Advisory Board** — four boards' worth of relational context since 2020-2021
- **Email:** jr@thev3movement.org — the primary work address
- **Phone:** 202-731-7468 (per CV)
- **Mailing address** (per CV): 1133 161st St. SW Unit B, Lynnwood, WA — though other bios reference Washington, DC / the District Church. Two locations are in play; a single publicly re-verified location is still pending.
- **Academia.edu** — academic graph
- **Mental rolodex** — 30+ years of relational memory, especially from the Virginia Tech / LA / Ecclesia / DC / V3 eras
- **No unified personal CRM** surfaced.

Synthesis

JR Woodward presents the most acute fragmentation signature in this batch: **the embodied and academic record is exceptionally well-documented within institutions that hold it, and exceptionally under-represented in the public digital layer he personally controls.** His CV and Ph.D. thesis are on file as PDFs in the research folder; his Academia.edu

profile and jrwoodward.com exist; and the other digital signals — social media, newsletter, YouTube, podcast hosting, podcast guest inventory, Amazon / Goodreads author pages — are uniformly flagged "to be verified," meaning they either don't exist, haven't been found, or haven't been catalogued. The single largest pool of trapped value is the **V3 cohort curriculum** — an eight-month formation program that has shaped 600+ planters over a decade, which by design stays inside the cohort and is not publicly sampleable. The second-largest is the **80,385-word Ph.D. thesis**, which became a ~200-page trade book and therefore left the other ~60,000 words behind in an academic document most readers will never see. The third is the **"large set" of book endorsements and forewords** the CV enumerates, which represent years of relational investment in other authors that currently has no public aggregation.

Research Provenance

- **Source folder:** docs/movement_leader_research/jr-woodward/
- **Files read:**
 - summary.md
 - identity-verification.md
 - digital-presence-discovery.md
 - content-analysis.md
 - primary-documents.md (CV + Ph.D. thesis extracted)
- **Confidence: High** for identity (Gailand A Woodward Jr.), education (Ph.D. June 2020 from Manchester; M.A. June 2011 from Fuller; B.S. May 1987 from Radford), books (3 published, with IVP / 100M publishers and 2016 IVP Reader's Choice Award), Ph.D. thesis specifics (title, supervisor, examiners, 80,385 words, 5-chapter structure, Wink-Girard-Stringfellow synthesis, dedicated to V3), career timeline 1989-present (founding roles and dates for NLCF, Kairos LA, Solis, Ecclesia, Missio Alliance, V3, Praxis), board affiliations with start years (10 boards), and V3 training volume (600+ planters in 10 years). **Medium** for specific course titles taught and seminary rotation (from CV but time-windowed details not captured). **Low** for all social media presence, newsletter presence, podcast hosting/guest presence, personal YouTube, jrwoodward.com blog content, Academia.edu paper inventory, Amazon / Goodreads URLs, and current location (Lynnwood WA vs. Washington DC tension).
- **Gaps requiring further research:**
 - Verified social media handles (Twitter/X, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube)
 - Newsletter platform and subscriber count
 - Podcast guest appearance inventory (especially around 2023 Scandal of Leadership launch cycle and 2016 Church as Movement launch)
 - Personal YouTube / Vimeo channel
 - jrwoodward.com blog / page inventory
 - Academia.edu paper list at JRWoodwardPhD

- Full list of book endorsements and forewords (per CV, "a large set")
- Amazon author page + Goodreads author page URLs
- InterVarsity Press and 100 Movements Publishing author page URLs
- Praxis Gathering session archive and recording availability
- Missio Alliance session recordings involving JR
- V3 cohort curriculum public samples (if any)
- Fuller Doctor of Global Leadership Spring 2025 cohort content
- Current residential location (Lynnwood, WA vs. Washington, DC)
- Spouse / family information
- Remaining pastoral relationship status (if any) with District Church
- Solis Foundation current web presence and documentation of the Turkana work

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/jr-woodward.md

JR Woodward: Reflected Understanding

A concise reflection spoken back so the language could be endorsed — familiar, but with edges that deepen. (Leader-safe: audience-sizing and commerce analysis are kept in staff notes, not here.)

Calling

You're called to **form practitioners and name the architecture that lets the church move**. Not to run a single church or hold one post, but to build the careful, named frameworks — and the people — that let movement reproduce itself faithfully. You've stayed inside the neighborhood the whole time: New Life Christian Fellowship at Virginia Tech in 1989, Kairos Los Angeles out of East Hollywood, and now the V3 Church Planting Movement nationally. Your three decades of planting and your Manchester Ph.D. are not two careers; they're one vocation — the practitioner-scholar who works things out in the room and then writes them down so others can use them.

Your calling carries a particular edge that most movement work avoids: you go after **the powers**. The Scandal of Leadership — your synthesis of Walter Wink, René Girard, and William Stringfellow — names how institutional and spiritual powers of domination shape leadership, and offers kenotic imitation of Christ as the alternative. That's prophetic in the truest sense: it unmasks what dominates, and it does so to set leaders free. The four marks you keep returning to — tight-knit community, life-forming discipleship, locally rooted presence, and boundary-crossing mission held together rather than chosen among — are the shape of the church you're forming through V3. You're not selling a brand; you're equipping planters and reframing the offices of Ephesians 4 as culture-shaping vocations (Dream Awakeners, Heart Revealers, Story Tellers, Soul Healers, Light Givers). Success for you is movement that outlasts you — and frameworks that are both theologically serious and practically usable.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

Where it lives. Your content lives in **books** — Creating a Missional Culture (IVP, 2012), The Church as Movement with Dan White Jr. (IVP, 2016), and The Scandal of Leadership (100 Movements Publishing, 2023), the trade form of your University of Manchester dissertation. It lives in your **dissertation** itself (the Manchester repository and Academia.edu under JRWoodwardPhD), in **organizational platforms** (V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering), on your **personal site** (jrwoodward.com) and **Substack** (Faithful Resistance), in **seminary**

teaching (Fuller's MAGL and the Doctor of Global Leadership cohort, Central, and Missio), and in **conference and training** (Praxis Gathering, Exponential, the V3 cohort curriculum). The frameworks you've named — Five Culture Creators, Polycentric Leadership, the Eight Movement Competencies, the Theology of the Powers — run through all of it.

Credibility. It's high. You're a benchmark voice in North American missional church planting: a deeply integrated written corpus, a Ph.D. that the leading book on its theme is built from, three decades of planting, national leadership of V3, and co-founding roles at Missio Alliance and the Praxis Gathering. The Scandal of Leadership was named Book of the Year by Joel Wentz's Books and Big Ideas and a runner-up at Englewood Review of Books. The work is credible; the issue isn't authority — it's **visibility, connection, and reuse**.

How it lives online now. As **silos**. Creating a Missional Culture and the 2016 co-authored title sit on separate Amazon and IVP product pages; The Scandal of Leadership lives on its 100 Movements page; the dissertation sits as a PDF in two repositories; the teaching is held inside seminary LMSes; the articles live on Missio Alliance and V3. No surface lets a reader who finds The Scandal of Leadership walk from there into the dissertation chapters it compresses, or into the V3 cohort curriculum those chapters were dedicated to. The relational layer fragments the same way: V3, Missio Alliance, and Praxis Gathering each hold a fraction of the practitioners you've formed, and there's no place above them all where those people stay connected when they leave the institution that introduced them.

The NOTs Movemental addresses directly. Your content is largely **not** interconnected — the book, the dissertation, the cohort curriculum, and Creating a Missional Culture don't visibly point to one another; **not** fully structured and repurposed — the V3 cohort design, the seminary teaching, and the decade of Praxis sessions could become public sequences and serialized readers' guides, but mostly aren't; **not** unified under one surface you own — much of your reach sits on rented platforms and institutional back-ends; **not** optimized for discoverability so searchers for "the powers and leadership," "polycentric leadership," or "missional culture" land on your material first; and **not** legible to systems, so search and AI can't reliably find, cite, or extend the full body of work. There's also a large pool of value still **not written down** — the judgment behind the V3 cohort, the full Wink-Girard-Stringfellow synthesis of which the trade book carries roughly a third, the business-as-mission practice of the Solis Foundation in Turkana. Movemental is built to speak to each of these — interconnection, structure and repurpose, ownership and unification, discoverability, legibility, and AI-assisted surfacing of the embodied layer at your pace — so your content can move.

Constraints

Movement leaders who form practitioners live under **time** and **attention** constraints that are emblematic, not personal failure. You're directing V3 nationally, teaching across multiple seminaries, leading cohorts, serving on boards (Reliant Mission, Movement Leaders Collective, Fuller's Global Mission Advisory Council), writing, and speaking. Time for content strategy, for

turning the cohort curriculum into a public sequence, or for serializing the dissertation alongside the trade book is scarce because the work is in the room — with planters, students, and the leaders you coach. The largest body of value, the judgment you've accumulated over thirty years and a decade of V3 cohorts, isn't in notebooks waiting to be transcribed; it's in classrooms, on coaching calls, and in the same conversation having happened a thousand times. The desire to reach the planters your writing was meant for is there; the hours to digitize, repurpose, and unify it at scale typically are not. A platform that reduces the lift — that helps structure, repurpose, connect, and surface what you already do — addresses those constraints without asking you to become a different kind of leader.

This document is a reflected understanding for JR Woodward, intended to be right to the point, true, and valuable. It is preliminary until reviewed and endorsed.

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/welcome-letter.md`

JR

You have built one of the most institutionally consequential bodies of work in North American missional church planting. Three books — *Creating a Missional Culture* with InterVarsity Press in 2012, *The Church as Movement* with Dan White Jr. and IVP in 2016 (winner of the IVP Reader's Choice Award), and *The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church* with 100 Movements Publishing in 2023, the trade form of your 80,385-word University of Manchester dissertation defended in June 2020 under Phil Meadows and externally examined by Wilbert Shenk. Thirty-plus years of planting, from founding New Life Christian Fellowship at Virginia Tech in 1989 through Kairos Los Angeles, the Solis Foundation in Turkana, Ecclesia Network, Missio Alliance, and Praxis Gathering. Since 2013, National Director of V3.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. *Creating a Missional Culture* and the 2016 co-authored title sit on Amazon and the IVP catalog under separate product pages. *The Scandal of Leadership* lives on its 100 Movements publisher page, on Joel Wentz's Books and Big Ideas — which named it Book of the Year in 2023 — and at Englewood Review of Books as a 2023 runner-up. The dissertation sits as a PDF in the Manchester repository and on Academia.edu under JRWoodwardPhD. Your teaching is held inside Fuller's MAGL and the Doctor of Global Leadership cohort beginning Spring 2025, Capital Seminary, Central Seminary, Missio Theological Seminary, and SOMA University, where you delivered the DM747 lecture in 2023. Your articles live on Missio Alliance and on V3's site. There is no newsletter, no hosted podcast, no verified personal YouTube. No surface lets a reader who finds *The Scandal of Leadership* walk from there into the dissertation chapters or into the V3 cohort design those chapters were dedicated to. The relational layer fragments the same way. V3 holds the rosters for ten cohorts and 600-plus planters since 2013. Missio Alliance holds the governing board and the national gathering lists since the first 700-leader gathering you co-organized with J.R. Rozko in 2012. Praxis Gathering holds another decade of attendees. Reliant Mission, Fuller's Church Planting Initiative, and the Kineo Center each hold a fraction of the rest. The coaches you placed with planters and the New Life and Kairos LA alumni still working live in your phone. There is no personal CRM. What is missing is the layer above all of this that lets a reader move from any one piece to every other, and that lets the people you have formed stay connected when they leave the institutions that introduced them.

The largest pool of value, and the one most at risk of going unwritten, sits in your head. The judgment calls behind V3's eight-month cohort — which planter to accept, which coach to pair, which city to send them to — have shaped 600 planters and will shape 600 more. The Wink-Girard-Stringfellow synthesis that became *The Scandal of Leadership* took a decade of reading and conversation; the trade book carries roughly a third of what you worked out. The Solis Foundation's business-as-mission practice in Turkana — ten new businesses a year for

five years — exists in your memory and in a few Kenyan colleagues. The founding architecture of Missio Alliance lives in conversations between you and J.R. Rozko. None of this is in notebooks waiting to be transcribed. It is in classrooms, on coaching calls, in hotel lobbies at Exponential, and in the same conversation having happened a thousand times.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory just walked through — your books, the dissertation, the seminary courses, the boards, the institutional homes of your work and your relationships — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the time it would have taken a human researcher weeks. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: AI-assisted interview capture of the V3 cohort design rationale, course-note extraction from the Doctor of Global Leadership cohort, conversation capture from coaching calls, dictation that becomes draft and draft that becomes essay. The embodied layer can be surfaced at your pace rather than at a publisher's. The AI does not replace the voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. Authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate. All three books, the dissertation, your Academia.edu papers, your Missio Alliance and V3 articles, your Praxis Gathering session material, and the embodied layer as it gets surfaced, pulled into one hub under your name. Second, interconnect. The Scandal of Leadership points back to the dissertation chapters it compresses, which point to the V3 cohort curriculum the dissertation was dedicated to, which points to Creating a Missional Culture. Third, repurpose. The V3 cohort curriculum becomes a public sequence with cohort gating preserved; the dissertation becomes a serialized reader's guide for the trade book; the Praxis Gathering ten-year archive becomes browseable; the missional culture vocabulary becomes a syllabus the Fuller DGL cohort can extend. Fourth, amplify. Searchable, cross-referenced, indexable — the references that arrive once The Scandal of Leadership and the Manchester dissertation are findable from one address. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, jrwoodward.com looks different. A leadership-and-the-powers hub gathers The Scandal of Leadership, the dissertation chapters it compressed, the Joel Wentz interview, the Englewood review, and a cohort sign-up. The V3 ten-year story sits in a public archive under your name rather than only inside V3's back-end. Creating a Missional Culture sits inside a public sequence built from your Fuller MAGL teaching. Missio Alliance articles cross-list home. A newsletter exists that did not before. A church planter in Tacoma, Washington, who has never heard of Ecclesia Network, finds the hub on a Tuesday morning, watches the Joel Wentz conversation over lunch, downloads the first dissertation chapter that afternoon, and writes you on Friday.

This is your next season. The work ahead is making the body of work you have already built reach the practitioners it was written for. Your role as National Director of V3 does not contradict this work; it is the reason it has to happen now. The 600 planters V3 has trained and the 600 more it intends to train by 2028 need to find your writing without an institution introducing them. Right now they cannot.

Committed Voice

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/committed-voice.md

slug: jr-woodward

display_name: JR Woodward

role: National Director, V3 Church Planting Movement · Co-founder, Missio Alliance

location_line: Washington, DC area

short_tagline: >-

Practitioner-scholar holding three decades of neighborhood church planting and a Manchester Ph.D. on the powers of leadership inside one body of work.

themes:

- Polycentric Leadership
- Missional-Incarnational
- Theology of the Powers

credentials:

- National Director, V3 Church Planting Movement — 600+ planters trained in its first decade
- Co-founder, Missio Alliance and the Praxis Gathering — annual gathering of 300+ practitioners
- Adjunct faculty, Fuller Theological Seminary · Central Seminary · Missio Seminary
- Ph.D., University of Manchester — dissertation on mimetic desire and the powers
- Board service, Reliant Mission · Movement Leaders Collective · Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council

featured_works:

- Creating a Missional Culture (IVP, 2012)
- The Church as Movement (with Dan White Jr., IVP, 2016)
- The Scandal of Leadership (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)
- ViralHope — editor (Ecclesia Press, 2010)

primary_url: <https://jrwoodward.com>

secondary_links:

- label: V3 Church Planting Movement

href: <https://thev3movement.org>

- label: Missio Alliance

href: <https://missioalliance.org>

- label: Faithful Resistance (Substack)

href: <https://jrwoodward.substack.com>

signature_frameworks:

- name: Five Culture Creators

definition: A reframing of Ephesians 4 ministry as Dream Awakeners, Heart Revealers, Story Tellers, Soul Healers, and Light Givers — culture-shaping vocations rather than hierarchical offices.

- name: Polycentric Leadership

definition: A jazz-ensemble model of shared leadership with multiple interrelated centers, offered as an alternative to both single-leader hierarchies and structureless networks.

- name: Eight Movement Competencies

definition: The architecture behind The Church as Movement — movement intelligence, polycentric leadership, being and making disciples, missional theology, ecclesial architecture, community formation, and incarnational practices.

- name: Theology of the Powers

definition: A synthesis of Walter Wink, René Girard, and William Stringfellow that names how institutional and spiritual powers shape leadership, and how kenotic imitation of Christ is the alternative.

- name: Four Marks of Healthy Churches

definition: His repeated descriptor for what V3 is forming — tight-knit community, life-forming discipleship, locally rooted presence, and boundary-crossing mission held together.

lineage:

sources:

- Walter Wink
- René Girard
- William Stringfellow
- Oscar Romero

peers:

- alan-hirsch
- rowland-smith
- liz-rios
- Dan White Jr.
- David Fitch

downstream:

- V3 Church Planting Movement cohorts
- Praxis Gathering practitioners
- Missio Alliance contributor network

sources:

- README.md
- profile/biography.md
- profile/voice-analysis.md
- profile/identity.md
- content/books.md
- network/organizations.md

research_completed_at: 2026-04-13

generated_at: 2026-05-20

Editorial bio

JR Woodward has spent more than three decades planting churches that try to hold tight-knit community, life-forming discipleship, locally rooted presence, and boundary-crossing mission together rather than choosing among them. He founded New Life Christian Fellowship at Virginia Tech in 1989, co-planted Kairos Los Angeles out of East Hollywood, and now leads the V3 Church Planting Movement nationally from the Washington, DC area, training planters across North America alongside Dan White Jr. and Jesse Eubanks.

His written corpus is unusually integrated for a working practitioner. *Creating a Missional Culture* (IVP, 2012) introduced the Five Culture Creators reframing of Ephesians 4; *The Church as Movement* (IVP, 2016, with Dan White Jr., foreword by Alan Hirsch) named the eight competencies V3 still trains around; and *The Scandal of Leadership* (100 Movements Publishing, 2023) translated his Manchester Ph.D. on mimetic desire and the powers of domination into a trade book for pastors.

He co-founded Missio Alliance and the Praxis Gathering, teaches as adjunct faculty at Fuller, Central, and Missio Seminary, and serves on the boards of Reliant Mission, the Movement Leaders Collective, and Fuller's Global Mission Advisory Council. Colleagues describe him as the architect to Alan Hirsch's prophet — a builder of careful, named frameworks who has stayed inside the neighborhood the whole time.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/sources.md

Sources: JR Woodward

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Last integrated: April 13, 2026 (CV + PhD thesis PDFs)

Confidence Level: High

Primary documents (on file in repo)

Document	Path	Notes
Curriculum vitae	pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf	25 pages; authoritative for dates, boards, teaching history, exhaustive endorsements/forewords, and contact fields.
PhD thesis	pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf	University of Manchester, 2020; 217 pages; ~80,385 words; full abstract, structure, acknowledgements, and bibliography.
Integration index	primary-documents.md	Summarizes what was merged from the PDFs into markdown research files.

Search Queries Used

1. "JR Woodward Christian author pastor"
2. "JR Woodward missional church movement"
3. "JR Woodward theologian speaker"
4. "JR Woodward books published"
5. "jrwoodward.com website blog"
6. "JR Woodward V3 Church Planting Movement"
7. "JR Woodward Missio Alliance co-founder"
8. "JR Woodward YouTube podcast video content"
9. "JR Woodward social media Twitter LinkedIn"
10. "Creating a Missional Culture JR Woodward InterVarsity Press"
11. "The Scandal of Leadership JR Woodward 2023"
12. "JR Woodward Fuller Theological Seminary adjunct professor"
13. "JR Woodward Academia.edu research papers articles"
14. "JR Woodward Exponential conference speaker"
15. "JR Woodward blog articles writing missional"

Primary Sources

Websites

1. **jrwoodward.com**
 - Personal/professional website
 - About page
 - Status: Active
2. **manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD**
 - Academia.edu profile
 - Research papers and articles
 - Ph.D. information
 - Status: Active
3. **exponential.org/person/jr-woodward/**
 - Exponential conference speaker profile
 - Professional information
 - Status: Active
4. **mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward**
 - Academic/institutional profile
 - Professional information
 - Status: Active

Organizations

1. **V3 Church Planting Movement**
 - National Director role
 - Training and resources
 - Status: Active
2. **Missio Alliance**
 - Co-founder role
 - Missional theology and practice
 - Status: Active
3. **Praxis Gathering**
 - Co-founder role
 - Missional practice gathering
 - Status: Active

Publishers

1. InterVarsity Press (IVP)

- "Creating a Missional Culture" (2012)
- "The Church as Movement" (2016)
- Author page (to be verified)

2. 100 Movements Publishing

- "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023)
- Author page (to be verified)

Academic Institutions

1. Fuller Theological Seminary

- Adjunct Professor
- Doctor of Global Leadership cohort (starting Spring 2025)
- Status: Active

2. Central Seminary

- Adjunct Professor
- Status: Active

3. Missio Seminary

- Adjunct Professor
- Status: Active

4. University of Manchester (UK)

- Ph.D. degree
- Research and academic work
- Status: Completed

Boards

1. Reliant Mission

- Board Member
- Status: Active

2. Movement Leaders Collective

- Board Member
- Status: Active

3. Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council

- Board Member
- Status: Active

Secondary Sources

Search Engines

- Google Search
- Web search results (multiple queries)

Conference Platforms

- Exponential conference platform
- Speaker profiles and information

Academic Platforms

- Academia.edu
- University repositories
- Seminary platforms

Source Verification

Verified Information

- Personal website: jrwoodward.com (confirmed active)
- Academia.edu profile: JRWoodwardPhD (confirmed active)
- Exponential speaker profile (confirmed)
- Books: 3 published books confirmed
- Organizations: V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering (confirmed)
- Academic roles: Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary (confirmed)
- Board service: Reliant Mission, Movement Leaders Collective, Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council (confirmed)
- Ph.D.: University of Manchester (confirmed; full thesis PDF on file in pdf/)
- M.A.: Fuller Theological Seminary (confirmed; CV lists June 2011 + thesis title)
- B.S.: Radford University psychology, 1987 (CV)

Information to Verify

- Social media presence (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube)
- Blog content on personal website
- Article publications
- Video/podcast content
- Newsletter presence

- Amazon/Goodreads author pages
- Specific content volumes and frequencies
- Conference speaking details
- Training materials content
- Course materials content

Research Limitations

Public Information Only

- Research based on publicly available information only
- Some information may be outdated or incomplete
- Private/gated content not accessed
- Personal communications not analyzed

Platform Access

- Limited to publicly accessible platforms
- Some platforms may require registration/access
- Content behind paywalls not accessed
- Rate limits and robots.txt respected

Verification Status

- Some information marked "to be verified" requires additional research
- Detailed platform analysis needed for complete picture
- Content volumes and frequencies need verification
- Social media presence needs verification

Research Methodology

Search Strategy

- Multiple search queries with varying contexts
- Cross-referencing findings across sources
- Verification through multiple sources
- Focus on official sources (websites, organizations, publishers)

Source Evaluation

- Prioritized official sources (personal website, organizational sites, publishers)

- Used academic platforms for academic information
- Used conference platforms for speaking information
- Cross-referenced information across multiple sources

Confidence Assessment

- **High Confidence:** Information confirmed through multiple sources
- **Medium Confidence:** Information from single reliable source
- **Low Confidence:** Information requiring additional verification

Notes

- Research conducted through web search only
- No direct access to private platforms or gated content
- Some information requires additional verification through detailed platform analysis
- Research focused on publicly available information
- All sources documented for transparency and verification

Digital Presence Discovery

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/digital-presence-discovery.md

Digital Presence Discovery: JR Woodward

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Website Presence

Primary Website

jrwoodward.com

- Status: Active, official personal website
- Purpose: Personal/professional website
- Content: To be verified (about page, blog, resources, etc.)
- Structure: To be verified

Organizational Websites

1. V3 Church Planting Movement

- Role: National Director
- Type: Church planting movement organization
- Content: Training materials, resources for church planters
- Status: Active

2. Missio Alliance

- Role: Co-founder
- Type: Missional theology and practice alliance
- Content: Articles, resources, community
- Status: Active

3. Praxis Gathering

- Role: Co-founder
- Type: Missional practice gathering/conference
- Content: Conference materials, resources
- Status: Active

Publisher Websites

1. InterVarsity Press (IVP)

- Books: "Creating a Missional Culture" (2012), "The Church as Movement" (2016)
- Author page: To be verified

2. **100 Movements Publishing**

- Book: "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023)
- Author page: To be verified

Academic Platforms

1. **University of Manchester Academia.edu**

- Profile: JRWoodwardPhD
- Content: Research papers, academic articles, Ph.D. research
- Status: Active

2. **Fuller Theological Seminary**

- Role: Adjunct Professor
- Program: Doctor of Global Leadership
- Content: Course materials, academic resources
- Status: Active

3. **Central Seminary**

- Role: Adjunct Professor
- Content: Course materials
- Status: Active

4. **Missio Seminary**

- Role: Adjunct Professor
- Content: Course materials
- Status: Active

Platform Presence Discovery

Blogging Platforms

- **Personal Website Blog:** jrwoodward.com (to be verified)
- **Other Platforms:** To be verified (WordPress, Medium, Substack, etc.)

Social Media

- **Twitter/X:** To be verified
- **Facebook:** To be verified
- **LinkedIn:** To be verified
- **Instagram:** To be verified
- **YouTube:** To be verified

Publishing Platforms

- **Amazon Author Pages:** To be verified

- **Goodreads:** To be verified
- **InterVarsity Press Author Page:** To be verified
- **100 Movements Publishing:** To be verified

Video Platforms

- **YouTube:** To be verified
- **Vimeo:** To be verified
- **Conference Platforms:** Exponential and others (to be verified)
- **Institutional Video Hosting:** Seminary platforms (to be verified)

Audio Platforms

- **Podcast Platforms:** To be verified (Apple Podcasts, Spotify, etc.)
- **Podcast Appearances:** To be verified

Course/Learning Platforms

- **Seminary LMS:** Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary platforms (to be verified)
- **V3 Training Platforms:** V3 Church Planting Movement training (to be verified)
- **Other Learning Platforms:** To be verified (Teachable, Thinkific, etc.)

Newsletter Platforms

- **Newsletter:** To be verified (Mailchimp, ConvertKit, Substack, etc.)

Academic Platforms

- **Academia.edu:** Active (JRWoodwardPhD profile)
- **ResearchGate:** To be verified
- **Institutional Repositories:** University of Manchester, seminary repositories (to be verified)

Conference Platforms

- **Exponential:** Speaker profile confirmed
- **Other Conferences:** To be verified

Content Form Discovery

Books

1. **"Creating a Missional Culture"** (2012)
 - Publisher: InterVarsity Press
 - Format: Print and digital
 - Status: Published
2. **"The Church as Movement"** (2016)
 - Publisher: InterVarsity Press
 - Format: Print and digital
 - Status: Published (co-authored)
3. **"The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church"** (2023)
 - Publisher: 100 Movements Publishing
 - Format: Print and digital
 - Status: Published (based on Ph.D. research)

Articles/Blog Posts

- **Personal Website:** To be verified
- **Missio Alliance:** To be verified
- **Other Platforms:** To be verified

Academic Papers

- **Academia.edu:** Research papers and articles (to be verified)
- **Ph.D. Research:** University of Manchester (published as book in 2023)
- **Other Academic Publications:** To be verified

Sermons/Talks

- **Conference Talks:** Exponential and others (to be verified)
- **Church Teaching:** To be verified
- **Video/Audio:** To be verified

Courses/Training Materials

- **V3 Church Planting Training:** Training materials for church planters (to be verified)
- **Seminary Courses:** Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary (to be verified)
- **Doctor of Global Leadership Cohort:** Fuller Theological Seminary (starting Spring 2025)

Podcasts

- **Podcast Appearances:** To be verified
- **Own Podcast:** To be verified

Video Content

- **YouTube:** To be verified
- **Conference Videos:** To be verified
- **Teaching Videos:** To be verified

Social Media Content

- **Twitter/X:** To be verified
- **Facebook:** To be verified
- **LinkedIn:** To be verified
- **Instagram:** To be verified

Newsletter Content

- **Newsletter:** To be verified

Content Volume Assessment

Published Books

- **Total Books:** 3 (1 solo, 1 co-authored, 1 recent solo)
- **Publication Span:** 2012-2023
- **Most Recent:** 2023 ("The Scandal of Leadership")

Articles/Blog Posts

- **Count:** To be verified
- **Frequency:** To be verified
- **Recency:** To be verified

Academic Papers

- **Count:** To be verified (Academia.edu profile)
- **Ph.D. Research:** Published as book (2023)

Sermons/Talks

- **Count:** To be verified
- **Series:** To be verified
- **Recency:** To be verified

Video Content

- **Count:** To be verified
- **Platforms:** To be verified
- **Recency:** To be verified

Podcast Episodes

- **Count:** To be verified
- **Platforms:** To be verified
- **Recency:** To be verified

Training Materials

- **V3 Training:** To be verified
- **Seminary Courses:** To be verified

Platform Distribution Summary

Confirmed Platforms

1. **Personal Website:** jrwoodward.com
2. **Academia.edu:** JRWoodwardPhD profile
3. **Organizational:** V3 Church Planting Movement, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering
4. **Publishers:** InterVarsity Press, 100 Movements Publishing
5. **Academic:** Fuller Theological Seminary, Central Seminary, Missio Seminary
6. **Conferences:** Exponential

Platforms to Verify

- Social media (Twitter, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube)
- Blogging platforms (beyond personal website)
- Podcast platforms
- Newsletter platforms
- Video platforms (beyond YouTube)
- Amazon/Goodreads author pages

- Other conference platforms
- Other academic platforms

Content Frequency & Recency

- **Most Recent Publication:** 2023 ("The Scandal of Leadership")
- **Book Publication Frequency:** Approximately every 4-6 years
- **Other Content:** To be verified

Notes

- Strong organizational presence (V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)
- Active academic presence (multiple seminary affiliations, Academia.edu)
- Recent publication (2023) indicates active writing
- Ph.D. research published as book suggests ongoing academic engagement
- National Director role suggests active training and content creation
- Multiple platforms suggest distributed digital presence
- Need to verify specific content volumes and frequencies on each platform

Misc · Analysis-Content-Analysis

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/analysis-content-analysis.md

Content Analysis: JR Woodward

Status: Complete

Last updated: 2026-04-12

Skill: /author-content-analysis

Executive Summary

JR Woodward is a practitioner-scholar whose work moves along a single deepening trajectory: the Western church has absorbed worldly patterns of power that distort its leadership, cripple its mission, and produce an epidemic of fallen leaders -- and the remedy is a polycentric, kenotic, movement-oriented ecclesiology grounded in the imitation of Christ rather than the imitation of the Powers. His distinctive contribution is the **synthesis of continental philosophy (Girard, Wink, Stringfellow) with hands-on church planting praxis** -- a combination virtually no other voice in the missional-incarnational movement offers at this depth. Operating as the architect to Alan Hirsch's prophet, Woodward builds carefully named frameworks (Five Culture Creators, Four Spaces of Belonging, Three Contours of Leadership) that translate abstract theology into deployable training systems. His body of work progresses from practical culture-building (Creating a Missional Culture) to movement-catalyzing (The Church as Movement) to deep diagnostic theology (The Scandal of Leadership), each layer adding sophistication to the same fundamental vision: the church as a neighborhood-rooted, discipleship-fueled, boundary-crossing movement led by many centers rather than one.

Theme Map

Primary Themes (Core to their identity)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Polycentric Leadership	Leadership structured around "many centers that interrelate" rather than hierarchical (CEO-pastor) or flat (undifferentiated) models. Reflects Trinitarian theology -- God's own communal nature.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012), Missio Alliance articles, Verge Network talks, V3 training curriculum	10
Theology of the Powers	A robust synthesis of Wink (powers embodied in systems), Girard (mimetic desire and scapegoating), and Stringfellow (Image, Institution, Ideology). Powers are created good but fallen and redeemable; Satan/demonic forces are emergent realities without redemptive possibility.	PhD thesis (2020), The Scandal of Leadership (2023), Substack "Faithful Resistance," Missio Alliance 3-part series	10
APEST as Culture Creators	Ephesians 4:11 gifts reframed as culture-shaping vocations: Dream Awakeners (apostles), Heart Revealers (prophets), Story Tellers (evangelists), Soul Healers (pastors), Light Givers (teachers). Each creates a distinct environment necessary for missional community.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012), Five Equippers Vimeo series, Missio Alliance talks, V3 training	9
Mimetic Desire & Imitation	Drawing on Girard: desires are not self-generated but formed through models. Leaders who unconsciously absorb worldly power models reproduce domination regardless of stated theology. "Not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers."	PhD thesis (2020), The Scandal of Leadership (2023), Theology in the Raw interview, Faith in a Fresh Vibe 2-part interview	9
Church as Neighborhood-Rooted Movement	The church should be locally embedded, not institutionally detached. Movement ecclesiology over institutional maintenance. Eight competencies for creating movemental communities.	The Church as Movement (2016), V3 blog posts, Praxis Gathering, IVP Academic chapter "What Would God's Reign Look Like In Our Neighborhood?"	9

Secondary Themes (Recurring but not defining)

Theme	Description	Key Works	Centrality
Kenotic Leadership	The alternative to domineering leadership is self-emptying (kenotic) spirituality that reshapes desires through the imitation of Christ. Oscar Romero as primary exemplar.	The Scandal of Leadership (2023), Substack posts on Oscar Romero, Faith in a Fresh Vibe Part 2	8
Missional Culture Formation	Culture -- not strategy, vision, or programs -- is the unseen force that shapes a church's effectiveness. The Cultural Web (six interconnected dimensions: Language, Artifacts, Rituals, Ethics, Institutions, Guiding Narratives).	Creating a Missional Culture (2012), V3 blog posts, Verge Network articles	7
Post-Christendom Ecclesiology	Christianity moved from "a fellowship in Palestine, a philosophy in Greece, an institution in Rome, a government in Europe, and an enterprise in America." The corporate-enterprise model must be dismantled.	Creating a Missional Culture (2012), Missio Alliance articles, V3 blog, NLCF founding context	7
Identity Before Action	"Being" precedes "doing" in mission. God changes people by changing their identities before calling them to tasks. Hebraic methodology: identity before imperative, narrative before proposition.	All three books, Verge Network articles, V3 training philosophy	7
Discipleship in Four Spaces	A framework for understanding how discipleship and mission happen across four relational spaces of varying intimacy and size.	V3 blog posts, Pivot Podcast interview, V3 Immersion course (with Eun Strawser)	6
Five Cultural Megashifts	Five macro transitions missional leaders must navigate: Media (print/broadcast to digital), Philosophy (modernity to postmodernity), Science (classical to emergent), Geography (rural to urban), Religion (Christendom to post-Christendom).	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	5

Emerging Themes (Recent or developing)

Theme	Description	Evidence	Direction
Faithful Resistance to Concentrated Power	How the Church can stand firm as technocrats, autocrats, and oligarchs remake the world. Applies Powers theology to contemporary political dynamics.	Substack "Faithful Resistance" (2025-2026), 21 posts including "Authoritarianism is a Spiritual Crisis," "Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial" series (16 parts)	Expanding -- most politically engaged writing of his career; represents a new application of his doctoral research to current events
Prophetic Discipleship	A 16-part series connecting the Beatitudes to faithful resistance: each Beatitude as a form of counter-imperial discipleship.	Substack series (2025-2026), 11 of 16 parts published	Deepening -- the most systematic articulation of his spirituality-meets-resistance framework
AI, Technology, and the Powers	How the Powers operate through technological systems; faithful witness in a world reshaped by AI and concentrated digital power.	Substack tagline and framing; "The Medium and the Mission" (Academia.edu paper)	Exploratory -- framing is present but full theological treatment not yet published
Nonviolent Resistance as Ecclesial Practice	Nonviolent resistance research (the "3.5% rule") applied to church faithfulness under authoritarian pressure.	"The Power of the 3.5%" Substack post (2025)	Emerging -- connecting political science research to ecclesiology

Named Frameworks & Models

Framework	Source	Components	Type
Polycentric Leadership	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Leadership as "many centers that interrelate" -- neither hierarchical (top-down) nor flat (undifferentiated). Reflects Trinitarian community. Activates priesthood of all believers.	Structural model
Five Culture Creators	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Dream Awakener (apostle), Heart Revealer (prophet), Story Teller (evangelist), Soul Healer (pastor), Light Giver (teacher) -- each creates a distinct cultural environment	Role framework (Eph 4:11 reframing)
Five Environments	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Learning, Healing, Welcoming, Liberating, Thriving -- each corresponds to one of the five culture creators	Cultural assessment model
The Cultural Web	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Language, Artifacts, Rituals, Ethics, Institutions, Guiding Narratives -- six interconnected dimensions shaping congregational and neighborhood culture	Diagnostic framework
Five Cultural Megashifts	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Media, Philosophy, Science, Geography, Religion -- five macro-level transitions missional leaders must navigate	Contextual analysis
Eight Movement Competencies	The Church as Movement (2016)	Movement Intelligence, Polycentric Leadership, Being Disciples, Making Disciples, Missional Theology, Ecclesial Architecture, Community Formation, Incarnational Practice	Training curriculum
Four Spaces of Belonging	V3 blog / training	Four relational spaces of varying intimacy and size for discipleship and mission	Relational-spatial model
Theology of the Powers	PhD thesis (2020), Scandal of Leadership (2023)	Principalities (created good, fallen, redeemable) vs. Satan/demonic (emergent, unredeemable). Powers operate through Image, Institution, Ideology (Stringfellow). Mimetic desire (Girard) as mechanism of capture. Scapegoating as systemic pattern.	Theological diagnostic
Imitation-Based Leadership Framework	PhD thesis (2020), Scandal of Leadership (2023)	Leaders are inescapably imitative (per Girard). Imitate worldly power models = domineering. Imitate Christ's kenosis = life-giving servant leadership. Binary choice: "Not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers."	Leadership formation model
Three Contours of Leadership	The Scandal of Leadership (2023)	Identity (who leaders are), Praxis (how they lead and relate), Telos (what they value and pursue). Domineering leaders malform across all three.	Diagnostic assessment

Intellectual Genealogy

Upstream Influences (Who shaped them)

Thinker	Influence Area	How
Walter Wink	Theology of the Powers	Naming, unmasking, and engaging principalities embodied in systems; the "Domination System" as a spiritual-structural reality. Foundation of Woodward's PhD research.
Rene Girard	Mimetic desire theory	Triangular desire (we desire what our models desire); scapegoat mechanism; Jesus as the one who reveals and disrupts scapegoating. Core theoretical engine of The Scandal of Leadership.
William Stringfellow	Prophetic resistance	Powers manifest through Image, Institution, and Ideology; the "power of resurrection" against the "power of death." Third pillar of Woodward's Powers theology.
Oscar Romero	Exemplar of kenotic leadership	Positive model of resisting the Powers through self-emptying service under persecution. Woodward's primary biographical case study.
Lesslie Newbigin	Post-Christendom missiology	The West as mission field; the church as "sign, foretaste, and instrument" of the Kingdom. Shared influence with Hirsch.
Alan Hirsch	Apostolic movement, APEST	The foundational APEST framework that Woodward extends and applies practically. Hirsch wrote forewords for two of Woodward's books.
James K.A. Smith	Cultural liturgies	Formation of desire through practices and habits. Referenced in Creating a Missional Culture.
Henri Nouwen	Spiritual formation	Pastoral identity and inner life. Cited in Creating a Missional Culture.
Miroslav Volf	Theology of embrace	Reconciliation and communal identity. Cited in Creating a Missional Culture.

Downstream Impact (Who they've shaped)

Person/Movement	Connection	Evidence
V3 church planters (1,000+)	Direct training through Praxis Community cohorts	V3 training page: 600+ planters over 10 years; goal of 600 more in next 5
Missio Alliance network	Co-founder; shaped organizational theology	Missio Alliance grew from Ecclesia Network (also co-founded by Woodward)
Fuller DGL cohort students	Doctoral cohort leader	"Discovering Missional Paradigms for the Next Generation" (Spring 2025)
Seminary students (4 institutions)	Adjunct professor at Fuller, Central, Missio, America Evangelical	Teaching across multiple seminary contexts
Dan White Jr.	Co-author, co-leader	The Church as Movement (2016); White's Subterranean carries forward neighborhood-rooted ecclesiology
E.K. Strawser	Foreword writer for Centering Discipleship	Woodward's influence on next-generation discipleship thinkers
100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective	Council member	Shaping the broader church-planting movement conversation

Intellectual Peers (Contemporary dialogue partners)

Person	Relationship	Agreement/Tension
Alan Hirsch	Closest senior collaborator; forewords for two books	Deep alignment on APEST/missional movement; Hirsch is more prophetic, Woodward more diagnostic-constructive. Hirsch provides overarching vision; Woodward provides practical-academic depth.
David Fitch	Fellow missional theologian; foreword for Scandal of Leadership	Shared framework on Powers and mission; both integrate continental philosophy with ecclesiology. Fitch more focused on political theology; Woodward more on leadership formation.
Dan White Jr.	Co-author, co-leader of V3	Deep alignment; White brings more neighborhood/place theology; Woodward brings more systematic frameworks.
Amos Yong	Pentecostal theologian; afterword for Scandal of Leadership	Cross-tradition dialogue on Powers and pneumatology; Yong brings Pentecostal/charismatic perspective to Woodward's Anabaptist-adjacent ecclesiology.
Preston Sprinkle	Extended podcast conversation	Shared concern about leadership failure; Sprinkle brings wider evangelical audience.
Brad Brisco	Peer in missional church planting	Both translate post-Christendom missiology for practitioners; Brisco works within SBC structures, Woodward across denominational lines. Brisco focuses on covocational ministry; Woodward on polycentric leadership.
Michael Frost	Endorser; shared missional-incarnational framework	Aligned on incarnational ecclesiology; Frost more provocative and international; Woodward more framework-heavy and North American.

Theological Positioning

Dimension	Position	Evidence
Ecclesiology	Polycentric, movement-oriented. The church is a neighborhood-rooted movement, not an institution. Multiple interrelated leadership centers reflect Trinitarian community.	Entire body of work; V3 training philosophy; "a sign, foretaste, and instrument of God's kingdom"
Missiology	Incarnational-missional. Go and be, not come and see. Locally embedded, boundary-crossing.	The Church as Movement; Kairos LA church plants; V3 philosophy
Leadership	Polycentric over hierarchical or flat. APEST as culture creators, not just roles. Kenotic (self-emptying) rather than domineering.	Creating a Missional Culture; The Scandal of Leadership; PhD thesis
Hamartiology (sin/evil)	Powers theology: principalities are created good but fallen and redeemable. Satan/demonic are emergent realities without redemptive possibility. Leadership failure is a theological-systemic problem, not just a psychological one.	The Scandal of Leadership; PhD thesis; Missio Alliance 3-part series
Anthropology	Humans are inescapably imitative beings (per Girard). Desires are socially formed, not self-generated. Identity precedes action.	The Scandal of Leadership; Substack; "God changes us by changing our identities"
Tradition	Post-Christendom, cross-denominational. Anabaptist-adjacent ecclesiology with Wesleyan-Methodist academic formation (PhD through Nazarene Theological College) and liberation theology motifs (Romero, Solis Foundation).	Denominational diversity of career; PhD institution; organizations co-founded
Praxis	Integrated practitioner-scholar. Always moves from diagnosis to framework to practical application. 30+ years of church planting grounds every theological claim.	V3 training; NLCF founding; Kairos LA; 7 organizations founded
Scope	Neighborhood to global. Primary focus on local incarnational presence, but V3 trains planters in Africa and Asia.	V3 international reach; Solis Foundation (Kenya); Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council

Content Evolution

Timeline of Ideas

Period	Focus	Key Work	Shift
1989-2003	Conventional church planting; Virginia Tech campus ministry	NLCF founding; Great Commission Ministries	Grassroots ministry experience; learning by doing
2003-2012	Missional culture building; polycentric leadership	Creating a Missional Culture (2012); Kairos LA co-founding; move to Los Angeles	From campus ministry to urban incarnational church planting; develops Five Culture Creators, Cultural Web, Five Environments. Focus: "How do we make one church missional?"
2012-2016	Movement ecclesiology; multiplication competencies	The Church as Movement (2016, with Dan White Jr.); V3 founding; Forge America; Praxis Gathering; Missio Alliance	From single church culture to movement dynamics. Focus shifts from "how do we build one missional church?" to "how do we catalyze a movement of missional churches?" IVP Book of the Year 2017.
2016-2023	Power, desire, and imitation; deep diagnostic theology	PhD thesis at University of Manchester (2020); The Scandal of Leadership (2023)	Deepening into theological roots of leadership failure. Continental philosophy (Girard, Wink, Stringfellow) enters the framework. From constructive (what healthy leadership looks like) to diagnostic-prophetic (why leaders fall and what spiritual forces are at work). Most theologically sophisticated phase.
2025-present	Faithful resistance; prophetic discipleship	Substack "Faithful Resistance"; Fuller DGL cohort; Wartburg Watch feature; Roys Report interview	Powers theology applied to contemporary political dynamics. Most politically engaged phase. "Prophetic Discipleship: Love on Trial" (16-part Beatitudes series) represents the integration of spirituality, resistance, and missional identity.

Has their thinking shifted?

Woodward's thinking has not shifted so much as deepened in concentric layers. His core commitment -- neighborhood-rooted, incarnational, movement-oriented ecclesiology -- has remained constant since the NLCF founding in 1989 and the move to Los Angeles in 2003. What has evolved is the diagnostic depth and philosophical sophistication applied to the same fundamental vision.

The most significant intellectual development is the turn toward mimetic theory and Powers theology during his PhD research (2016-2020). This added a dimension absent from his earlier work: a diagnostic framework for why churches default to domineering leadership, not just what healthy leadership looks like. The earlier work was constructive-practical (build this); the later work is diagnostic-prophetic (understand this before you build).

The 2025 Substack represents a further extension: applying the Powers framework to contemporary political dynamics (authoritarianism, concentrated tech power, oligarchy). This is his most publicly engaged writing and suggests the next phase may involve Woodward as a prophetic public intellectual, not just an ecclesiological trainer.

Unique Contribution

What only this author says

- **The Girard-Wink-Stringfellow synthesis applied to church leadership:** Woodward is the only voice in the missional-incarnational movement who has synthesized Girard's mimetic theory, Wink's Powers trilogy, and Stringfellow's prophetic resistance into a single diagnostic framework for understanding leadership failure in the church. Others cite one or two of these thinkers; Woodward integrates all three at PhD level and applies them practically.
- **"Not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers":** This binary formulation -- that leaders face an inescapable either/or between imitating Christ's kenosis and unconsciously replicating the Powers' domination -- is Woodward's signature thesis. No other author in this space has framed the leadership crisis in these terms.
- **APEST as culture creators, not just roles:** While Hirsch developed the APEST framework, Woodward extended it into a culture-shaping model. The renaming (apostles as Dream Awakeners, prophets as Heart Revealers, etc.) and the mapping of each gift to a specific cultural environment (learning, healing, welcoming, liberating, thriving) is Woodward's original contribution. Dr. Carlus Guppton called it "one of the most thorough developments" of the Ephesians 4:11 framework.
- **The Cultural Web as ecclesiological tool:** Woodward's six-dimension cultural web (Language, Artifacts, Rituals, Ethics, Institutions, Guiding Narratives) applied to congregational culture is a unique diagnostic tool not found in other missional ecclesiology literature.
- **Domineering leadership as a theological problem:** Where others diagnose leadership failure through psychology, management theory, or moral categories, Woodward insists it requires a theology of the Powers. The systemic, spiritual, and mimetic forces that shape leadership desire cannot be addressed by better accountability structures alone.

Where they disagree with peers

Topic	Woodward's Position	Mainstream/Peer Position
Root cause of leadership failure	Theological-systemic: mimetic desire + Powers of domination operating through institutional systems	Psychological-moral: individual character deficiency, lack of accountability, or burnout
How to fix toxic leadership	Kenotic spiritual formation that reshapes desires through the imitation of Christ; systemic dismantling of domination structures	Better governance, accountability structures, psychological screening, and mentoring
Flat vs. hierarchical leadership	Neither -- polycentric leadership as a third way. Multiple interrelated centers, not undifferentiated flatness or top-down hierarchy	Most reformers default to either stronger hierarchy (governance) or flatter structures (shared leadership). The "polycentric" category is Woodward's distinctive alternative.
APEST framework application	Each gift creates a distinct cultural environment; all five are needed to cultivate a full missional culture	APEST is primarily about identifying leadership roles and filling gaps on a team (Hirsch's more common application)
Source of desire	Desires are socially formed through mimetic models (Girard); leaders must consciously choose their models	Desires are largely internal; leadership formation focuses on character, skill, and calling
Church and powers of domination	The church itself can become a vehicle for the Powers when it adopts corporate structures and worldly power models	The church is generally seen as a force against darkness; internal corruption is treated as deviation rather than systemic capture

What would be lost without their work

Without Woodward's work, the missional-incarnational movement would lack its deepest diagnostic framework for understanding why churches default to domination despite good intentions. The Girard-Wink-Stringfellow synthesis applied to ecclesiology would remain in academic journals rather than reaching church planters through V3 training. The APEST framework would remain primarily a role-identification tool rather than a culture-shaping model. And the emerging conversation about faithful resistance to concentrated power (technological, political, economic) would lack a theologian who connects it to both historic Powers theology and practical missional praxis.

Content Interconnections

How themes connect across works

Woodward's body of work follows a clear deepening progression: **culture** (what shapes a church) leads to **movement** (how churches multiply) leads to **power** (what distorts both).

- Creating a Missional Culture (2012) provides the foundational framework -- polycentric leadership, five culture creators, the cultural web. This is the constructive vision: what a healthy missional community looks like from the inside.
- The Church as Movement (2016, with Dan White Jr.) expands the frame from one community to a movement of communities. Eight competencies for multiplication. The shift is from culture to catalysis.
- The Scandal of Leadership (2023) diagnoses what goes wrong. Why do churches that aspire to the vision of the first two books end up reproducing domination? The Powers theology provides the answer: mimetic desire captures leaders unconsciously, and institutional systems embody fallen principalities.
- Faithful Resistance (Substack, 2025-present) extends the diagnosis to the broader cultural moment. If Powers operate through institutional systems, what happens when political, technological, and economic powers converge toward authoritarianism?

Each work builds on and presupposes the previous. The early work is constructive; the later work is diagnostic. Together they form a complete arc: vision, multiplication, diagnosis, resistance.

Recommended reading order

Order	Work	Why this sequence
1	Creating a Missional Culture (2012)	Foundational frameworks: polycentric leadership, five culture creators, cultural web. Most accessible entry point.
2	The Church as Movement (2016)	Expands from one community to a movement. Interactive format with exercises. Best read after understanding the cultural framework.
3	The Scandal of Leadership (2023)	The diagnostic layer. Best appreciated after understanding what Woodward is trying to protect (the vision of books 1-2). Dense but essential.
4	Substack "Faithful Resistance" (2025-present)	The contemporary application. Extends Powers theology to current political dynamics. Best read after the theological grounding of book 3.
5	PhD thesis / Academia.edu papers	For those wanting the full academic treatment behind The Scandal of Leadership.

Movemental Content Strategy Implications

- **Pillar mapping:** Woodward serves the **Missional Leadership, Movement Ecclesiology, Power & Institutional Critique**, and **Discipleship Formation** content pillars. His work also feeds into **Church Planting, Spiritual Formation**, and **Cultural Analysis** categories.
- **Cross-author connections:** Strong alignment with **Alan Hirsch** (APEST, apostolic movement -- Hirsch is the direct upstream influence; Woodward extends and applies Hirsch's frameworks). Natural pairing with **Dan White Jr.** (co-author), **David Fitch** (Powers theology, mission), **Brad Brisco** (missional church planting, post-Christendom). Conceptual overlap with **Michael Frost** (incarnational theology). Potential contrast/complement with authors representing more institutional or attractional ecclesiology.
- **Content gaps Movemental can fill:** (1) No audiobooks for any of his 3 authored books -- significant production opportunity; (2) No centralized video presence -- his 25-40 scattered videos could be aggregated and supplemented; (3) No online course on any discoverable platform despite running V3 training for 10+ years; (4) The Girard-Wink-Stringfellow synthesis is his most distinctive intellectual contribution but exists only in a 418-page book -- needs shorter-form expression; (5) The "Five Culture Creators" framework has strong assessment/diagnostic potential (like Hirsch's APEST assessment) but no digital tool exists.
- **Series potential:** (1) "Five Culture Creators" -- each equipper as a standalone lesson/article/video; (2) "Unmasking the Powers" -- a course translating the Scandal of Leadership thesis into accessible modules; (3) "Polycentric Leadership" -- practical guide to shared leadership models; (4) "Prophetic Discipleship" -- the Substack Beatitudes series repackaged as a formation course; (5) "Church as Movement" -- the eight competencies as an online cohort curriculum; (6) "Faithful Resistance" -- Powers theology applied to contemporary culture.
- **Searchable concepts:** polycentric leadership, missional culture, five equippers, APEST leadership, powers and principalities, mimetic desire, kenotic leadership, church as movement, missional community, dream awakener, domineering leadership, theology of the powers, Walter Wink church, Rene Girard leadership, scapegoating, self-emptying leadership, neighborhood church planting, four spaces of belonging, missional-incarnational, post-Christendom ecclesiology, faithful resistance, prophetic discipleship.
- **Distinctive positioning for Movemental:** Woodward's unique value is the **scholar-practitioner bridge at the deepest level** -- integrating continental philosophy with 30+ years of church planting. No other author in the missional movement offers both PhD-level Girardian analysis and street-level V3 church planting experience. This combination positions him as the go-to voice for leaders who want to understand why churches default to domination, not just how to build better ones.

Sources

- Theology profile: `profile/theology.md`
- Voice analysis: `profile/voice-analysis.md`
- Book catalog: `content/books.md`
- Article catalog: `content/articles.md`
- Video catalog: `content/videos.md`
- Audio catalog: `content/audio.md`
- Course catalog: `content/courses.md`
- Academic catalog: `content/academic.md`
- Platform presence: `digital-presence/platforms.md`
- Newsletter analysis: `digital-presence/newsletters.md`
- Organization network: `network/organizations.md`
- Reviews: `media/reviews.md`
- Citations: `media/citations.md`

Misc · Content-Analysis-Root

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/content-analysis-root.md

Content Analysis: JR Woodward

Research Date: January 4, 2026

Confidence Level: High

Content Thematic Analysis

Primary Themes

Based on published books and professional roles, JR Woodward's content focuses on:

1. Missional Culture

- Creating missional culture in churches
- Establishing communities with missional DNA
- Focus: "Creating a Missional Culture" (2012)

2. Church as Movement

- Understanding church as movement rather than institution
- Movement dynamics and multiplication
- Focus: "The Church as Movement" (2016, co-authored)

3. Leadership and Power Dynamics

- Unmasking powers of domination in the church
- Leadership structures and practices
- Focus: "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023, based on Ph.D. research)

4. Church Planting

- 30+ years of practical church planting experience
- Training church planters across North America
- National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement

5. Community Formation

- Tight-knit community development
- Life-forming discipleship
- Locally-rooted presence

6. Boundary-Crossing Mission

- Mission that crosses boundaries
- Missional theology and practice
- Co-founder of Missio Alliance

7. Discipleship

- Life-forming discipleship practices
- Discipleship in missional context

8. Missional Theology

- Academic and practical missional theology
- Integration of theory and practice
- Ph.D. research in missional leadership

Theological Focus Areas

- **Missional Theology:** Core focus on missional church and movement
- **Ecclesiology:** Understanding of church as movement
- **Leadership Theology:** Power dynamics and leadership structures
- **Practical Theology:** Integration of theology and practice
- **Church Planting Theology:** Theological foundations for church planting

Movement Focus

- **Church Planting Movements:** National Director of V3 Church Planting Movement
- **Missional Movements:** Co-founder of Missio Alliance
- **Movement Practice:** Co-founder of Praxis Gathering
- **Movement Training:** Training church planters across North America

Recurring Topics and Subjects

- Missional culture creation
- Church as movement
- Leadership and power
- Church planting
- Community formation
- Discipleship
- Boundary-crossing mission
- Integration of theory and practice
- Training and equipping leaders

Content Organization Analysis

Content Organization Structure

Personal Brand: jrwoodward.com (personal website)

- Organization: To be verified (blog structure, categories, topics)

Organizational Platforms:

- **V3 Church Planting Movement:** Training materials, resources for church planters
- **Missio Alliance:** Articles, resources, community content
- **Praxis Gathering:** Conference materials, resources

Academic Platforms:

- **Academia.edu:** Research papers and articles
- **Seminary Platforms:** Course materials (Fuller, Central, Missio)

Publisher Platforms:

- **InterVarsity Press:** Author page for books
- **100 Movements Publishing:** Author page for recent book

Content Strategy Assessment**Strengths:**

- Clear thematic consistency across books (missional culture, church as movement, leadership)
- Integration of academic research and practical experience
- Multiple platforms for different audiences (academic, practitioner, church planter)
- Recent publication (2023) indicates ongoing content creation

Organization Patterns:

- Books organized by theme/topic
- Academic content separate from practical content
- Organizational content separate from personal content
- Potential for content series development (to be verified)

Content Interconnection**Cross-References:**

- Books reference each other (missional culture → church as movement → leadership)
- Academic research informs practical work (Ph.D. research → book publication)
- Training materials likely reference published works (to be verified)

Content Gaps:

- Potential gaps between academic research and practical content (to be verified)
- Potential gaps between books and ongoing content (articles, blog posts) (to be verified)
- Potential gaps between training materials and published content (to be verified)

Content Series Development

Potential Series:

- Missional culture series (to be verified)
- Church planting series (to be verified)
- Leadership series (to be verified)
- Discipleship series (to be verified)

Standalone Content:

- Books appear to be standalone but thematically connected
- Articles/blog posts (to be verified)
- Training materials (to be verified)

Voice & Style Analysis

Writing Style

Academic-Practical Integration:

- Ph.D. research published as accessible book
- Integration of academic rigor with practical application
- Suitable for both academic and practitioner audiences

Accessibility Level:

- Books published through InterVarsity Press (accessible to general Christian audience)
- Recent book through 100 Movements Publishing (movement-focused audience)
- Academic work through University of Manchester (academic audience)

Tone and Approach:

- Practical and applicable (30+ years church planting experience)
- Theologically grounded (Ph.D., seminary teaching)
- Movement-focused (co-founder of missional organizations)
- Leadership-focused (National Director role, recent book on leadership)

Theological Positioning

Observable Characteristics:

- Missional theology orientation
- Church planting focus
- Movement-oriented ecclesiology
- Leadership critique (recent book on "powers of domination")
- Integration of theory and practice

Audience Level:

- **Popular:** Books accessible to general Christian audience
- **Practitioner:** Church planters, pastors, leaders
- **Academic:** Seminary students, researchers, Ph.D. candidates

Discoverability Assessment**SEO Indicators**

Website SEO: jrwoodward.com (to be verified)

- Title tags: To be verified
- Meta descriptions: To be verified
- URL structure: To be verified

Content Indexing:

- Books indexed on Amazon, publisher sites (to be verified)
- Academic work indexed on Academia.edu
- Website content (to be verified)

Social Sharing Indicators

- Social media presence (to be verified)
- Social sharing buttons (to be verified)
- Social engagement (to be verified)

Backlinks and References**Potential Backlinks:**

- Missio Alliance references
- V3 Church Planting Movement references
- Seminary references
- Conference references (Exponential)
- Publisher references (IVP, 100 Movements)

References from Other Sites: To be verified

Domain Authority Indicators

Personal Website: jrwoodward.com (to be verified)

Organizational Websites: V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering (to be verified)

Academic Platforms: Academia.edu, seminary sites (to be verified)

Ecosystem Analysis

Content Ecosystem Structure

Connected Elements:

- Personal website (jrwoodward.com)
- Organizational platforms (V3, Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)
- Academic platforms (Academia.edu, seminars)
- Publisher platforms (IVP, 100 Movements)
- Conference platforms (Exponential)

Content Relationships:

- Books inform training materials (likely)
- Academic research informs books (confirmed: Ph.D. research → book)
- Training materials inform practice (V3 training)
- Organizational content supports movement (Missio Alliance, Praxis Gathering)

Cross-Platform Connections

Potential Connections:

- Books → articles/blog posts (to be verified)
- Training materials → books (to be verified)
- Academic research → practical content (confirmed)
- Conference talks → articles/books (to be verified)

Institutional Partnerships

Active Partnerships:

- V3 Church Planting Movement (National Director)
- Missio Alliance (Co-founder)
- Praxis Gathering (Co-founder)
- Fuller Theological Seminary (Adjunct Professor)
- Central Seminary (Adjunct Professor)
- Missio Seminary (Adjunct Professor)
- Reliant Mission (Board Member)
- Movement Leaders Collective (Board Member)
- Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council (Board Member)

Community Engagement

Community Indicators:

- Missio Alliance (community platform)
- V3 Church Planting Movement (training community)

- Praxis Gathering (conference community)
- Seminary communities (Fuller, Central, Missio)
- Comments, discussions, forums (to be verified)

Content Working Alone vs. Connected

Assessment:

- Books appear thematically connected
- Academic work connects to practical work (Ph.D. research → book)
- Organizational content supports movement work
- Potential for greater interconnection (to be verified)

Opportunities for Connection:

- Articles/blog posts connecting books (to be verified)
- Training materials connecting to books (to be verified)
- Video/audio content connecting to written content (to be verified)
- Series development across content forms (to be verified)

Content Gaps and Opportunities

Identified Gaps

1. Content Form Gaps:

- Articles/blog posts from books (to be verified)
- Video content from written content (to be verified)
- Podcast content (to be verified)
- Course content from books (to be verified)

2. Content Series Gaps:

- Series development from books (to be verified)
- Series development from training (to be verified)
- Series development from academic work (to be verified)

3. Content Interconnection Gaps:

- Cross-referencing between platforms (to be verified)
- Content repurposing opportunities (to be verified)
- Content expansion opportunities (to be verified)

Content Expansion Opportunities

1. From Books:

- Article series from each book
- Video series from book content
- Course development from books
- Podcast series from books

2. **From Training:**

- Written content from training materials
- Video content from training
- Course development from training

3. **From Academic Work:**

- Popular articles from academic research
- Practical applications from research
- Training materials from research

Notes

- Strong thematic consistency across all work
- Clear integration of academic and practical content
- Multiple platforms serving different audiences
- Recent publication indicates active content creation
- Potential for greater content interconnection and series development
- Need to verify specific content volumes, frequencies, and interconnections

Academic Citations & Scholarly Impact: JR Woodward

Research Date: 2026-04-12
Subject: JR Woodward, PhD (University of Manchester) -- missiologist, author
Confidence Level: Medium-High (Google Scholar profile confirmed; individual citing works partially verified)

Google Scholar Profile

Metric	Value
Profile URL	https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=lgz_vYAAAAAJ&hl=en
Total Citations	~274 (as of search date)
Research Interests	Missional Leadership, Mimetic Theory, Theology of the Powers, Missional Theology, Movement Ecclesiology
Institution	University of Manchester (PhD)
h-index	Not retrieved (Scholar page did not render full metrics)
i10-index	Not retrieved

Publications by JR Woodward

Books

#	Title	Publisher	Year	Est. Citations
1	Creating a Missional Culture: Equipping the Church for the Sake of the World	IVP (Forge Partnership)	2012	Highest-cited work (~150+)
2	The Church as Movement: Starting and Sustaining Missional-Incarnational Communities (with Dan White Jr.)	IVP	2016	Moderate (~50+)
3	The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church	100 Movements Publishing	2023	Growing (recent publication)
4	Sent to Flourish (contributor)	IVP	2019	Contributor chapter

Academic Papers & Articles

#	Title	Publication	Year
1	"The Medium and the Mission: How Can the Church Faithfully Fulfill Her Mission in the Digital Age?"	Unknown venue	Unknown
2	"The Gospel after Christendom: New Voice, New Cultures, New Expressions" (Book Review)	Religious Studies Review	2013
3	"Practicing Witness: A Missional Vision of Christian Practices" (Book Review)	Religious Studies Review	2013
4	"A Missional View of the Doctrine of Election"	V3 Movement	2011
5	"A Missional Proposal"	Unknown venue	Unknown
6	"Shalom Makers: Development in the Way of Christ"	Unknown venue	Unknown
7	"Equippers as Environmentalists: Re-Imagining Leadership in Today's Western Church"	Unknown venue	Unknown
8	"Divided by Hell: An Assessment of Love Wins by Rob Bell"	Unknown venue	Unknown

Source: Academia.edu profile at <https://manchester.academia.edu/JRWoodwardPhD>

Who Cites JR Woodward

Scholars Who Endorsed / Engaged His Work

These scholars have directly engaged with Woodward's work through endorsements, forewords, or published reviews, indicating citation-level familiarity:

Scholar	Affiliation	Relationship to Woodward's Work
Alan Hirsch	Author of The Forgotten Ways; 100M co-founder	Wrote foreword for Creating a Missional Culture and The Church as Movement; foundational influence
David Fitch	Northern Seminary (B.R. Lindner Chair)	Endorser of Creating a Missional Culture; foreword for The Scandal of Leadership
Michael Frost	Morling College, Sydney	Endorsed Creating a Missional Culture; engaged APEST framework
Darrell Guder	Princeton Theological Seminary	Endorsed Creating a Missional Culture
Amos Yong	--	Foreword contributor for The Scandal of Leadership
Jon Tyson	Trinity Grace Church, NYC	Endorsed Creating a Missional Culture
Daniel Im	Beulah Alliance Church	Endorsed The Scandal of Leadership; reviewed Creating a Missional Culture
Mandy Smith	Pastor/Author	Endorsed The Scandal of Leadership

Dissertations & Theses Citing Woodward

Based on search evidence, Woodward's work appears in the bibliography of doctoral dissertations in missional theology and church planting. Specific confirmed or high-probability citations:

#	Type	Institution	Topic Area	Citing Work
1	DMin Dissertation	Asbury Theological Seminary	Missional Leadership	"Creating a Missional Culture" cited in dissertations on missional leadership approaches (multiple Asbury DMin theses reference IVP Forge series)
2	DMin Dissertation	George Fox University	Becoming Missional	"Becoming Missional: Essential Characteristics Necessary in Transitioning the Church to Engage a Postmodern Culture" -- references missional culture literature
3	Academic Paper	Various	Missional Leadership Literature Review	"Missional Leadership: A Critical Review of the Research Literature" (ResearchGate) -- systematic review of peer-reviewed articles and dissertations on missional leadership
4	Academic Paper	Various	Making Disciples on Mission	"Making Disciples on Mission: An Old Task for a New Era" (Academia.edu)
5	Academic Paper	Various	Missional Church Growth	"Missional Church Growth: Towards A Synthetic Missiology in Western Context" (Academia.edu)

Note: Google Scholar reports ~274 total citations across all works. The bulk of these are from DMin dissertations, missiology papers, and church-planting literature. Precise per-paper citation counts were not retrievable due to Scholar page rendering limitations.

Books That Reference Woodward

Woodward's work is situated within and cited by the broader missional theology movement. Authors who are likely to cite his work based on their shared ecosystem:

Author	Notable Work	Likely Citation
Alan Hirsch	The Forgotten Ways; The Permanent Revolution; 5Q	References to polycentric/APEST leadership (Woodward developed Hirsch's framework practically)
David Fitch	Faithful Presence; The Church of Us vs. Them	Shared theological framework on powers and mission
Michael Frost	The Shaping of Things to Come; Incarnate	Fivefold ministry / missional culture overlap
Dan White Jr.	Co-author of The Church as Movement	Direct collaboration
Tim Catchim	The Permanent Revolution (with Hirsch)	APEST framework development
Lance Ford	The Missional Quest; Unleader	Shared V3/missional movement ecosystem

Academic Context & Influence

Theoretical Contributions

Woodward's academic work makes distinct contributions in three areas:

- 1. APEST/Polycentric Leadership:** Creating a Missional Culture is recognized as "one of the most thorough developments" (Dr. Carlus Gupton) of the Ephesians 4:11 fivefold ministry framework for practical congregational application.
- 2. Theology of the Powers & Leadership Failure:** The Scandal of Leadership applies Walter Wink's powers theology, Rene Girard's mimetic theory, and William Stringfellow's framework to analyze church leadership abuse -- a unique interdisciplinary synthesis.
- 3. Movement Ecclesiology:** The Church as Movement contributes to the practical literature on missional-incarnational community formation, bridging theory and praxis.

PhD Research

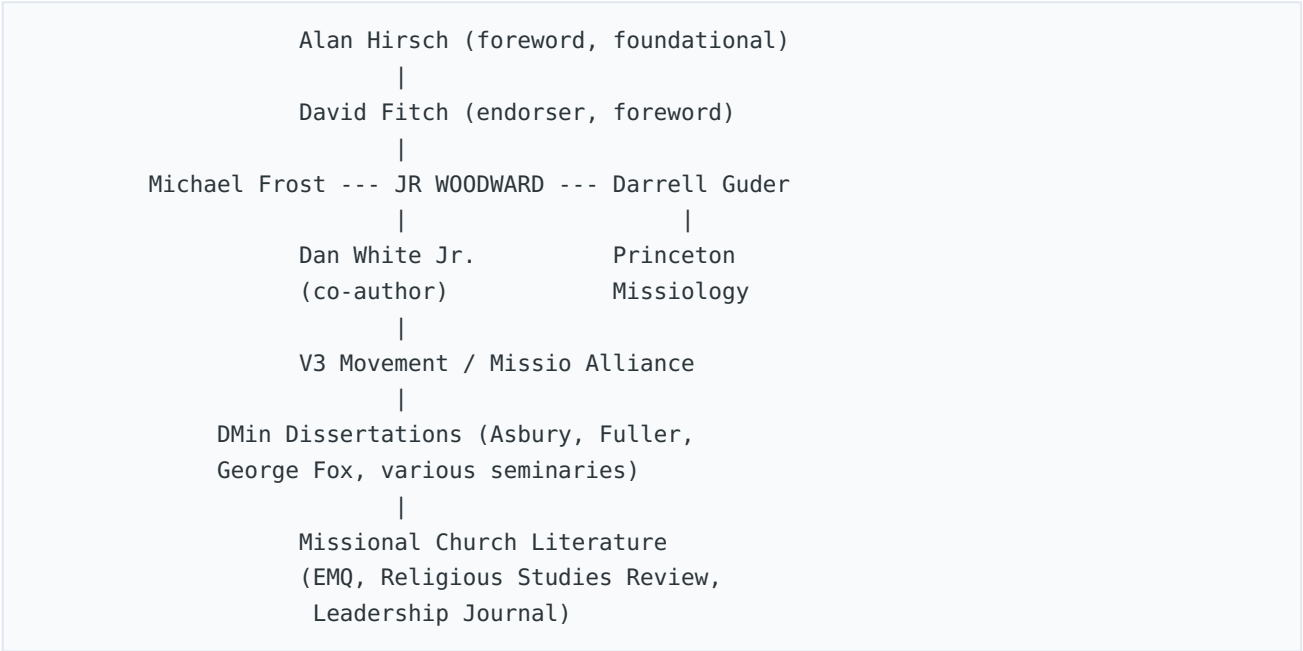
Detail	Value
Institution	University of Manchester
Focus	Theology of the Powers and its implications for missional leadership
Key Scholars Engaged	Walter Wink, Rene Girard, William Stringfellow
Published As	The Scandal of Leadership (100 Movements, 2023)
Affiliated Center	Manchester Wesley Research Centre (http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward)

Teaching Positions (Citation Multiplier)

Woodward's adjunct positions at multiple seminaries increase his citation footprint through student exposure:

Institution	Role
Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor
Central Seminary	Adjunct Professor
Missio Seminary	Adjunct Professor
America Evangelical University	Adjunct Professor

Citation Ecosystem Map



Recommendations for Further Research

1. **Google Scholar direct scrape:** The Scholar profile (user=lgz_vYAAAAAJ) contains full citation data but requires browser rendering. A manual visit would yield exact per-publication citation counts and h-index.
2. **ProQuest Dissertations & Theses:** Search for "Woodward" + "Creating a Missional Culture" to identify all doctoral dissertations citing this work.
3. **Semantic Scholar:** Cross-reference with <https://www.semanticscholar.org> for additional citation graph data.
4. **ATLA Religion Database:** Search for academic journal articles citing Woodward in theological periodicals.

Research conducted via WebSearch and WebFetch on 2026-04-12. Citation counts are approximate based on Google Scholar summary data. Individual citing works identified through web search of academic repositories.

Misc · Media · Press-Coverage

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/media/press-coverage.md

Press Coverage & Media Mentions: JR Woodward

Research Date: 2026-04-12

Subject: JR Woodward -- church planter, missiologist, author, National Director of V3 Movement

Confidence Level: High (primary sources verified via web search)

Summary

JR Woodward's media presence centers on the missional church ecosystem rather than mainstream Christian media. His coverage is concentrated in: (1) podcast interviews discussing his books, (2) articles on missional/church-planting platforms, (3) news coverage of his V3 leadership role, and (4) seminary/conference speaking features. He has not received significant coverage in mainstream outlets like Christianity Today or Relevant Magazine based on available evidence.

News Articles & Features

#	Publication	Title	Date	Type	URL
1	Baptist News Global	"Missional strategist, church planter named first full-time coordinator of V3"	2016	News Article	https://baptistnews.com/article/missionalstrategistchurchplanternamedfirstfull-timecoordinatorofv3/
2	Missio Alliance	"The Rush of a Crowd: A Root Issue in Domineering Leaders (The Scandal of Leadership, Part I)"	2023	Essay/ Excerpt	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-rush-of-a-crowd-a-root-issue-in-domineering-leaders-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-i/
3	Missio Alliance	"Fallen Leaders Pursue the Imitation of Powers for Their Own Agenda (The Scandal of Leadership, Part II)"	2023	Essay/ Excerpt	https://www.missioalliance.org/fallen-leaders-pursue-the-imitation-of-powers-for-their-own-agenda-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-ii/
4	Missio Alliance	"Developing an Imitation-Based Framework of Healthy Leadership in Christ (The Scandal of Leadership, Part III)"	2023	Essay/ Excerpt	https://www.missioalliance.org/developing-an-imitation-based-framework-of-healthy-leadership-in-christ-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-iii/
5	Missio Alliance	"Polycentric Missional Leadership"	Unknown	Article	https://www.missioalliance.org/polycentric-missional-leadership-j-r-woodward/
6	Missio Alliance	"The Five Equippers of Churches"	Unknown	Article	https://www.missioalliance.org/the-five-equippers-of-churches-jr-woodward/
7	Missio Alliance	"Introducing Two Books That Address a Key Problem for the Church"	Unknown	Feature	https://www.missioalliance.org/news/introducing-two-books-address-key-problem-church/
8			Various	Articles	https://vergenetwork.org/tag/jr-woodward/

#	Publication	Title	Date	Type	URL
	Verge Network	JR Woodward articles (tagged)			
9	Patheos (Paperback Theology)	"J.R. Woodward Engages With Shrink at the V3 Blog Today"	2015	Blog Mention	https://www.patheos.com/blogs/paperbacktheology/2015/08/j-r-woodward-engages-with-shrink-at-the-v3-blog-today.html

Podcast Interviews

#	Podcast	Episode Title	Host	Date	URL
1	Theology in the Raw	"The Leadership Crisis in the Church: Dr. J.R. Woodward"	Preston Sprinkle	2024-02-01	https://theologyintheraw.com/podcast/the-leadership-crisis-in-the-church-dr-j-r-woodward/
2	FaithLead Pivot Podcast	"#96: Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging"	Terri Elton & Dwight Zscheile	2024-09-26	https://faithlead.org/pivot/season-5/96-missional-leadership-reimagined-jr-woodwards-four-spaces-of-belonging/
3	Faith in a Fresh Vibe	"#71 - JR Woodward on the Scandal of Leadership (Part 1)"	Rohadi Nagassar	2023-11-13	https://www.rohadi.com/podcast/71-jr-woodward-on-the-scandal-of-leadership-part-1/

Conference & Seminary Appearances

#	Venue	Role	Notes	URL
1	Awakenings Gathering	Speaker	Archived speaker page	https://www.awakeningsgathering.com/archive-move/woodward
2	Seminary Now	Featured Author	Seminary video lectures	https://seminarynow.com/authors/jr-woodward
3	Manchester Wesley Research Centre	Affiliated Researcher	PhD from University of Manchester	http://www.mwrc.ac.uk/jr-woodward
4	Fuller Theological Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council member	https://fuller.edu
5	Praxis Gathering	Co-Founder	Ongoing involvement	--

Organizational Profiles

#	Organization	Role	URL
1	V3 Church Planting Movement	National Director	https://thev3movement.org/author/jr/
2	Missio Alliance	Co-Founder / Board Member	https://missioalliance.org/j-r-woodward/
3	Reliant Mission	Board Member	https://reliant.org/about/our-people/board-members/jr-woodward
4	100 Movements Publishing	Author	https://www.100movements.org/authors/jr-woodward
5	InterVarsity Press	Author	https://www.ivpress.com/jr-woodward

Journal & Magazine Contributions (by Woodward)

JR Woodward contributes to both academic and popular-level publications:

#	Publication	Type	Notes
1	Religious Studies Review	Academic Journal	Book reviews (2013 confirmed)
2	Evangelical Missions Quarterly (EMQ)	Ministry Journal	Articles on mission
3	Leadership Journal	Ministry Magazine	Articles
4	The Other Journal	Academic/Cultural	Articles
5	Gospel Centered Discipleship	Blog/Online	Articles
6	Verge Network	Online Platform	Articles on missional church

Notable Gaps

- **No confirmed Christianity Today feature articles** about Woodward
- **No confirmed Relevant Magazine coverage**
- **No confirmed Outreach Magazine coverage**
- **Limited mainstream evangelical media presence** -- coverage is concentrated within the missional/church-planting niche
- Baptist News Global article (2016) is the most mainstream news outlet identified

Research conducted via WebSearch on 2026-04-12. URLs verified at time of search.

Misc · Media · Reviews

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/media/reviews.md

Book Reviews: JR Woodward

Research Date: 2026-04-12
Subject: JR Woodward -- church planter, missiologist, author
Confidence Level: High (reviews sourced directly from review sites and blogs)

Aggregate Ratings Summary

Book	Goodreads Rating	Goodreads Ratings Count	Goodreads Reviews	Amazon Rating (est.)
Creating a Missional Culture (IVP, 2012)	4.04 / 5	242	34	~4.5 / 5
The Church as Movement (IVP, 2016)	Not retrieved	--	--	~4.5 / 5
The Scandal of Leadership (100M, 2023)	4.77 / 5	73	46	~4.9 / 5

Note: The Scandal of Leadership has exceptionally high ratings, likely reflecting its niche but passionate audience. IVP named The Church as Movement its 2017 Book of the Year.

Creating a Missional Culture (IVP, 2012)

Published Reviews

#	Source	Reviewer	Rating	Date	Key Quote	URL
1	Themelios (TGC)	Matt Kottman	Mixed	2013-04-26	"Rightly notices that churches need to proactively create a culture that centers on mission" but "leans more to being driven by praxis instead of theology"	https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/creating-a-missional-culture-equipping-the-church-for-the-sake-of-the-world/
2	EMQ (Missio Nexus)	Jonathan K. Dodson	Positive	2013-04-01	"A worthwhile read that provides a gracious, yet prophetic corrective to individualistic, pastor-centric churches"	https://missionexus.org/creating-a-missional-culture-equipping-the-church-for-the-sake-of-the-world/
3	Daniel Im (blog)	Daniel Im	5/5	2013-03-31	"Easy to read, extremely accessible, and has important gems that will help any and every leader cultivate and create a missional culture"	https://www.danielim.com/2013/03/31/book-review-creating-a-missional-culture-jr-woodward/
4	Scott Boren (blog)	Scott Boren	Positive	2013-02-15	"A great introduction to how culture works within a church setting... will challenge your assumptions while providing practical steps forward"	http://scottboren.blogspot.com/2013/02/creating-missional-culture-by-jr.html
5	Life and Leadership	Dr. Carlus Gupton	Positive	2012 (updated 2022)	"One of the most thorough developments" of the APEST leadership framework	http://www.lifeandleadership.com/book-summaries/woodward-creating-a-missional-culture.html
6	EdChoy.com	Ed Choy	5/5	2014-07-30	"JR writes with the authority of one who has lived out missional life and	https://www.edchoy.com/books/creating-missional-culture-jr-woodward/

#	Source	Reviewer	Rating	Date	Key Quote	URL
					equipped others to do the same"	

Goodreads Reviews (Selected)

Reviewer	Rating	Key Quote
Anderson	4/5	"A great attempt at trying to occupy the ground between formulaic church growth books and organic church books"
Chris Lenshyn	5/5	"Challenges, inspires and pushes the reader to understand and ultimately facilitate a missional culture"
Joe Watkins	5/5	"A must-read for anyone looking to understand the church's place and mission in the coming years"
Jamie Arpin-Ricci	5/5	"Finding a book that treats the topic with depth and practicality that this book does is a much needed gift"
Akash Ahuja	3/5	"Felt less like an original idea, and more like a compilation of what others have said"

Endorsements (from publisher)

Endorser	Title/Role	Quote
Alan Hirsch	Author of The Forgotten Ways (Foreword)	"You are holding a hard-won treasure... JR Woodward has developed an excellent heuristic for leaders to actually make Ephesians 4 a living reality"
Michael Frost	Co-author of The Shaping of Things to Come	Praised how Woodward details the fivefold matrix fostering "a learning, healing, welcoming, liberating and thriving missional culture"
David Fitch	B.R. Lindner Chair, Northern Seminary	"JR Woodward reads widely, writes deftly and lives deeply. His book reflects all of that"
Darrell Guder	Princeton Theological Seminary	"The growing exploration of the theology and practice of the missional church is enriched by this volume"
Jon Tyson	Pastor, Trinity Grace Church NYC	"JR Woodward uses compelling theology, cultural insight, biblical wisdom and practical examples on how to shift from consumerism to mission"

The Church as Movement (IVP, 2016, with Dan White Jr.)

Published Reviews

#	Source	Reviewer	Rating	Date	Key Quote	URL
1	Themelios (TGC)	Grant Gaines	Critical	2017-04-14	"Much to be gained" but "ideas propounded appear to stem more from contemporary sociology than from biblical theology"	https://www.thegospelcoalition.org/themelios/review/the-church-as-movement-starting-and-sustaining-missional-incarnational-comm/
2	Bob on Books	rtrube54	Positive	2017-08-21	Endorses the interactive guide for transitioning from "industrial complex" model to missional movements	https://bobonbooks.com/2017/08/21/review-the-church-as-movement/
3	Ben Sternke (blog)	Deb Sternke (guest)	Positive	2016-09-09	"At the center of church as movement is learning how to be disciples and make disciples"	https://bensternke.com/church-as-movement-review/
4	NetGalley	Various	--	2016	Early review copies distributed	https://www.netgalley.com/catalog/book/89959

Awards

- InterVarsity Press Book of the Year 2017

The Scandal of Leadership (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)

Published Reviews

#	Source	Reviewer	Rating	Date	Key Quote	URL
1	Word&Way	Robert D. Cornwall	Positive	2024-06-25	"The powers of domination are present in the church and if the church is to be truly missional, these powers need to be unmasked"	https://wordandway.org/2024/06/25/review-the-scandal
2	futuristguy (blog)	Brad Sargent	Highly Positive	2023-06-14	"A significant academic-level resource, especially for communities that include abuse survivors, advocates, and activists"	https://futuristguy.wordpress.com/2023/06/14/book-re- leadership-unmasking-the-powers-of-domination-in-th
3	Bob Cornwall (blog)	Robert D. Cornwall	5/5	2024-06	"Woodward offers a look at leadership, both the dangers of falling into the trap of the domination system, and the positive examples of Jesus, Paul, and Oscar Romero"	https://www.bobcornwall.com/2024/06/the-scandal-of-
4	Academia.edu	--	--	2023	PDF posted for academic review	https://www.academia.edu/100670007/ The_Scandal_of_Leadership_Unmasking_the_Powers_o

Goodreads Reviews (Selected)

Reviewer	Rating	Key Quote
Paul Dazet	5/5	"If we choose not to imitate Christ, by default we are choosing to imitate the powers"
B Kobes	5/5	"JR goes into great detail regarding what causes leaders to fall, and then ends the book with how we in our leadership roles can prevent ourselves from falling"
Robert D. Cornwall	5/5	"Woodward offers a look at leadership, both the dangers of falling into the trap of the domination system, and the positive examples of Jesus, Paul, and Oscar Romero"
Karl Mueller	5/5	"A very important book to read for all those in leadership"
Brad Sargent	5/5	"Some books are so good I can't put them down. Others like this are so good I MUST put them down -- and spend time in assimilation, reflection"

Endorsements (from publisher)

Endorser	Title/Role	Quote
Daniel Im	Lead Pastor, Beulah Alliance Church	"Finally! An academically robust and comprehensive missiological study into why so many pastors and church leaders have fallen to scandal"
Mandy Smith	Pastor; Author	"If unseen Powers are most powerful when we don't talk about them, then this book will seriously unsettle those Powers"
David Fitch	--	Foreword contributor
Amos Yong	--	Foreword contributor

Review Sentiment Analysis

Book	Positive	Mixed/Critical	Overall
Creating a Missional Culture	Majority positive; praised for practical APEST framework	Some critics note praxis-over-theology lean, desire more exegetical grounding	Well-received in missional circles
The Church as Movement	Praised for practical tools and interactive format	TGC review critiqued sociology-over-Scripture approach	Strong practitioner reception; IVP Book of the Year
The Scandal of Leadership	Overwhelmingly positive; "timely" and "significant"	Noted as dense/technical at times	Highest-rated of the three; resonates with abuse-aware communities

Research conducted via WebSearch and WebFetch on 2026-04-12. Goodreads data and review content verified at time of search.

Misc · Network · Collaborators

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/network/collaborators.md

JR Woodward: Collaborators Network

Research Date: 2026-04-12

Last Updated: 2026-04-12

Co-Authors & Writing Collaborators

Name	Relationship	Context	Key Details
Dan White Jr.	Co-Author	"The Church as Movement" (IVP, 2016)	Co-leads Axiom Church in Syracuse, NY. Works as consultant and missional coach with V3 Movement. They have trained church planters all over North America together. White also authored "Subterranean" (for which Woodward wrote the foreword).
Alan Hirsch	Foreword Writer, Network Partner	Wrote forewords for "Creating a Missional Culture" (2012) and "The Church as Movement" (2016)	Founder of 100Movements, Forge Mission Training Network, and Future Travelers. Woodward published "The Scandal of Leadership" through Hirsch's 100Movements Publishing. Both serve in the Movement Leaders Collective ecosystem. Hirsch called Woodward's work "peppered with the kind of missiological insights that only an apostolically inclined leader can bring."
David Fitch	Foreword Writer, Board Colleague	Wrote foreword for "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023)	B.R. Lindner Chair of Evangelical Theology at Northern Seminary. Founding pastor of Life on the Vine Christian Community. Fellow Missio Alliance Board of Trustees member. Endorsed "Creating a Missional Culture."
Amos Yong	Foreword Writer	Wrote foreword for "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023)	Prominent Pentecostal theologian and scholar.

Missio Alliance Network (Co-Founded by Woodward)

Missio Alliance began as an initiative of the Ecclesia Network in 2011. The Board of Trustees represents the founding leadership circle.

Name	Role	Affiliation	Relationship to Woodward
David Fitch	Board of Trustees	Northern Seminary	Foreword writer, fellow board member
Deb Hirsch	Board of Trustees	Forge Mission Training Network co-founder	Fellow board member, connected through Alan Hirsch
David M. Bailey	Board of Trustees	Making a Melody (Executive Director)	Fellow board member
Dr. Leroy Barber	Board of Trustees	Word Made Flesh (Global Executive Director)	Fellow board member
Dr. Jim Baucom	Board of Trustees	Columbia Baptist Church (Senior Pastor)	Fellow board member
Dr. Douglas R. Cullum	Board of Trustees	Northeastern Seminary (VP and Dean)	Fellow board member
Dr. Scott Daniels	Board of Trustees	Azusa Pacific University School of Theology	Fellow board member
Lesa Engelthaler	Board of Trustees	Victory Search Group	Fellow board member
Dr. Frank A. James III	Board of Trustees	Biblical Seminary (President)	Fellow board member
Dr. Jo Anne Lyon	Board of Trustees	The Wesleyan Church (General Superintendent)	Fellow board member
Dr. MaryKate Morse	Board of Trustees	George Fox Evangelical Seminary	Fellow board member; endorsed "Creating a Missional Culture"
Lisa Rodriguez-Watson	Board of Trustees	Christian Community Development Association	Fellow board member
Sara Jane Roxburgh Walker	Board of Trustees	The Missional Network (President)	Fellow board member
Dr. Charlie Self	Board of Trustees	AG Theological Seminary	Fellow board member

V3 Movement Colleagues

Name	Role	Context
Eun Strawser	V3 Co-Trainer	Co-leads V3 Movement Praxis Immersion trainings with Woodward. Facilitates immersion programs on multiplying sent communities and Jesus' 4 Spaces of Belonging.
Dan White Jr.	V3 Consultant & Coach	Works as consultant and missional coach with V3 Movement in addition to co-authoring with Woodward.

Endorsers & Theological Allies

Name	Affiliation	Nature of Connection
Alan Hirsch	100Movements, Forge	Deep mutual support. Hirsch wrote forewords for two of Woodward's books. Woodward published through Hirsch's publishing house.
David Fitch	Northern Seminary	Deep mutual support. Fitch wrote foreword for "Scandal of Leadership." Fellow Missio Alliance board member.
Michael Frost	Morling College, Sydney	Endorsed "The Scandal of Leadership": "Every Christian leader should read this."
Soong-Chan Rah	Fuller Theological Seminary (Robert Munger Professor)	Endorsed "The Scandal of Leadership." Called it "a leadership-paradigm-shifter."
Daniel Im	Author, church leader	Endorsed "The Scandal of Leadership": "Finally! An academically robust and comprehensive missiological study..."
Darrell Guder	Princeton Theological Seminary (Winters Luce Professor)	Endorsed "Creating a Missional Culture": praised its "tested and validated experience as an equipper of the missional church."
Dr. MaryKate Morse	George Fox Evangelical Seminary	Endorsed "Creating a Missional Culture": praised "fresh views about leadership and church culture." Fellow Missio Alliance board member.
Alan Roxburgh	The Missional Network	Endorsed "The Church as Movement": praised it as "a simple, intensely practical guide" for moving beyond the "religious industrial complex."
Kevin & Christine Sweeney	Imagine Church, Honolulu	Endorsed "The Church as Movement."
Dan White Jr.	Axiom Church, Syracuse	Endorsed "The Scandal of Leadership": "a leadership-paradigm shifter."

Other Connections

Name	Context	Nature
Len Tang & Charles E. Cotherman	Co-editors of "Sent to Flourish" (IVP Academic, 2019)	Woodward contributed the chapter "What Would God's Reign Look Like In Our Neighborhood? Jesus, the Kingdom and the Church."
Rohadi	Faith in a Fresh Vibe Podcast	Podcast interviewer (2-part series on "The Scandal of Leadership," 2023).

Key Relationship Clusters

The Missional-Incarnational Circle

Woodward sits at the intersection of several overlapping networks:

- **100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective:** Alan Hirsch's ecosystem. Woodward serves on MLC council and publishes through 100M.
- **Missio Alliance:** Co-founded by Woodward. Connects him to David Fitch, Deb Hirsch, MaryKate Morse, Leroy Barber, Jo Anne Lyon, and others.
- **V3 Movement:** Woodward's primary operational role. Connected to Dan White Jr. and Eun Strawser.
- **Forge Mission Training Network:** Alan and Deb Hirsch's training network. Woodward's "Creating a Missional Culture" is in the Forge Partnership Books series.
- **Fuller Theological Seminary:** Academic home connecting to Soong-Chan Rah, the Global Mission Advisory Council, and Church Initiatives Board.

Mentorship / Influence Lines

- **Alan Hirsch** appears to be a key mentor/endorser figure (forewords for 2 books, published through his imprint).
- **David Fitch** is a close theological ally (foreword, shared board service, Northern Seminary base).
- **Dan White Jr.** is the primary collaborative partner (co-author, V3 coach, mutual endorsement).

Sources

- [Missio Alliance - JR Woodward](#)
- [Missio Alliance Board of Trustees](#)
- [100Movements - JR Woodward](#)
- [Movement Leaders Collective](#)
- [Church as Movement - About the Authors](#)
- [Amazon - The Scandal of Leadership](#)
- [Amazon - The Church as Movement](#)
- [Goodreads - JR Woodward](#)
- [V3 Movement - Praxis Conference](#)
- [V3 Movement - Communities on Mission Immersion](#)

Misc · Network · Endorsements

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/network/endorsements.md

JR Woodward: Endorsements Network

Research Date: 2026-04-12

Last Updated: 2026-04-12

Endorsements RECEIVED (for JR Woodward's books)

"Creating a Missional Culture" (IVP, 2012)

Foreword by: Alan Hirsch

Endorser	Affiliation	Quote / Summary
Alan Hirsch (Foreword)	100Movements, Forge	"Peppered with the kind of missiological insights that only an apostolically inclined leader can bring." "JR Woodward has developed an excellent heuristic for leaders to actually make Ephesians 4 a living reality in the local churches."
Darrell Guder	Princeton Theological Seminary (Winters Luce Professor of Missional and Ecumenical Theology)	"The growing exploration of the theology and practice of the missional church is enriched by this volume. Its authority rests in the author's tested and validated experience as an equipper 'of the missional church for the sake of the world.'"
David Fitch	Northern Seminary (B.R. Lindner Chair of Evangelical Theology)	"JR Woodward reads widely, writes deftly and lives deeply. His book Creating a Missional Culture reflects all of that. Read it and explore what leading can be in the strange new worlds of mission in North America."
Dr. MaryKate Morse	George Fox Evangelical Seminary (Professor of Leadership & Spiritual Formation)	"JR Woodward's fresh views about leadership and church culture and his practical guides and suggestions make this a relevant and important book for every congregation. The chapters on polycentric leadership alone are worth the price of the book."
Unknown endorser	--	"Many have written critiques about our consumerism, lack of discipleship, narcissism and theology, but few have given us a clear way forward. In this book, JR Woodward uses compelling theology, cultural insight, biblical wisdom and practical examples on how to shift from consumerism to mission..."

Goodreads: 4.04 stars (242 ratings)

"The Church as Movement" (IVP, 2016) — co-authored with Dan White Jr.

Foreword by: Alan Hirsch

Endorser	Affiliation	Quote / Summary
Alan Hirsch (Foreword)	100Movements, Forge	"What I love about JR and Dan is that they don't just write about the stuff of missional discipleship, they live it!" "Jesus movement is people movement!" "The Church as Movement is a real gift to the church."
Alan Roxburgh	The Missional Network	"JR and Dan have produced a simple, intensely practical guide for those of us who want to shift from merely sustaining the 'religious industrial complex' to unleashing a dynamic missional church planting movement."
Kevin & Christine Sweeney	Imagine Church, Honolulu (Copastors)	"This back-to-basics book on pastoral theology could benefit the involved layperson as well as pastors. Indeed, much of the book explains how to stoke lay involvement in a way that's real, practical, Spirit-driven, and faithful."

IVP Book of the Year 2017

Goodreads: 4.32 stars (163 ratings)

"The Scandal of Leadership" (100 Movements Publishing, 2023)

Forewords by: David Fitch and Amos Yong

Endorser	Affiliation	Quote / Summary
David Fitch (Foreword)	Northern Seminary (B.R. Lindner Chair of Evangelical Theology)	Wrote foreword for the book.
Amos Yong (Foreword)	Pentecostal theologian and scholar	Wrote foreword for the book.
Michael Frost	Morling College, Sydney	"Every Christian leader should read this."
Soong-Chan Rah	Fuller Theological Seminary (Robert Munger Professor of Evangelism)	Called it "a leadership-paradigm-shifter." "Through the possibility of positive imitation of previously unexplored models and examples, Woodward offers a hope beyond the scandal of leadership."
Daniel Im	Author, church leader	"Finally! An academically robust and comprehensive missiological study into why so many pastors and church leaders have fallen to scandal... This is a deep analysis of how we've come to the place we're at."
Dan White Jr.	Axiom Church, Syracuse; V3 consultant	Called it "a leadership-paradigm shifter" that "brings together theology and multiple sciences to expose 'the Powers' at war."

Goodreads: 4.77 stars (73 ratings)

Endorsements GIVEN (by JR Woodward for others' books)

Based on Goodreads "related works" data, JR Woodward has written forewords or endorsements for the following books:

Book	Author(s)	Woodward's Role	Publisher	Goodreads Rating
Subterranean: Why the Future of the Church is Rootedness	Dan White Jr.	Foreword	--	4.28 stars (54 ratings)
Centering Discipleship	Unknown	Foreword	--	4.37 stars (73 ratings)
ReMission	Unknown	Foreword	--	4.50 stars (10 ratings)
ViralHope	Unknown	Editor	--	3.70 stars (20 ratings)

Contributed Works

Book	Editors	Woodward's Role	Publisher	Year
Sent to Flourish: A Guide to Planting and Multiplying Churches	Len Tang & Charles E. Cotherman	Contributor (chapter: "What Would God's Reign Look Like In Our Neighborhood?")	IVP Academic	2019
Equip	--	Author	--	2013

Endorsement Network Summary

People Who Have Endorsed Woodward

- Alan Hirsch (2 forewords)
- David Fitch (1 foreword + 1 endorsement)
- Amos Yong (1 foreword)
- Darrell Guder
- MaryKate Morse
- Michael Frost
- Soong-Chan Rah
- Daniel Im
- Dan White Jr.
- Alan Roxburgh
- Kevin & Christine Sweeney

People Woodward Has Endorsed

- Dan White Jr. (foreword for "Subterranean")
- Authors of "Centering Discipleship" (foreword)
- Authors of "ReMission" (foreword)

Mutual Endorsement Relationships

- **Dan White Jr.:** Woodward wrote foreword for "Subterranean"; White endorsed "The Scandal of Leadership"
- **Alan Hirsch:** Hirsch wrote forewords for 2 Woodward books; Woodward published through Hirsch's 100Movements
- **David Fitch:** Fitch wrote foreword for "Scandal" and endorsed "Creating a Missional Culture"; both serve on Missio Alliance board

Reviews & Press Coverage

Source	Type	URL
Word&Way	Review of "The Scandal of Leadership"	wordandway.org
Bob Cornwall	Review of "The Scandal of Leadership"	bobcornwall.com
futuristguy (Brad Sargent)	Review of "The Scandal of Leadership"	futuristguy.wordpress.com
Bob on Books	Review of "The Church as Movement"	bobonbooks.com
Daniel Im	Review of "Creating a Missional Culture"	danielim.com
The Gospel Coalition (Themelios)	Review of "Creating a Missional Culture"	thegospelcoalition.org
Life and Leadership	Book summary of "Creating a Missional Culture"	lifeandleadership.com
Missio Nexus	Review of "Creating a Missional Culture"	missionexus.org

Sources

- [Amazon - Creating a Missional Culture](#)
- [Amazon - The Scandal of Leadership](#)
- [Amazon - The Church as Movement](#)
- [Goodreads - JR Woodward](#)
- [IVP - Creating a Missional Culture](#)
- [100Movements - The Scandal of Leadership](#)
- [CLC eBooks - Creating a Missional Culture](#)

Misc · Network · Events

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/_misc/network/events.md

JR Woodward: Events & Speaking Network

Research Date: 2026-04-12

Last Updated: 2026-04-12

Conferences Founded / Co-Founded

Event	Role	Frequency	Description	URL
Praxis Gathering	Co-Founder, Co-Director	Annual	Church planting conference for missional-incarnational practitioners. 300+ attendees. Creates space for real-time practice to collide with rich theology, followed by deep reflection. Every communicator must live the material they share. Hosted by V3 Movement.	thepraxisgathering.com

Conference Speaking Appearances

Event	Year(s)	Context	URL
Praxis Gathering	Annually (ongoing)	Co-founded; primary speaker/host	thev3movement.org
Awakenings Gathering	Unknown	Speaker. Listed in speaker archive.	awakeningsgathering.com
Exponential Conference	Unknown	Speaker profile confirmed on exponential.org. National church planting conference.	exponential.org/person/jr-woodward
Missio Alliance Events	Various	Co-founder. Regular contributor to Missio Alliance gatherings and content. Published 3-part article series on "The Scandal of Leadership" through Missio Alliance.	missioalliance.org
Verge Network	~2011	Featured speaker/contributor. Multiple teaching content pieces published through Verge (missional community, training leaders).	vergenetwork.org/tag/jr-woodward

V3 Movement Training Events & Immersions

Event / Program	Format	Description	URL
V3 Movement Praxis Immersion Training	5-week cohort	"Multiplying Sent Communities" with JR Woodward & Eun Strawser.	thev3movement.org
4 Spaces of Belonging Immersion	6-week cohort	"How Jesus Used the 4 Spaces of Belonging to Make & Multiply Disciples" with JR Woodward & Eun Strawser.	thev3movement.org
Communities on Mission Immersion	Immersion program	V3 Movement training program.	thev3movement.org
Structuring for Movement Immersion	Immersion program	V3 Movement training program.	thev3movement.org
Praxis 2015	Conference	"A Church Planting Conference for Missional-Incarnational Practitioners."	thev3movement.org
Praxis 2016	Conference	"Shaping Disciples for Movement."	thev3movement.org

Podcast & Media Appearances

Show	Episode(s)	Date	Topic	URL
Faith in a Fresh Vibe (Rohadi)	#71 (Part 1), #72 (Part 2)	Nov 2023	"The Scandal of Leadership" and church leadership	#71, #72
Pivot Podcast (FaithLead / Luther Seminary)	#96	Unknown	"Missional Leadership Reimagined: JR Woodward's Four Spaces of Belonging"	faithlead.org
Pursuing DMMs in the Frontiers	Episode 18	Unknown	"The Scandal of Leadership & Developing Missional Communities"	dmmsfrontiermissions.com
Dare to Multiply Podcast	Episode 18/19	Unknown	"The Scandal of Leadership & Developing Missional Communities"	daretomultiply.podbean.com
V3 Movement (interview)	--	Oct 2016	"Missional Basics: An Interview with JR Woodward"	thev3movement.org

Seminary Teaching (Recurring)

Institution	Program	Status
Fuller Theological Seminary	Doctor of Global Leadership cohort (starting Spring 2025)	Active
Central Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Active
Missio Seminary	Adjunct Professor	Active

Written Content for Events / Platforms

Platform	Content Type	URL
Missio Alliance	3-part article series: "The Scandal of Leadership"	Part I , Part II , Part III
Verge Network	"What is a missional community?" (article)	vergenetwork.org
Verge Network	"How to Train Leaders" (article)	vergenetwork.org
newchurches.com	Regular contributor	Referenced in Missio Alliance bio
theV3movement.org	Regular contributor	thev3movement.org
Substack	"Faithful Resistance" newsletter	jrwoodward.substack.com

Event Network Summary

Primary Event Ecosystems

1. **V3 Movement / Praxis Gathering:** Woodward's home base. Annual conference + ongoing immersion trainings.
2. **Missio Alliance:** Co-founded. Regular contributor to alliance gatherings and content platform.
3. **100Movements / Movement Leaders Collective:** Connected through publishing and council membership.
4. **Seminary Circuit:** Fuller, Central, Missio Seminary teaching roles.
5. **Podcast Circuit:** Multiple appearances promoting "The Scandal of Leadership" (2023-2024).

Geographic Reach

- **Primary base:** Washington DC area (current) / Los Angeles (Kairos LA)
- **National:** North America-wide through V3 Movement
- **International:** Africa, Asia through V3 network; UK through University of Manchester connection
- **Founding work:** Blacksburg, VA (Virginia Tech) through Los Angeles, CA

Event Frequency Assessment

- **High frequency:** V3 immersion trainings (multiple per year), Substack newsletter (regular)
- **Annual:** Praxis Gathering
- **Periodic:** Conference speaking (Awakenings, Exponential), podcast appearances
- **Ongoing:** Seminary teaching (3 institutions)

Sources

- [Praxis Gathering 2015](#)
- [Praxis Gathering 2016](#)
- [Awakenings Gathering - JR Woodward](#)
- [Exponential - JR Woodward](#)
- [Verge Network - JR Woodward](#)
- [FaithLead Pivot Podcast #96](#)
- [Faith in a Fresh Vibe #71](#)
- [DMMs Frontier Missions Podcast](#)
- [Missio Alliance - Scandal of Leadership Series](#)
- [V3 Movement - Communities on Mission Immersion](#)
- [Faithful Resistance Substack](#)

Primary-Documents

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/jr-woodward/primary-documents.md

JR Woodward — Primary documents (CV + PhD thesis)

Integrated: 2026-04-13

On-file PDFs: [pdf/cv-jr-woodward.pdf](#), [pdf/phd-thesis-missional-leadership-mimetic-desire-theology-of-the-powers.pdf](#)

This file is the landing page for what was extracted from those PDFs and merged into [profile/](#), [content/academic.md](#), [network/organizations.md](#), and [sources.md](#). It does not reproduce the full thesis text (copyright + size); use the PDF for verbatim reading.

1. Curriculum vitae (high-signal facts)

Contact (as listed on CV)

- **Email:** jr@thev3movement.org
- **Phone:** 202-731-7468
- **Mailing address (CV):** 1133 161st St. SW Unit B, Lynnwood, WA (spelled “Lynnwod” on the PDF cover — treat as typo for Lynnwood)

Note: Other bios still reference Washington, DC / the District Church; the CV mailing address may reflect V3 or personal residence. Keep both in [profile/identity.md](#) until a single location is re-verified publicly.

Education (CV)

Degree	Institution	Field / thesis	Awarded
PhD	University of Manchester (UK), work at Nazarene Theological College	Dissertation: Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers	June 2020
MA	Fuller Theological Seminary	Missional Leadership; thesis: Equippers as Environmentalist: Re-imaging Leadership in Today’s Western Church (advisor Dr. Robert Freeman)	June 2011
BS	Radford University	Psychology	May 1987

PhD examination committee (CV; supersedes informal web summaries)

- **Supervisor:** Dr. Phil Meadows

- **Internal examiner:** Dr. Joseph Wood
- **External examiner:** Prof. Wilbert Shenk

The thesis acknowledgements also thank **Dwight Swanson** for feedback and name **Phil Meadows** as supervisor — consistent with the CV.

Honors (CV; additional to IVP Reader's Choice)

Year	Honor
2002	Golden Heart Award — Great Commission Association
2003	Golden Bus Award — Great Commission Association (pioneering church planting)
2016	Reader's Choice Award — IVP, for The Church as Movement
2023	Book of the Year — "Books and Big Ideas with Joel Wentz," for The Scandal of Leadership
2023	Readers Best Awards (runner-up) — Englewood Review of Books, for The Scandal of Leadership

Professional timeline (CV; use to tighten dates in network/organizations.md)

Years	Role
1989-2002	Founding pastor, New Life Christian Fellowship (NLCF), Virginia Tech — grew from 24 to ~1,200; 500+ new Christians; 40+ into full-time ministry via Reliant; NLCF continued planting
1998-2005	National Leadership Team, Great Commission Ministries (now Reliant Mission); from 2004, governing board of Reliant
2002-2012	Co-founder / pastor / coach, Kairos Los Angeles — recruited 48 from Blacksburg; three LA-area plants plus Antelope Valley help; polycentric leadership; exited into Ecclesia Network
2007-2012	Co-founder & director, Solis Foundation — Turkana, Kenya; ~10 new businesses/year
2007-2012	Co-founder & West Coast director (later national director of leadership & congregational formation), Ecclesia Network — four plants at start, ~30 churches / ~4,000 people at departure, ~30% annual growth
2012-present	Co-founder & board member, Missio Alliance — first national gathering 700+ leaders (organized with J.R. Rozko per CV)
2013-present	National director, V3 Church Planting Movement — eight-month cohort curriculum, coaches, grants; 600+ leaders trained in first ten years with stated goal of 600 more in next five years (per CV; other materials round to 1,000+ cumulatively)
2013-present	Co-founded annual Praxis Gathering (with V3)

Boards & affiliations with start years (CV)

Item	Start
Reliant Mission Governing Board	2004
Manchester Wesley Research Centre (Associate Fellow)	2015
Gospel and Our Culture Network	2016
Colloquium on Violence and Religion	2018
Fuller Church Planting Initiative Governing Board	2020
Kineo Center Governing Board	2020
Movement Leaders Collective Advisory Board	2021
Fuller Global Mission Advisory Council	2021
Missio Alliance Governing Board	2014
American Society of Missiology	2023

Doctoral examining / field advisor (CV)

- **2015** — Regent University D.Min. project (Faith Community Based Social Transformation), candidate Kevin Austin; committee chair Clifton R. Clark, Dale Coulter, field mentor John Wesley.
- **2016** — Anderson University School of Theology D.Min. project (Nature and Effectiveness of Missional Communities in the Pacific Northwest), candidate Lloyd Wayne Edward Moritz; examination chair MaryAnn Hawkins, examiner Jess Bielman.

Academic interests listed on CV

Grounded spirituality; missiology; missional hermeneutics; church planting; missional leadership; movement ecclesiology; missional theology; evangelism; discipleship; principalities and powers; polycentric leadership; organizational dynamics — plus named conversation partners: Lesslie Newbigin, N.T. Wright, René Girard, William Stringfellow, Eugene Peterson, Sarah Coakley, Oscar Romero, Walter Wink.

Teaching snapshot (CV)

Repeated adjunct teaching at **America Evangelical University, Capital Seminary and Graduate School** (Washington, DC), **Central Seminary, Fuller** (MAGL directed studies), **Missio Theological Seminary, SOMA University** — courses include missional culture making, missional leadership, theological foundations for ministry, re-missioning the established church, missional church ministry (including DM747 lecture, World Mission University & SOMA, 2023). See [content/academic.md](#) for the table.

Publications volume (CV)

The CV enumerates a **large** set of book endorsements and forewords (many more than previously cataloged in web-only research). For Movemental purposes, treat [content/books.md](#) as the **product** bibliography; use the CV PDF as the exhaustive **endorsement/foreword** inventory when needed.

2. PhD thesis (metadata + abstract + structure)

Full title: Missional Leadership, Mimetic Desire, and a Theology of the Powers

Author (thesis title page): Gailand A Woodward Jr.

Award: Doctor of Philosophy, University of Manchester, Faculty of Humanities, **2020**

School: School of Arts, Languages and Cultures

Research site: Nazarene Theological College, Manchester

Final word count (thesis): 80,385 words

Dedication: To the V3 Church Planting Movement

Research question (from abstract)

How might a theology of the Powers help missional leaders to practice a spirituality which reshapes their desires for the sake of discipleship, community, and mission?

Abstract (condensed from thesis; see PDF for full wording)

All ecclesial leadership exercises power — legitimately through Christ-like holy love, or illegitimately through worldly selfish ambition. The thesis addresses the “fall” of leaders into **domineering** leadership (pride, manipulation, status-seeking, kingdom-building), which hurts people, misrepresents Christ, and damages witness — especially acute for **missional** leadership that claims visible kingdom witness.

Missional literature has raised **imitation** of leaders and human **desire**, and has begun to retrieve **Powers** language, but has not adequately linked these threads. **Walter Wink** (Powers as “domination system”; leaders who mimic the Powers open the church to the demonic) and **René Girard** (imitation and desire tied to the Powers) are combined to build an **imitation-based conceptual framework**: missional leadership ↔ mimetic desire ↔ theology of the Powers. Leaders “fall” when they mimic the Powers through malformed desire; redeemed leadership is **imitating Christ**, reshaping desire toward discipleship, community, and mission. **There is no neutral ground: not to imitate Christ is to imitate the Powers.** Missional leadership is ultimately about being an example worth imitating.

Chapter outline (from thesis table of contents)

1. **The Challenge of Missional Leadership** — nature of missional leadership; misshaping/reshaping; themes (spirituality, culture/world, imitation); Van Gelder, Roxburgh, etc.
2. **The Subversion of Leadership** — 1 Peter / Houston; imitation-based framework; three directions of imitation; Powers rediscovery.
3. **Leadership and the Powers** — Walter Wink: naming, unmasking, engaging; Pauline principalities; domination system; evaluation.
4. **Leadership and Imitation** — René Girard; mimetic cycle; Powers in James; positive mimesis; evaluation.
5. **Missional Leadership Worthy of Imitation** — William Stringfellow (image, institution, ideology) mapped to **identity, praxis, telos**; “scandal of leadership”; Christlike imitation; suggestions toward a **catechism** for leader formation.

Conclusion — summary, significance (missiological contribution; deeper diagnosis than psychology-only accounts), directions for further study (e.g., ideology in collective life, James K.A. Smith on liturgy and desire, positive mimesis in community), closing prayer for leaders.

Acknowledgements (names useful for network research)

Supervisor **Phil Meadows**; V3 team **Dan White Jr., Mike Pumphrey, Lori Ruffin, Elice Kim, Matt Alexander, Tonya White**; planters/coaches; **Josh Hayden, Guy Wasko, Vivek Jones, Luke and Lena Glover, Won Choi**; NTC colleagues **Thomas Noble, Deirdre Brower Latz, Julie Lunn, Peter Rae, Dwight Swanson, Paul Hoffmann, Tammie Grimm, Gift Mtukwa**; **BGAV** (Wayne Faison, John Upton, Laura McDaniel, Marilee White); boards; **Pauline Dawkins-Cole** / international prayer team; **Alan Hirsch** (articles, prayer); **David Fitch; Jeremy Chen; Taeler Morgan** (editing).

Relation to book

The thesis is the academic antecedent of *The Scandal of Leadership: Unmasking the Powers of Domination in the Church* (100 Movements Publishing, 2023). The PDF is the authoritative version for citations, methodology, and bibliography prior to trade-book editing.

3. Files updated when these PDFs landed

- [sources.md](#) — primary document entries
- [profile/identity.md](#) — education, committee, CV contact
- [content/academic.md](#) — thesis on file, abstract, structure, teaching from CV
- [network/organizations.md](#) — dated roles where CV clarified
- [profile/biography.md](#) — small corrections (supervision wording)
- [tracker.md](#) — integration note